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Virginia Board of Education, Special Meeting, Thursday, August 31, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WBYkLtGxd34
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:08:05] Grace Creasy: Good morning, it is 9:02 and I will call this special meeting of the Virginia Board of Education to order. My name is Grace Creasy and I have the honor of serving as this body's president. Grace Creasy: But before we begin, I'd like to note, as you all have seen, that I have approved the remote participation of board members Debbie Kilgore and Dale Sturdifant

[00:08:27] JoAnne Hanrahan: Under the board bylaws and 2.2 dash 37 oh 8.3 be three of the code of Virginia, because of their principal residents being more than 60 miles from our current meeting location at this time, I would ask that you join me in a moment of silence and now we'll stand for the pledge.

[00:09:02] I'm glad to lead the Institute of Life of the United States of America and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation, one of your God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all. So the Board of Education is convening this special meeting this morning in order to consider a number of items that I and the rest of the Board consider to be of incredible importance.

[00:09:34] And so first will be the proposed mathematics standards of learning. And as our students continue to suffer from learning loss, we as a board will act swiftly to raise the expectations and put forth best-in-class standards for all subject areas.

[00:09:53] We cannot afford a delay in these standards, and we will not. The second major area of concern is the relationship between the accountability and accreditation system that the board has continued to circle for quite some time. So those of you who have been listening in or participating in our board meetings know that this has been a conversation that we have continued to discuss and have come up at our meetings for quite some time.

[00:10:22] And in the same way that our students need higher standards to stem that tide of learning loss, students, families, educators, and policymakers alike need an accountability system that lays a plain and transparent opportunity for the effectiveness of our education system.

[00:10:44] I have consulted with the superintendent extensively on these presentations, and I'm confident that we will be in a position to move our discussions forward and into action after this meeting. And then the third concerns, the revisions to the board's comprehensive plan.

[00:11:02] This conversation is needed, and it was delayed and pushed from the July work session in order to ensure that we do not fall too far behind. Lastly, we will or will not, depends on our day, have a presentation on learning loss presentation. Under the board's bylaws, I, as the president, have the authority to call a special meeting of the board, and in accordance with the bylaws, no business other than that specified in the notice of the meeting shall be transacted today.

[00:11:35] Consistent with the practice of the board special meeting in May of this year, the board will not be accepting public comment today. While the board loves to hear from the public, it will continue to do so at our regular scheduled meetings. So with that, may I have a motion to approve today's agenda for our special meeting.

[00:11:58] Okay. All those in favor? So let's go down the list here. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Sturdifin? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye.

[00:12:24] Okay. And moving right along, may I have a motion to approve the meeting minutes from the July meeting of the Board of Education as presented? All those in favor, Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And Chair Boots? Aye.

[00:12:56] Okay, so we will move into our action and discussion items. That is first up, the item A. We will begin with the presentation from staff. So thank you, Dr. Sorenson and Ms. Mazikane. We are happy to have you with us today, and we will let you take it away.

[00:13:19] I just want to mention my thanks for this team. I think they've been in every corner of the state talking with educators, collaborating, and I've never seen such a responsive group of experts really thoughtfully take into consideration feedback and incorporate feedback from a variety of spaces. So I just thank you, Madam President. I would be remiss not to thank them for all of their hard work.

[00:13:54] Thank you. We do have a slide deck. I don't know if that's queued up or not. I'll see. I can start while he takes care of that because we definitely want to get started. Good morning, President Creasy, Vice President Hanson, Superintendent Coons, esteemed members of the board. My name is Tina Mazikane. I'm the K-12 Mathematics Coordinator at the Virginia Department of Education. Presenting with me today is Dr. Marcy Sorensen. She is the Deputy Superintendent

[00:14:30] of Teaching and Learning at the Department, and we are super pleased to be here today to present the proposed 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning for your final review. Before we begin, we would like to thank members of the board who took time to attend the 10 in-person and virtual Mathematics Standards of Learning public hearings that we helped to provide stakeholders the time and willingness to give their public comment.

[00:15:00] So we appreciate you all presiding over those hearings. This is an important process, and it's really a testament to the value that you all hold for public comment and being able to have feedback be a part of our standards revision process, and it really has been. I'd also like to take this time to thank the mathematics educators who have participated in the process, particularly those that served on our revision committees.

[00:15:24] their expertise and dedication to the work really has brought together a much stronger set of standards for the children across the Commonwealth. And today with us from our VDOE mathematics team is Deborah Delosier. She's a mathematics specialist for elementary. Kristen Williams-Foss, she is a mathematics and special education specialist. And then Dr. Jessica Brown, she is a mathematics and intervention specialist. So thank you ladies for being here. And I would I'd also like to thank you all for your hard work and dedication as well.

[00:15:59] Working on it. They're working on it. Okay, thank you.

[00:16:52] Can you guys go with that? Yeah, we can just keep going. Please. Absolutely. We can all pull it out. Okay, very good. The slides for those of you in the public are available on our website, so we apologize for the inconvenience.

[00:17:08] The draft documents have also been provided to the board and posted on the board's website, And those include both edits to the version that we brought before the board in June at first review, and also the now final approval kind of more clean copy.

[00:17:24] You'll see those are both available. And so today we're going to talk a little bit about guiding principles that have supported the work of the mathematics standards of learning. We'll give a summary and a little bit of an analysis of the public comment that we did receive regarding the draft that we took for public comment starting in June.

[00:17:43] then the description of the edits that were made to the standards. And then finally we're going to give you a little bit of an overview of what are the next steps once standards are approved what happens after that. So the proposed math standards of learning that will be presented today represent the best in class for all students in Virginia. The revisions to the standards involve the opportunity to collect public comment from a variety of stakeholders and by providing a clear and vertically coherent set of expectations to educators and families, the revisions to the standards will raise academic expectations for students and schools. Instruction based on

[00:18:22] rigorous academic content standards will ensure that every student has access to educational experiences that prepare them for post-secondary opportunities. The 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning established clear and coherent standards that allow for common expectations for proficiency for students, families, school staff, and assessment designers. So there are six guiding principles included in the Virginia 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning that represent the values and beliefs upon which the revised standards were created. Thank you. Preparing

[00:19:01] Virginia students to pursue higher education, to compete in a modern workforce, and to be informed citizens requires rigorous mathematical knowledge and skills. Students must gain an understanding of fundamental ideas in number sense, computation, measurement, geometry, probability, data analysis, statistics, algebra, and functions, and they must develop proficiency in those mathematical skills. So the first principle that guided this work was raise the floor, remove the ceiling. Mathematics education programs should have an expectation of creating

[00:19:35] and providing rigorous mathematics opportunities for all students. Successful programs challenge students to maximize their academic potential and provide consistent monitoring, support, and encouragement to ensure success for all. Opportunities should be provided to challenge, enhance, and extend students' mathematical knowledge and future learning opportunities.

[00:19:58] The second guiding principle is to ensure that every student builds strong mathematical foundational skills. Students must possess those strong foundational skills while also being able to apply them to real-world and contextual situations.

[00:20:13] Mathematics instruction must simultaneously develop students' conceptual understanding, computational fluency, and problem-solving skills. The development of related conceptual understanding and computation should be balanced and intertwined, and each supports the other and kind of reinforces learning.

[00:20:33] The third guiding principle is mastering critical content. understanding of prerequisite knowledge particularly in mathematics is critical for students to make connections and and to be able to learn what they're they're uh they're connecting to other content in in mathematics so just in time instructional supports can help prepare students for success in their current grade level by providing targeted support for the most critical prerequisite content for upcoming units of study so previous grade level concepts and skills are addressed but in the context of the current learning the fourth principle is integrating

[00:21:10] mathematics across all content areas it's important for students to make connections between mathematics and the world around them making these connections allow students to build on that prior knowledge that we just talked about and to relate concepts and procedures from different topics within mathematics and see math as an integrated field of study though the application of content and math process skills helps students they can make those connections better through those and among different areas of math like science and other areas and disciplines and also to real world context the fifth principle is to prepare math teachers to teach mathematics

[00:21:48] accurately and effectively to have great mathematics students we must have great mathematics teachers teaching math with understanding now allows now requires our teachers to have deep understanding of content and also how students learn mathematics to build that understanding of the content successful professional learning for teachers in math works best when it's focused on a classroom practice and can include components of coaching to form an ongoing level of support and the video plans to provide lots of support around professional learning and dr sorenson

[00:22:23] will be talking about that a little bit more later in the presentation the sixth principle is applying mathematics to better use technology the use of appropriate technology and the interpretation of the results from applying technology tools must be an integral part of teaching learning and assessment findings from several studies have shown that strategic use of technology tools can support both the

learning of the mathematics procedures and skills as well as developing more advanced mathematical proficiencies like problem solving reasoning and justification

[00:22:55] so we did have quite a bit of feedback as we went through this process and this slide shows kind of the three-pronged process of collecting feedback so the first level of the structure of feedback started back in 2022 when we began the revision process stakeholder feedback was collected beginning in february of 2022 and that was on the existing standards at that time so we collected a feedback on the 2016 standards for 30 days of open public comment we also had public engagement sessions at that time where we collected both in-person and virtual feedback

[00:23:35] held in may and june of 2022 next we we put together a committee that that formed the rough draft of the the 2023 mathematics standards and at that time we held both in-person and virtual meetings with specific groups of parents k-12 educators faculty from institutions of higher ed and business and community members and that was in november and december feedback then on the draft 2023 were also received from educators at several math conferences state math conferences we also conferred with several different experts to get some written feedback regarding the standards

[00:24:13] the final prong which has been the most recent prong of public comment began in june and we we began with online written feedback from the public and one way we provided that opportunity was through an online form we collected 159 submissions through that particular form process so the same person could submit more than one comment so we received 73 just general comments and then they could also submit more specific or grade level comments and there are 243 of those the video we

[00:24:49] also collected feedback just through email and we received 13 comments via email that were sent directly to the department. Additionally, the board held public hearings. Six virtual, four were in person during July and August. And at that time stakeholders could provide comments and those hearings were open to the public. So some folks just came and listened, others were able to give comment and we actually were able to coax a few people to actually speak that may not have actually been prepared to do it at that time but but it worked out really well so we were excited about

[00:25:22] that so we we do have also feedback from our mathematics education advisory committee they actually are a group of stakeholders that met four times during our revision process so they've kind of traveled this journey with us and they most recently met on august 15th following the public comment period so we were able to take the public comment the most recent public comment took that to them let them review it and then they gave us recommendations so there are five recommendations that directly relate to the content of the proposed mathematics standards

[00:25:59] of learning the first one was around data analysis and data science the the the committee recommended that the data science standards be concretely linked to existing content standards and in particular they felt that synthesizing data science standards within other standards of the course or connecting them more directly would be most helpful.

[00:26:21] They also provided feedback on Algebra I in middle school. The committee felt that developing guidelines for standards to compress grade seven and eight content to provide opportunities for acceleration would be important. They also felt that K-8 standards should remain distributed across those school years.

[00:26:39] The third recommendation was around technology and calculators. the committee recommended incorporating additional technology and continuing the use of calculators such as the desmos calculator currently used on our sol assessments in order to enhance understanding and to encourage calculator utilization as a valuable skill their fourth their fourth recommendation was around conceptual understanding and procedural fluency and they felt that there should be a blend of both of those in the standards and their fifth recommendation was about math process goals they recommended that the math process goals be embedded throughout the

[00:27:18] curriculum knowledge and skills where they belong with the mathematics we also looked at some recommendations from the fordham institute so this institute came from a report it's titled the state of state standards post common core and it was published in august 2018 and that particular report rated both english language arts and mathematics state standards across the united states based on content rigor clarity and specificity of the standards the report the report actually for virginia mathematics included several key recommendations but i wanted to

[00:27:57] highlight two of those that i felt would most kind of address some of the revisions we've made to our standards for 2023 the first recommendation that i wanted to highlight was that they recommended that we specify fluency expectations for multi-digit operations involving whole numbers and decimals and reference the standard algorithm as appropriate so our 23 math standards added more specificity around fluency expectations and recall of basic facts and as you see there's a couple examples on this slide where we've included grade two and four knowledge and skills that kind of shows that

[00:28:35] idea of incorporating the standard algorithm in addition references to the use of the algorithm has also been included in grades three and four so you can see in that first upper right box where we kind of included some examples right from the standards that have been revised the second recommendation by the fordham report was that they felt we should make conceptual understanding more explicit in the standards of learning revise and rearrange the the curriculum framework to reflect this emphasis on conceptual understanding and make explicit the coherence and the progression of the standards and that is really something that is very evident across many of the revisions

[00:29:15] that were made particularly rational numbers across grades two all the way through eighth grade we've really developed a more coherent progression for those particular concepts in representing equations and inequalities in context we've always had solving equations and inequalities in our grade six through eight and algebra one standards but we've really put more of an emphasis on the contextual component of how do we use those to actually solve real world problems and then explaining and justifying solutions you'll see across the the revised standards to help support problem solving so the structure of the standards really has built upon

[00:29:53] that vertical connectedness of math across the grade levels and across the courses and hopefully you'll be able to see that as you've looked through through the standards so um there were several different trends as we looked at public comment that we received we wanted to highlight one particular trend that we felt was important and really kind of did make several substantial edits to the the draft standards that we brought in june and so this particular slide shows some samples of the public comment that we received around algebra one geometry and algebra two

[00:30:28] and you'll see that as with many of the comments and there's comments uh you know about certain things for one you know side and one for the other so we tried to really look at all of the feedback

around algebra and geometry and really make some substantial changes and one of the biggest changes it was an algebra one they just felt that the content was very heavy but there was a lot of content in algebra one and and so there was much feedback about what could we change to make that better so we went back and kind of re-looked at things and in algebra one there was a standard that had been added on absolute value equations and inequalities. So that standard has been

[00:31:07] connected back to the Algebra 2 content and was removed from Algebra 1 from what you saw in the June draft. Again, there is absolute value functions related to that particular standard about equations and inequalities that also had that same switch made. And then there was an additional statistic standard in Algebra 1 that was added, and it was about univariate data being represented in histograms and being fitted with a smooth curve, and this is really kind of the prelude of normal distribution that they typically look at in Algebra 2, so what we do is we remove that standard. We took key components of that, and we connected it into the Algebra 2 standard to make

[00:31:47] it a little bit more robust, and the students would get that all at one time, so we also received quite a few comments about geometric instructions and the geometry standards, so we worked to go ahead and remove this the standard about constructions but we took those standards and we embedded them across the content where they most apply so for example students in geometry look at congruent triangles you probably remember doing that in geometry so they would take those constructions and constructions basically you take a ruler and a compass and you construct congruent angles or congruent sides to be able to understand the relationship between you know the congruent

[00:32:26] triangles so we've tried to embed that where it was most appropriate in the geometry standards so that's an example of how we've responded to public comment um in in the uh the final draft that's different from what you saw in june so i'm going to turn it over to dr sorenson she's going to address some of the next steps what happens after approved standards occur and i'm much shorter i'm going to have to move this thank you i move it down it's this five foot tall self

[00:33:00] good morning it's nice to see you thank you for the opportunity to present um so the other bucket of feedback was around implementation and so i want to stand before the board and talk about next steps and implementation so um we want to put out very transparently that videoe stands ready to support our educators in the field shoulder to shoulder as we implement best in class standards

[00:33:35] and so what you have before you is for 23 24 school year options for our school divisions option one being a full crosswalk year that once the board of education and makes the decision to approve the standards our school divisions can be all in with our support shoulder to shoulder making decisions that we're going to lean into these standards right now option two partial crosswalk here where we decide where are the essential learnings that our educators can lean

[00:34:09] in and say with these units with these standards here are spaces where our young people can get the best class standards right now and we're going to work with our educators and our school divisions to make decisions on where those high leverage points are option three is that they can take this as a full learning year and then dig in next year and so i want the board of education to be assured that we already have a transition team of educators there are 24 educators that are working with us right now we already have a transition team in place of educators in the field

[00:34:47] everywhere from prince william to essex to goochland to harrisonburg we've got folks from all over the commonwealth working with us on this transition team to help us develop what is needed in

terms of professional learning what is needed in terms of support what is needed in terms of making this transition so that we can best support our educators in the field as they make this transition for our students as they receive bus and class standards so we already have engaged through an application process and these 24 educators who have already met and to begin to

[00:35:26] do this work and around professional development around materials adoption around convening around calibration around rigor complexity and what is needed to support our educators to make this shift yes i have a quick question yes in terms of the option this is a district option or these yes the district will have the option the division i'm sorry the division will have the option to decide whether they want option one option two or option three and as soon as the board of education

[00:35:59] makes the decision to adopt and we are hosting you will see i'm sorry no just in the winchester session that was a common theme of just concern of the implementation timeline and um just i don't know if you had consistent commentary across the commonwealth or if it was in certain pockets of those who might be so we plan on having a webinar with our school divisions as soon as this is passed to walk them through their options and then school divisions will say i want this to be option three

[00:36:39] for us we really want to spend the year of learning really attending these webinars attending professional development being a part of this transition committee attending our regional hub learning labs that we're going to host across the commonwealth and we really just want to spend the year learning and that's going to be up to the school division to do that we are also going to have some school divisions that have already said to us we want in we want to start doing this work now so that we're ready for next year to really get in there and do our very best work next year

[00:37:16] with our young people and perfect our craft this year and then we've got some folks who say let's go halfway in and tell us where our space is in places for example in algebra where our teachers might struggle to make some of the shifts in practice so vdoe where are the essential shifts in practice where are the essential skills and knowledge so we're going to try these units out with guidance and so we're going to go with option two and that's going to be up to them and where they are but we want to be shoulder-to-shoulder partners as they make those decisions and support

[00:37:54] them in those decision-making processes thank you absolutely dr siever um i have a couple of things I want to get to but while we're on this particular subject on option two key content my hunch is and hoping y'all can affirm this for me as part of that key content will be what things are changing in terms of sequence across grade levels because I think that that for for divisions that are too leaning toward option three they are still going to want to not have children disadvantaged and have it very very clear what content is moving places so that so I think you're nodding that

[00:38:29] And that makes me feel good about that, and I appreciate the support we talked to previous meetings and encourage the superintendent and the team to really think about the support for implementation. Because again, like Mr. Hanson, most feedback I've heard has been about the speed of implementation. But even the folks getting that concern are people saying these new standards are really good.

[00:38:47] So we really don't want to wait a whole year for kids to benefit from them. But there's concern about invitation, especially again at the elementary level. key content provision, including whatever's changing, moving from grade levels so children don't miss out, I think, would be key on that topic. I don't want to mess up the slides again, so can you drive for me? Absolutely. And so I wanted to also show the

board just a very high level professional development plan in terms of webinars to engage, but also being out in the

[00:39:20] field, you know, showing exemplars and instructional guides, really being out in the field in terms of regional support hubs, engaging with not only central office folks and chief academic officers and executive directors of, but teachers, department chairs, and really saying, okay, so let's bring together our knowledge around where the standards shifting, how are they moving in terms of grade level but also understanding coherence around what does rigor mean as we define the standards themselves right it's one thing to just use the word rigor but what

[00:40:00] does that mean as we talk about amplifying foundational skills what does that mean and so we want to get clear with our educators across the commonwealth so that students across the commonwealth are getting the same when we say all we mean all so i wanted to just give a graphic but But also wanted to really highlight that we're going to differentiate our professional development.

[00:40:22] We know that there are some school divisions that have robust staff, and we also know that there are some that don't. And so we know that we're going to have to differentiate our professional development and our support. So we're willing to be, again, boots on the ground, out in the field, doing what we need to do, not only from Richmond, but out in the field and supporting our educators with them in classrooms if that's where we need to be in order to make sure that the support is there as folks are doing the instructional work.

[00:40:57] Next. So then additional supports. We really want to lean into helping people understand what assessment will look like as we move into that realm. And we want to provide exemplars. And to your point, Dr. Siebert, around what does that look like and how does that translate to instruction?

[00:41:17] And we want to talk about intervention and acceleration, right? As we talk about learning loss, we know that we're going to have to address both ends of the spectrum. we know that we have students who are going to need support in order to get there so what are the scaffolds and support that instructors are going to need in order to help our students then accelerate so what does that look like and we're there to help we want to communicate with parents and community about what these standards not only mean but how do they help partner with us so how do we empower our parents and our community members and we also are going to

[00:41:55] deeply engaged around special needs students and our english language learners and so that professional development will be embedded into the professional development that we do so that not only are our general education teachers armed and prepared and ready to support but that it is a comprehensive effort and and also we want to make sure that our standards of quality language is very clear around acceleration for our school divisions yes walton thank you mark marcy for this

[00:42:30] useful uh presentation the under intervention and acceleration resources and your soq reference is there an anticipation what's the department's assessment of whether there will be additional resource needs at the division level for intervention and acceleration do they need more financial support and if so what's the department's assessment of how we're going to go about addressing that um i think as we work with our educators right now through our transition team we're listening and we're learning and we're hearing what the needs are um part of it i think

[00:43:10] will be addressed through instruction um and i think we will listen and learn and hear what the the needs are. And then we will make proposals if need be. I know Dr. Coons wants to address this as well. If I can just for clarity, I am seeing that we have a letter from the Virginia ASCD that just came into our public comment last day or two, eager to help with implementation and very supportive of the standards changes and raising questions about resources, suggesting that

[00:43:47] particularly things like benchmarking to NAEP, et cetera, is going to require interventions, tutoring, summer camp, et cetera. We have several active RFPs for statewide tutoring content, statewide tutoring support, in statewide tutoring resources for our school divisions when those RFPs close we'll be able to share more actively the learning acceleration intervention plan for the department and how

[00:44:21] we'll be supporting school divisions we agree 100 with that and are actively procuring resources to support school divisions thank you and how about the summer piece is that is there going to be money for the divisions to do address that that would depend on budget decisions miss holton i would just encourage the board as we think about our soq language and the department as you think about your budget recommendations up the chain that we you know essentially if we're trying to do something almost analogous to the literacy act here in numeracy one of the beauties of

[00:44:59] the literacy act is it was comprehensive and included resources and this looks like work that at least from what we're hearing from the field, requires resources as well to do right. Thank you. And to your point, we want to make sure that we are supporting our educators instructionally as they make transitions to more rigorous standards. So if you could, next slide.

[00:45:30] And so really wrapping up and really wanting to hit the home run is here in the Commonwealth, we really just want to summarize with that our standards are best in class and they're some of the most challenging across the nation. And they are benchmarked, Ms. Holton, to your point, to the NAEP, ACT, SAT. And we really do want to ensure that our young people across the Commonwealth are getting the best and that we are supporting our educators as they make the transition. Our standards do strongly reinforce the foundational skills and facts to ensure that

[00:46:07] our students can accelerate at their own pace. And we want to make sure that our students have really strong foundations. I can tell you, as somebody who spent quite a bit of time in secondary education, that when they arrive in secondary and they do not have strong foundations, they really do struggle. And so it is very important that we do get that right at the front end with our young people. And the approach taken in these standards ensures that students can apply mathematical concepts in their college and career pathways and advance right and move forward and live the lives

[00:46:44] that we all dream for them and that they dream for themselves and we want to be able to actualize that through the standards and standards are designed to ensure mastery from grade to grade providing an opportunity for students to demonstrate competency before they move on to the next skill We want to be able to measure that. We want to be able to ensure that they do have the ability to do what it is that we're asking them to do.

[00:47:10] And the only way to be able to do that, I think, to this board's point in terms of implementation is to support our very hardworking educators in the field and really partner with them to make sure that they are equipped to do the very hard work that we're asking them to do.

[00:47:24] So I appreciate your time. I appreciate your consideration. And without taking any more time, the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education approve these revised math standards of learning to be fully implemented, and then authorize the VDOE to make the technical edits, if need be, for the 24-25 school year. Thank you very much. Are there any further questions?

[00:47:56] And thank you. You've answered one of my two questions and I have a couple of comments. One, I want to echo the kudos to the team and the outreach that was undertaken. And I really think that even the online piece, it was a really good approach. And so very, very, very impressive and kudos everybody for that.

[00:48:13] I have a conversation and the feedback I've received recently, questions about, you know, process for the front matter, but that was coupled with the fact that it's quite good and that there's some really sound things in there. So hopefully, you know, in the category of technical edits, even what I provided is considered technical.

[00:48:35] The question sort of gets into the idea of division choice. And so I appreciate you addressing that in the key standards piece. kudos for picking up on different divisions will need different things i'm not talking about deep surveys and vetting the response and all that but let the divisions tell you in advance what they want so you can find out who's using option one option two option three or some sort of a hybrid and and i think that will vary by the size of district and and rural ones are probably one different level of support so kudos for for that as well um the the again i'm an old science teacher

[00:49:08] so i i have math teacher friends i'm never quite invited into the clubhouse but um you know i i i so the feedback i got was in the change of the introduction um what was kind of lost was a lot of those definitions and tina touched on the importance of the pd piece that um that is very important and and some of my math friends said some of those definitions have been very helpful in the past and lift up computational fluency in particular as a really important tenet uh that was was there. So my question is, do we feel, has the MEAC weighed in on this? Do we think those definitions are institutional knowledge now and so they don't need to be in the standards or we

[00:49:47] can reference them in an appendix? But those kind of definitions that were in their previous introduction, I heard that there's some value to many of those. I think that we're going to still look at putting it in an appendix. And as we look to create instructional guides, we will make sure that there is clarity and coherence around mathematical terminology so that again no matter where you are in the commonwealth there is coherence and understanding so that all children across the commonwealth are getting the same level of rigor and complexity so that all educators

[00:50:22] understand what we mean by that I think that'd be appreciated thank you absolutely so what I'd like to do is if there are questions I would like to have them answered by Dr. Sorensen if it is a comment i would like to reserve that after a motion has been made please miss holton thank you i'll reiterate everybody else's thanks and i did have the opportunity to participate in several of the public comment hearings and the thoroughness of the work you all have done

[00:50:59] on content is remarkable and your outreach has been terrific i have a question for you tina about process uh i a lot of the language in the preamble the guiding principles and the implementation section are uh new to me as of last week i think they are new to the public as well as of last week and so i have a process had any of that content been shared for instance with the meak the draft guiding principles uh were they part of your discussion with meak in on august at the august

[00:51:35] of 23 meeting the guiding principles and or the implementation section was that documentation provided to them for feedback at the time that we met with the meack it was the 15th of august so they really looked at the public comment that was their big focus at that point we had not completed all of the edits to the uh the draft from june so they did not see um some of those edits that have been made so am i right that those guiding principles the language and guiding principles and the implementation section that they're that that's new content that some of it

[00:52:10] is built upon what was in the original june um version and some of it was revised and edited so what i would just say is that i'm i we have had a attorney general's documentation what is the question i have no question as to the legality of our going forward today the attorney general's question. I saw an opinion. I did see that. I'm completely satisfied that this board has the authority to adopt all of this today, including the preamble material. But that's a different

[00:52:45] question from the wisdom of doing so. And we do have one public comment from the ASCD suggesting that we separate out the preliminary material from the standards themselves. And that's something we can discuss if there's an interest when we get to the discussion. But my question is to understand whether those materials have been, I think public comment is because we want to hear from the public, we want their feedback. And so I want to hear what the public had a chance, what the MEAC as a one voice from the public had an opportunity to review. That was the nature of

[00:53:24] my question. So, so no, they didn't have a chance to see any of this language, uh, among other edits as well. I would say that the language may, maybe no, but the general principles of the, that are incorporated there are certainly part of what the larger standards document represents. Um, so I'll save anything further I have on that for the, uh, comments, uh, um, time. Uh, thank you. Um, and if I

[00:53:52] just one one further um question is um the um oh textbook provisions um this wasn't ready or swanson yeah i'm happy to answer yeah whoever this wasn't raised by anybody in the uh uh public comment and so i'm guessing there must be an answer that i'm not understanding but it's just my experience in the past and i think it's mandated by code that we revise that we go through a process of procurement for new textbooks revised consistent with the standards and i'm guessing

[00:54:31] that the math folks who know more math than me which is basically all of you have some understanding of how this is going to work but normally that's a process that goes forward over to it that the commercial producers of the textbooks need some time to revise their textbooks consistently to meet our standards and then it's a matter of two or three months of meetings for us to review them and then adopt them and then the local school division so i'm seeing you know what might be a six eight month process between now and when a school division would be putting in a purchase

[00:55:08] order for new textbooks help me how how is that going to happen absolutely i think that's a very legitimate question and and thank you for asking um which is why we started working with our educators already. We knew that this implementation process would be important to our educators in the field as we know what a lift this work is. And we know how important shifts in instruction are, especially when we're asking our educators who are already working so hard to make any shift in practice. And so we've already got, again, like I said, 24 educators in the field giving us input

[00:55:46] on what they need and so that would include the potential for new materials right and so um have we engaged in textbook conversation with textbook publishers yet absolutely not because our standards haven't been adopted or approved by our board of education but we have worked with our

educators to say what do you need and so we are getting input again from educators across the field to say our new materials a part of that and if so then we will take it upon ourselves to engage with

[00:56:20] publishers and and and and then it will be part of that engagement process um but at this point we're just learning from our educators what what they need um in order to make these shifts and then i think as dr siebert said really learning who's going through option one option two option three so that we can support the field for implementation just to follow up um thank you that makes perfect sense as the place to start i'm hoping you will also look at the procurement rules of course absolutely and um what i guess my question would be can you come back to us in

[00:56:58] september or hopefully no later than october with a timeline you know do we absolutely maybe maybe we don't need to do textbook revisions maybe the the textbooks are i mean i understand a lot of these standards are based on national organization standards. So maybe the textbooks are already there. But if they're not already there, how are we going to get them there in the time?

[00:57:20] Because I do expect you will hear from the educators that they do use textbooks in the math. Absolutely. So, so thank you. And we're going to have to come back after that'd be great. Absolutely. And whether that's part of a board meeting or in writing, I'm comfortable either way.

[00:57:35] absolutely thank you further questions okay seeing none uh can i have a motion from the board to approve the proposed revised mathematics standards of learning on final review and authorize the virginia department of education to make any final clarifying or technical edits so moved second okay miss kilgore how do you vote oh sorry let's take discussion excuse me let's do that i'm trying to move us along too quickly would anyone like to make a

[00:58:15] comment regarding the proposed mathematics standards like one clip president dr siebert one clarifying comment so i appreciate the differentiation i think you talked about the regions and the rurals i think the other level of differentiation will be probably elementary middle and high i think even in some small one high school districts they probably have pretty strong math departments that will roll up their sleeves and do great work but the elementary teachers this school year in particular are justifiably focused on virginia literacy act and a host of other things so i think that that there even some districts that might say are

[00:58:50] our secondary teachers are need this level of support i my heart is my former elementary principal self is is still concerned about the elementary teacher implementation i do think these standards are excellent and i think they're going to be very very good so i don't want to slow down implementation but um i'm concerned about my elementary friends all go ahead mr rotherham you've been on a roll i yield to my colleague so uh i'll reiterate my support for

[00:59:24] the content standards if the board if there was a willingness among board members to uh consider severing the front matter uh pursuant to the request from vascd i would be amenable to that but i won't make the motion unless there's support for it i am concerned and i think the basis for separating the front material is the fact that the public parents educators administrators have not had an opportunity and it may well be that for instance i'm sure those guiding principles are

[01:00:01] are uh reflective of what's embedded in the standards but i'm just not competent to evaluate that i was i was good in math all the way through high school um but the amount of math i've forgotten since then is uh greater than well greater than we can all imagine and i can't evaluate whether those

guiding principles uh are uh whether there's anything of concern in them or not and i do see the vascd folks raise some concerns about it so for that i'm i'm a big believer in transparency

[01:00:35] and process and our we always traditionally share important language with the public for feedback in some fashion or another and had this language all been in the first version that we saw back in june or otherwise shared with the public before five days ago basically i'd feel more comfortable adopting it that said it's just a process objection and if the board is if there's not a sentiment in favor of severing that content i won't make the motion

[01:01:08] there is one other area i want to two other areas i want to address one is the the language on i'm looking at the red line version or purple line version so on page 11 of the purple line version there's language setting out what the state board of education will do there's language about four years of credit bearing math experiences for graduation requirements and there's language about aligning that seems to suggest aligning our cut scores to nape proficiency i i would just say

[01:01:45] those may well be things that we can and should do at some point as a board but they in my view would need to be there's a lot of context including resources that would need to be addressed before that would make sense and that the cut scores in particular, realigning the cut scores to proficiency would require being part of an overall review, overall relook at accountability and accreditation, which I know the board is embarking on. But I would just say I am comfortable voting for the standards, even though that language gives me pause because my conversations,

[01:02:24] including conversations with the superintendent helped me understand that language to be aspirational non-specific and non-binding on this board so you know we can't bind ourselves for instance to making changes in the graduation requirements here because those are embedded in regulation and there's a whole process for changing regulations so some of the matters may even touch on things that are embedded in statute so understanding that they're non-binding I am raising them up for attention, but not but comfortable voting for the document as a whole, if that's how it goes forward.

[01:03:01] And my final point would be I just think that the ambitious plans for implementation are terrific. I think these standards should be implemented. They're good quality standards. And we do need to, frankly, all across the United States, we need to raise our content standards on math.

[01:03:21] And I think these, or raise our student outcomes on math. And I think these content standards will help on that. But I think the implementation plan is aggressive.

[01:03:38] And if we can pull it off, great. I'm hoping we can have regular reports and revisit if need be if we fall behind on the things that are crucial to make it the most important thing is a successful implementation and let's not let haste interfere with that and with with respect to that there's just one more thing I'll note that I'm hoping we can hear from the board on and hear from staff on at future meetings and that is at least theoretically the history standards should be being implemented before the math standards right they're a year ahead of the math standards in our seven-year cycle of evaluation and were

[01:04:18] adopted back in the spring and we haven't heard anything more since then and we definitely don't want to have a pile on for our divisions um with literacy act math standards history standards all being implemented at the same time but on the other hand i don't want all the good hard work that we on the board and the public and many many engaged groups did on the history standards to be forgotten and

so you know in theory those standards should be implemented a year before math and so at some point i hope we can hear from the department about what are the plans for history

[01:04:52] standard implementation and um i i i know the superintendent is is thinking hard about how we integrate that into the plan and hoping we can hear from that at a future meeting thank you Madam President. Yes, Mr. Sturdifant.

[01:05:12] First, I want to thank the staff for all the hard work they constantly do. They've put a lot of time and effort into it, and I definitely value their work and their expertise. I also like the comments from Ms. Holton.

[01:05:27] She brings a lot of information to the board. In this case, I would not support her recommendation for severing. written i think we should keep it as one as a whole and move forward uh without delay thank you madam president mr rotherham uh yes i have a couple of things first of all yeah thank you all these are uh this is great it's it's been a lot of work i know um uh and appreciate and i think what's particularly gratifying is when you send this out to people in the field you know national leaders and are like hey on this issue and like hey here's what we're doing like what do you think the feedback has been particularly after some of the revisions and the feedback the feedback's just

[01:06:06] been terrific and that's and that's great to see um uh yeah i'm not in favor of severing the front matter as i said when we did history i think every one of these should have a front matter and i think the reason for that is you should have to sort of show your work i think it's important that this is anchored in here's what why these are best practices here's um you know where this relates to sat act i think we should always have to do that rather than just hear these things that somebody just came up with so i i would like to see us extend this we should i think we should do the same thing when we get when we get to english um i think i think format is important i'm under no illusions that students across the commonwealth are going to peruse this but i do

[01:06:44] also think it's good that it says here's why this is important here's why this matters these are not you know a common question when you talk to kids as they say why you know why do i have to learn this or do this and i think it's important to put in this as this document does here's why this actually this actually um matters so um i like all that i do have one quibble like again i'm going to support it i'm not going to vote against i'm not thrilled with where we landed on some of the language under what the board will do for a different reason um than my colleague it seems like again we are sort of shifting the emphasis off of schools back on to who knows why kids might

[01:07:19] not be achieving i would be much more comfortable with 3a if it said a clear picture of how every school is or is not ensuring that every child is making progress because we have gaps that emerge as kids go through school not just by race in math by gender i mean we either have to believe there's something in the water in this commonwealth or there's stuff that is happening or not happening that is impacting that um we're all familiar also obviously with the socioeconomic gaps and i think like it behooves us just to call that out plainly particularly in light of the presentations we're

[01:07:55] going to have later in the day with our challenges and just to be forthright about it um uh and name that and it's just because that's you know that is a key part of of what we're going to try to do it's a key part of the issue so i just want to call attention to that and also and this is going to sound like like picky and wordsmithing but we say we're going to redesign the state accountability system i would submit we don't actually have an accountability system right now to redesign we have an accreditation system and then so

we should probably say we're going to design an accountability system that's going to take those things in and i mean again i don't want to be like language guy but i do think like you know i could i sort of come down on the orwell side of things

[01:08:30] specificity and language particularly political language matters um and so i i i want to call those those two uh those two issues out if we could i would be happier if we could say how every school is or is not and we could say design not uh redesign happy to offer an amendment if there's sufficient support and i just ask that might be just simply clarifying in nature that's up to you ma'am president can i ask what where is the the is or is not 3a oh so under state board of education will so on the non red line version it's page six okay and it's under which of the state board will

[01:09:07] number three okay thank you so exactly like design rather than redesign and then just add how every school is or is not ensuring i mean it's aspirational that every school is ensuring this and we're going to show that but i think when you look at the data that is it is hard to make the case that that is where we are today any further discussion dr northern i'll just be on the bandwagon that these are exceptional standards thank you for all the hard work thank you for including the standard algorithm which is something that is so critical for kids in elementary school because if you don't know your standard algorithms you're going to be counting

[01:09:47] on your fingers the rest of your life um if you don't have the standard algorithm you've got parents going what is this discovery math my kids are learning um and you've got a lot of confusion so that was a huge improvement and as a person who's looked at math standards all across the country i will say that that is the biggest weakness of state standards across the country when they do not establish that firm foundation elementary school so the procedural uh the computational fluency the the understanding the melding of of what you guys have done is um is

[01:10:22] is very impressive and the way that you've taken feedback uh into consideration so kudos um i'm also could quibble with some of this language in the front matter um i like my colleague here i don't like to quibble but i could have some quibbles um i certainly do not want that to stand in the way of what i consider to be exceptional standards and um and we use the phrase best in class a lot around here but i really do believe that these standards merit

[01:10:55] that description so thank you i also want to echo the board and and the staff's work on this i just want to also recognize the courage it takes to raise standards when we know our scholars are so far behind particularly in math when it comes to the pandemic and so i think it's the right time the right action to keep expectations i love the raise the floor um while removing the ceiling and i really appreciate the timeline around the options of execution because each division will

[01:11:30] definitely need something different um i would though want to make sure that there is a timeline around when all divisions will be able to adopt them and appreciate the time that's going to take to make sure that curriculum and resources are there for teachers and division heads but uh the gaps in math are just enormous then we know this but raising the standards now so that we can make sure that all scholars have the chance to be successful is incredibly important so thank you

[01:12:03] dr saver i support mr rotherham's uh revision language i think is or is not it's fine i think most are but i'm i'm good with that um i think if that's technical that's great also i do hope in other categories technical the i don't know if the appendix of the definitions would fall in that category or not but i think that would be appreciated uh by the pd leaders in the field mr hansen yeah just likewise i um i think the

guiding principles i commend the team for putting those together i've read through them and i think they're perfectly aligned to the content of what

[01:12:40] uh is in the standards going out and um i just don't see any issue with not uh moving those forward with the standards today and also handy i support both your tweaks uh as well i think they're both important for us to make and again thank you for your time trekking across the commonwealth and just also just for the substance of what we have before us it's uh i think uh ms ashton's comment it's uh will be very helpful to us as we try to get our students where they

[01:13:17] need to be and to both catch up but then speed ahead so thank you if there's nothing further i would just say before um we call for the vote here um i have been extremely impressed with the work that this team has done um i think that's probably because math is definitely over my head i am not a mathematician nor am i a math scholar but i will tell you that the team certainly came approached this opportunity with the revision of the math standards with a deep desire that all

[01:13:56] students find a love of math or at least feel like they can be successful in mathematics and we know that it is so critical that our students have some kind of ownership and some kind of positive feeling around their ability to do math. Because so many in the past, I being one of them, didn't feel successful in math. And that really tainted sometimes my view of school.

[01:14:27] And so the more that we can give kids the opportunity to feel successful and have a positive outcome i just think these standards are absolutely directed uh to that end and it's it's really wonderful to see from somebody who's not a math person so um all that being said oh yes ma'am please i wanted to add i wanted to echo what everyone has said and as you just stated my background was not math that was not my strength as a but as a former educator you know even though i didn't teach mathematics i was always having to i feel like to send it in the classroom when

[01:15:06] somebody was complaining about their math class whatever class they were taking and trying to explain to them that yes they did need it and yes there were reasons it was relative to their lives in the future and so i want to commend and i came late to the game coming in july so i'm not as familiar with all the hard work you've done but i can only imagine how difficult this has been and i'm impressed with how you've brought in you know educators from all over the state and have their input which that's what matters um they have a they have an ownership to it and i appreciate that

[01:15:38] so thank you for all your work anything else okay miss kilgore how do you vote yes miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr sturdifan hi mr rotherham hi

[01:16:09] and chair votes aye okay um now i thank you team congratulations thank you so we have a a switch to make here yes can we take a five minute break as we prepare for the next uh

[01:16:28] presentation thank you would you like to introduce our guests good morning very excited to have this

[01:28:26] um launch today we um have been talking about achievement and accountability and what that should look like along with our accreditation system so i am so excited to have chad with us chad alderman has spoken to the board several times but chad is here today to guide us through our conversations around accountability and accreditation last month during our retreat you asked for a lot of presentations a lot of national feedback on a variety of different things

[01:29:01] and so really excited to have chad here i'm going to let chad launch us into our opening discussion and then i'll interview the rest our interview introduce i am not interviewing today i will introduce um the rest of our experts as we go through presentations today so very excited um to turn it over to Chad.

[01:29:24] - Great. Thank you, Dr. Coons. So for those of you who don't know, I'm Chad Alderman. I am an independent contractor, but my experience, I worked with the U.S. Department of Education on accountability back when there were no child left behind waivers. I worked at Bellwether with Mr. Rotherham for a while and led a independent review process on the ESSA state plans.

[01:29:44] And I've continued to research and write about accountability as well. I'm gonna hope to play a moderator, facilitator role today and keep us on track. There are a lot of pieces of accountability, a lot of questions that we'll have to get to eventually. Today, we're going to try to focus on sort of the building blocks, the indicators that will go into the system.

[01:30:02] And I'm just going to stand here with Chad because this is actually my slide today. And very excited to talk about where we've been because you started this process way before I got here and had lots of conversations in October and November of 2022 about the North Star and what you were trying to accomplish.

[01:30:21] you really talked about having high expectations for every student's proficiency proficiency definitions set by benchmarking against the demands of virginia employers in higher education you talked a lot about transfer transparency i cannot speak today transparency and access to actionable information as a hallmark of this new system you've talked a lot about growth and proficiency both as vital measures but a system that prioritizes getting every student to proficiency. You also talked about the purpose of accountability and that the purpose of

[01:30:57] accountability is to bring trust to schools, parents, and students through a transparent, concrete, and easy to understand reporting system. And finally, you talked about how important stakeholder input was and that this was critical. I've really had the opportunity in my first four and a half months to meet with superintendents, to meet with principals, to meet with teachers, to meet with various stakeholders, and really listen to what they wanted. As a matter of fact, we met with VAS eight different times in their regions. Then we had weekly meetings for a month

[01:31:33] with our superintendents to hear what they really wanted to see. We had the opportunity to have principals give feedback, and we had the opportunity to really think through our regional teachers. So excited that we are in a place today, in August, for you to really look at those pieces of the accountability system or accreditation and where you're going with that i think at the last meeting the conversation moved from accreditation to an accountability system as mr rotherham spoke about during the math presentation and thinking about those components so today you will see a

[01:32:11] presentation on growth you will see a presentation on achievement and a presentation on readiness and career readiness as requested those are all being done by national experts my apologies i thought chad had presented prior to um this meeting and um miss creasy told me madam chair president that you have not heard from chad so very excited to have chad as our moderator chad has extensive experience in a variety of spaces and can really help guide our conversations today we want to to make sure this is really about board voice. Our hope is that in September 2023, that the board

[01:32:51] adopts new accountability measures and metrics so that we can start to build those metrics out during October through May. And then in June and July, we finalize that accountability system and fully implement the accountability system in 24-25. So that is our hopeful timeline. That is our aspirational timeline, today is critical for us moving forward with that September approval.

[01:33:16] So very excited to dig in, very excited to turn this conversation over to Chad and his expertise and allow us to guide through the conversations today. So I'm going to turn it back over to Chad. Right. So I'm going to remind us why we're all here. We're going to learn more about the opportunities that Dr. Kuhn's mentioned on growth, achievement, and career readiness indicators.

[01:33:45] And then we're gonna discuss and gather inputs that will inform recommendations. You all on the board have seen these slides before. This is about the NAIT Achievement Scores, the National Assessment of Educational Progress. Virginia has suffered particularly large declines in the 2022 assessment year in math and reading.

[01:34:07] I'm sorry, before you go to the next slide, I have a question. yeah thank you Mr. Olderman for for being with us today and I look forward to hearing from you and all this terrific expertise in the room uh I'm just clarifying these are the fourth grade slides is what you've got here is that right right these are the fourth grade um math reading math on the left uh reading reading on the left and math on the right thank you and am I correct that the eighth grade would show a similar drop from 19 to 22 but would show that we are still above

[01:34:41] average in reading and significantly above average in math uh i don't know that off the top of my head but that sounds correct yeah the the point really is to show like we are falling behind where we were and uh we want to get back on track particularly for lower performing students so this is the nape fourth grade reading i sliced it by percentiles so nape provides it by different levels this is the 10th percentile is the lower performing the red the higher performing is the 90th percentile in light the darker gray and then the median the 50th percentile is the light gray

[01:35:20] and so there's just a distribution problem as well it's not that the state as a whole is declining but we're uh declining particularly for the students that are the farthest behind so we're having larger achievement gaps over time um unfortunately virginia's accreditation system is barely picking up on these NAEP trends. So the accreditation system in 2019-20 found 93% of schools fully accredited. In 2022-23 had 90% of schools fully accredited. And in neither year were there any school that had their accreditation denied. I think part of that is also there's a

[01:35:57] couple reasons for that. One which we can get into is some of the specific indicators in the accreditation system some of the choices to include the inputs of schools in addition to outcomes and then also the stakes involved there are stakes involved with how we define schools that are unaccredited and so i think that all feeds into some of these issues so uh i'm we're going to talk today about bifurcating these two systems accreditation system would still exist and would still measure the inputs there are lots of things in the virginia code about accreditation and what it includes everything from summer school to enrichment

[01:36:37] activities to teacher quality facilities etc and those will still stay but we're proposing or talking today about the accountability system so how do we measure outcomes and hold schools and set guidelines for what we want schools to accomplish with the students just to say a brief word about accountability as a whole accountability matters there's quite a bit of research suggesting that how schools

and the sort of what is measured matters as well as what happens in the long run so there's just a new study out recently from the national bureau of economic research showing that

[01:37:13] the system that south carolina put in place in the year 2000 had short-term impacts so in terms of graduation rates and academics for those students but they also had long-term outcomes so students who were in schools that were identified that needed to improve, they did. The schools improved, the kids got better in the short term, and they had long-term effects as well. So lower incarceration rates for those kids in their 20s and 30s, as well as higher earnings in the long run. So

[01:37:46] what we're talking about today has very long-lasting impacts. What we're not going to talk about today is some of the final determinations. There are lots of choices that we can still make about what we're going to talk today about what goes into the system. And then over time, we're going to talk about what to do once we figure out what goes into it. But it doesn't have to be some of what's called a summative rating system. So there are some states that use an A through F grading system. Virginia used to use one. But this is an example of there are other states that handle it differently. This is an example from Indiana. And what they do is they

[01:38:26] have a very clear transparent system for each of their accountability indicators. They have a dashboard approach to say, here's a school performance. Here's what it looks like. And so Virginia would also have choices about how both on the indicator side and then once we decide on what goes into the system and what result is as well. We talked some already in the earlier discussion this morning as well as Dr. Coons mentioned some of the guiding principles but the North Star is high expectations for every student that means that every student can achieve every

[01:39:01] student we want to show that they can achieve and there are different ways to accomplish that we want the system to be transparent and accessible and actionable so giving people information that they actually can use in their lives whether that's parents whether that's teachers and educators student economic growth and proficiency are both important measures so we want to know whether students are meeting a bar we also want to know if they're well behind the bar are they progressing towards that bar over time purpose of accountability is to send a message about what matters from a

[01:39:36] state it's also to build trust between schools parents and students through transparent concrete and easy to understand principles and reporting stakeholder input is critical so we we are designing the system in a vacuum we want to make sure that folks are coming along with us along the way so we've already done a little bit of preview i'll just say a little bit more that we're going to talk about the building blocks of the indicators that will go into the system we're going to start this morning talking about growth and student growth measures we have a presentation from katrina miller from sas this afternoon we'll turn into a conversation about achievement and how to

[01:40:14] measure that in accountability systems and then we'll talk about readiness and career readiness as well. With that, I'm going to turn it over to Katrina Miller from SAS, and we will launch into the conversation. Good morning. I'm going to share from my screen. Just in case you have other questions, I can pop over into some live things. All right. Like Chad said, my name is

[01:40:51] Katrina Miller. I work for the SAS Institute. I'm a lifelong educator. I've been at SAS for seven years, but prior to that, I worked at CCSSO, where I provided technical assistance to states on a variety of policy decisions, including using student growth and making decisions around actionable data. I also worked at the state of Tennessee, where I helped write a race to the top grant, and then oversaw part of its

implementation. So this is very common to me, board meetings, and I'm excited to be back in front of a board making great policy decisions for students.

[01:41:23] At SAS, we're a large global company, and I'll tell you a little bit about who we are, but More importantly is we have over 200 individuals dedicated to using data and analytics to improve student outcomes. 85 of those individuals are specifically dedicated to student growth and have spent their career, some of whom have been in the field for over 30 years, researching student growth measures, applying them in the field, and helping educators make better decisions for students. But it's backed up by a company that is known worldwide and is really a leader in data and analytics and even the new buzzword, artificial intelligence, which we've been doing since the 1970s, even though most of us have only heard about it recently. You may not

[01:42:02] have heard of SaaS, but we touch your everyday lives. If you're on Amazon, like I am ordering things because I'm on the road a lot, and you get those lovely recommendations, that's SaaS software behind it predicting that you may likely buy this. That type of information, analytics, and intelligence is what fuels our education work as well. Education has been historically behind in using data and analytics, and we really try to bring that expertise into the education space. Both of our owners are former faculty members, so we're really dedicated to education and improving the lives of students across our country. Today, we're going to talk about EVOS, which is our solution around

[01:42:40] student growth. We've been doing this at SAS for over 20 years. Currently, we have 13 states using this in a statewide level, which allows us to have over 15 million student records in our system and apply these analytics to this and give access to our reporting and analytics to over 425 educators. What's really important about this is that we try to make it easy to use and provide actionable data into the hands of educators to help improve student learning.

[01:43:08] And that's what I hope to talk to you about today. Not only about using this in an accountability system to make sure your accountability system is trustworthy and transparent and fair, but also that the accountability system can really be used for school improvement into advanced student learning here are the states that we're currently providing this type of data in and the gray states are where it's used in their accountability system in ohio pennsylvania tennessee and north carolina they've used evos in their accountability system as their student growth measure for over a decade and i know some of the papers that you all read previous to this discussion and as you've looked

[01:43:42] at accountability systems you've looked at some of those states so i want to start with grounding us in some overarching principles. The information that we provide through student growth is using your statewide summative assessment data, your SOLs. We can incorporate a variety of student tests, including K-2 tests, high school and of course exams, all the way up to ACT and SAT.

[01:44:05] So I really want to differentiate between growth and achievement and think about why they're both critically important to understanding students' success. So I want to start with this first group of students. And if you think about the students, you get their SOLs at the end of the year and they're above that proficiency line. We should celebrate. This group of students is doing well.

[01:44:25] But what if I told you at the beginning of the year, they were actually much higher than that proficiency line? And so over the course of the year, their proficiency declined. A straight proficiency rating or achievement level is not going to tell you that information. On the flip side of that, you have these students who began the year or ended the year right under proficiency.

[01:44:48] So it's something we still need to work on. We want all of our kids to be proficient in math reading reading and doing math on grade level but if you think about where those students began at the beginning of the year and you look at that change over time the school and divisions that these students were in actually had a great impact on their learning and helped those students progress over the year this is why we need to have achievement we need to know whether students are proficient or not but we have to pair that with growth to understand the impact of schools and divisions on student learning and student progression in a given year and over time simply

[01:45:27] put, student achievement is looking at if a student's reached a targeted proficiency level by the end of the school year. Student growth is looking at if students grew at the same rate compared to other students who took that same assessment in that same year. These things paired together really allow you to get the true impact of a school and a division on student learning.

[01:45:52] But there are a lot of ways of measuring student growth. Here are probably the five best well-known student growth measures from simple gain all the way to EVOS or VVOS which is what it's called in Virginia and they really lie a lot along a spectrum of model complexity so on simple gains and value tables you have much simpler ways of explaining student growth often they look at the end of like 2023 school year compare that to the end of the 2022 school year and say what's the difference did the students grow while that's easy to understand and easy to communicate and has value in specific

[01:46:27] ways, it also leaves a lot of students out. If a student didn't take that previous test score, they may not show up in that system. When you go along that model complexity spectrum and you get to VVOS, you're really taking a longitudinal look at student learning. So you think about VVOS is looking at all of the students' past testing history. Say you have a seventh grade student, we may be looking at their third grade, fourth grade, fifth grade, sixth grade, seventh grade, math, ELA, science, social studies, all the tests that they took. And then we predict their performance on the current year's test. So knowing what we know about that student and all of their

[01:47:03] testing history, how would we expect them to perform on that seventh grade SOL? And then we compare that expected performance to how they actually did. We aggregate that up and that allows us to say, this is growth. This is the impact of the school and the division on this collection of students' growth. It's a much more robust measure, which is incredibly important in the times of post-COVID. We have a lot of students moving. There's high student mobility.

[01:47:29] We had a lot of missing test scores, so we need to make sure that even if student test scores are missing, we can still include them. And that's as wonky as I'm going to get for today, unless you want to go a little bit deeper, because I know it can get very technical. The benefits of each of these measures really provide a full picture and a full lens of student learning.

[01:47:51] So when you think about student achievement, it measures student performance at a single point in time. And we know that there's a lot of noise around an individual student test score. You think about your student going in for that test that morning, they may have had a bad morning, a fight with their mom like I do with my child sometimes, they didn't eat breakfast.

[01:48:10] We want to make sure that we're looking at a student's full history instead of just that one single point in time. We also know that it's most closely related to family and economic background. That's been noted a few times today. Our poorer students and our students of color tend to score lower than their peers on peer achievement levels.

[01:48:29] It also compares a student to an external performance standard. That earlier slide where we looked at those students who were right below the proficiency line. Maybe they were in the eighth grade and they were at the seventh grade level by the end of the year. But they may have started on a fourth grade level, which means they made tremendous progress within that year, even though they didn't meet that external benchmark.

[01:48:53] And finally, we know educators cannot control the entering achievement levels of their students. If you have a seventh grade reading teacher and their students come in on a fifth grade reading level, they're going to meet them where they are. they're going to help them progress throughout the year so we really need a fair and transparent measure that looks at the impact of schools and divisions on student learning in pairing that with growth we can use vivos to measure student progress between all tested grades and subjects and the reason that this is important is that all these subjects are interrelated if i were to walk

[01:49:29] into an eighth grade math classroom and ask that math teacher other than math what's most important for your students to know what do you think they would likely say reading reading exactly if a student can't read they can't access the text in the curriculum it's much harder to learn other subjects so we actually include previous reading scores on their math student growth measure it's not weighted the same as math but it is highly predictive of success so we're able to include every grade and subject on all of those and we look at those relationships every single year for every single test that's provided to us. We also know after three decades of research on this topic

[01:50:07] that growth is most closely related to schooling effectiveness and teaching effectiveness. This is where the rubber hits the road of what's the impact on student learning, your schools and your teachers and your divisions, and growth shows that. It's also comparing students' performance to their own prior performance. So if you think of that seventh grader coming in on a fourth grade level, We're really saying, okay, you're in the fourth grade.

[01:50:34] How much progress did you make this year? And let's celebrate that progress. If you made two years worth of progress and you're now on a sixth grade level, that's wonderful. We're closing those achievement gaps. It's important to note and to celebrate, especially in an accountability system. And I had a pop-up, sorry about that.

[01:50:54] And finally, we know that educators can influence the amount of growth that their students make. Again, three decades of research shows this. We've proven it in over half of the states. And it's not just SAS proving it. Bellweather Foundation, Fordham, all of these external partners have seen that the same type of information and proving that growth measures are really assessing the progress of students and the influence of schools and divisions. But it's not just a single number. You have implemented VVOS in Virginia and provided this information back to your educators.

[01:51:30] Accountability, the pure purpose of accountability and holding schools accountable is really about school improvement and making sure that we're providing the best education for our students. In order to do that, you don't just need a number or a performance or an effectiveness level. You really need the information that goes into that to make school improvement decisions and better prepare your students and your teachers to do the job that they're in the classroom to do. And that's exactly what VBOSS does through our web reporting system and the reports that are given to educators. We're going to think

about four levels of reports today, and I'm not going to get into all of them. I just want to give you a sample to kind of show you what school

[01:52:08] improvement tools are out there because that's really the purpose of the system is school improvement. The first is public reports. These public reports are going to allow you to really compare divisions in schools and how they're performing in growth. I'm going to show you a few examples of scatter plots. It actually is using Virginia data showing you divisions. I will not show any division names today, but it's using SOL data to see how divisions are performing as it relates to growth. You highlighted transparency earlier as a key hallmark of what you wanted to do as a board. These public reports really support that transparency and the trust that you can build

[01:52:45] with the student or the public that you're providing the information that's needed to make improvements. The growth reports really allow you to understand what's going on in division in schools. Where are our strengths? Where are kids performing well? And where do we have opportunities to improve? Are we doing great in eighth grade math like you mentioned earlier? And we need some work in fourth grade math? Where are those differentiators? That's paired with what we call diagnostic purports. These diagnostic tools allow you to further disaggregate the information.

[01:53:17] So say you have a school and you're doing wonderful in sixth grade math. You are at the highest performance level, what we call level five in VBOX. You're doing a great job knocking out of park. But when you start to disaggregate that information like Chad did earlier, you see that, well, you're knocking it out of the park with your high achievers and your average level achievers, but you're really missing the mark with your low achievers. And it's just masked in that overall score. So here's where we need to provide some more interventions and supports to really help students grow and learn. We also see a flip side. Our high achievers are really being left

[01:53:53] behind while we're supporting our low and middle achievers. We can slice it and dice it by demographic information by specific classrooms. All of this information really allows you to dig in deeper and improve student performance. And finally, through the VBOSS system, we provide student projected scores. And this really looks at, okay, here's how each student has performed in the past, and here's how they're likely to perform in the future. Now, this isn't a gotcha or let's not worry about that student because they're going to be fine or there's no hope for them. It's really, here's their likely performance. What do we need to do to change that trajectory?

[01:54:30] How do we help that student now in the sixth grade that's not projected to be proficient in eighth grade eat that and actually get to proficiency and these student reports are incredibly robust and really focused towards educators using them to make decisions about the support they need in the classroom to help their students achieve so what do these look like the first set of reports i want to talk to you about are what we call scatter plots these scatter plots each of these yellow dots represents a division in the commonwealth of virginia and they're plotted along

[01:55:06] the axis of the growth index and achievement this dark black line is what we call average growth so this is the average amount of growth in this subject in this grade this is fourth through eighth grade math in the past year and what you see is that regardless of where a division lies upon the achievement spectrum you have some divisions exceeding the growth index and some falling below it the most important takeaway from this is regardless of the type of students you serve all students can learn and grow all students can learn and grow and that's

[01:55:44] an expectation that we can have for our divisions and our schools i know you've seen this quadrant slide before and when you think about where would we want our students to go my son is starting kindergarten next year he's five and if i were to pull this up in my area i live in tennessee so we have this information publicly available i would want to look specifically at this slide for all of these schools and let's say we don't have school choice in tennessee where you can choose whatever public school you can go to but let's say that we did and i said okay i want my son to go to a high achieving high growth school in the green quadrant because not only are they high achieving

[01:56:23] their kids are exceeding proficiency but they're also growing those kids each year but if i don't have that option i probably want to go to blue next lower achieving but high growth because that means wherever my son comes in on that spectrum you may already be past proficiency or maybe be below it that school is helping them reach or exceed their potential and these schools or divisions in the red is where we need to put some more resources and maybe pay a little bit more attention how do we support them how does the department the virginia department of education provide resources and support for those schools because they have the students who have the most

[01:57:02] needs but also are not helping them progress like we would hope so let's break it down a little bit further. That was very high level looking at divisions. But what about if we wanted to go into an individual school? And I know this is a lot to see from a distance. So what I want to do is kind of orient you to what you're looking at. On the left hand side, you have all of these options. When you think about transparency, putting a number out there and saying you're a high growth school in math, good job. That tells me nothing as an educator. I really need

[01:57:38] to dig into the information and understand what that means, who I'm serving, just aggregate it a little bit more, and that's what this allows you to do. It allows you to select those different filters. What subject do I want to look at? Do I want to look at growth or achievement in growth? Do I only want to look at where we're doing well or where we have opportunities to improve?

[01:57:56] And this really allows you to dig into that. If you look at the colors, it gives you a quick synopsis of how you're doing in each subject and grade. So green means that you're meeting the average amount of growth in that subject to grade for that school year. Light blue and dark blue means that we have moderate or significant evidence that our students are exceeding the growth standard. And yellow and red means that we have moderate or significant evidence that our students are falling below the growth standard. So we can quickly see that overall this school is doing great. We're in the green and the blue for most subjects and grades with the exception of sixth grade reading. We're in the red. So that's an area where we can quickly identify that we may

[01:58:35] need to do some more interventions, look at different curriculum, different supports for our teachers. If you go in a little bit further, you can actually add more statistical information to that. So what was our growth measure? What percentile are we in? How many students are we serving? You can actually add entering and exiting achievement on here. So you can look at the achievement data side by side with the growth to understand what types of students we're serving in this school. The diagnostic reports that I told you about earlier, I'm not going to show those here today, you could pull it up and say, okay, what types of students are we serving? Can

[01:59:10] I just look at my LOA achievers? How are they doing? Can I look at my students who are socioeconomic disadvantaged and see how we're performing with them? All of that type of information is

embedded in our system. In addition to the overall school reports, we have student reports as well. These student reports allow you a one-stop shop to go in and look at the information about student performance and their testing history. So you'll see here we have the trajectory of a student and um this is math for sol for 2019 2021 and 2022 the student dipped a little bit and now they're

[01:59:47] up on a trajectory to go forward we could actually use this and project out to how they're likely to perform on next year's test or even three years from now this model has been externally validated by west ed brand and the government accountability office and found that our projections are actually more accurate three years in advance of a test than just looking at a student's previous test school so this gives teachers and educators the information they need to plan for students long term plan for staffing in their school and their division how many algebra one teachers are we going to need in middle school how many ell teachers are we going to need what do we need

[02:00:24] to make sure that we're meeting the needs of the students who we're going to be serving in addition this type of information is available in a parent report for parents to be sent home you can send the full testing history of all of the different subject areas and grade levels that your student has received and then you can also get those projections to say okay how are we doing how are we likely to do in the future to have those really rich parent-teacher conferences about student performance and finally you can look at the past schooling experiences of a student and for me this

[02:01:00] is incredibly powerful we know that when students have lower effective schools year after year it's going to impact their future trajectory we need to make sure that all students are getting highly effective schooling experiences so for this student in particular we see that for mathematics mathematics in 2021 their school and their division was lower performing in growth we want to make sure that student has the resources they need moving forward and that in seventh grade and eighth grade and beyond they're getting high performing schools and divisions to really

[02:01:37] accelerate that growth moving forward. Overall, this tool and this solution, while it's definitely a part of many states' accountability systems, and is an incredibly important part of accountability to understand, one, how schools and districts or divisions are impacting student growth, but also providing that fair and reliable and transparent measure, it's more importantly a school improvement school to use that accountability system to increase student learning, to increase student growth. I'd love to take any questions that you may have, and I think Chad's going to

[02:02:12] moderate this section, but I'm happy to go with any more reports or dig a little bit deeper. Comments or questions from board members. Dr. Sievert. Thank you, Madam President. I was looking to see if I was going to go first. First of all, thank you, thank you, thank you. And I'd like to share a little historical context I think might be beneficial. So this is kind of a story, but with a purpose, and it's about trust and context. So, you know, in my prior division, 15 years ago,

[02:02:48] we were the first division to use MAP. And when we brought MAP online, based on our reviews and visits to schools and divisions in Ohio and other places, we also wanted to use that data well. So we contracted with SAS as a division about 15 years ago to do that work. And my trust for SAS came from the fact that they called me and said, "We need to give you a refund." And the reason they called to give me a refund is 15 years ago, Virginia's SOL scores did not have sufficient stretch to let these tools work properly. And so rather than cash the check, well, we're using math. So we actually renegotiated the contract and we got some pretty good reporting that was

[02:03:28] helpful for our division. So I just want you to know that huge trust in my experience with the company SAS for that reason, not to mention John White and other brilliant people being involved for a long time. Very, very good. That was 15 years ago. 11 years ago, coming out of the Great recession. Virginia wanted its ARA funds. To get our ARA funds to come out of the Great Recession, we had to check the box that we were going to do some student growth measures. Now, at that point in time, checking that box meant bringing online student growth percentiles. But at that point in time, statewide, student growth percentiles had the same problem Salem had in the years before

[02:04:06] where there wasn't enough stretch in our scores. So as a result, there was tremendous pushback and scrutiny justified from the field that SGPs, we had a pretty low ceiling on some of our scores, led to a lot of distrust and a lot of concerns. So that's the context. Trust in SAS, context historically. I think this creates for us, probably more importantly for the department moving forward, a communications challenge where there's also an opportunity. SAS is a trusted company Vivos and its reporting is excellent more importantly 10 years later this is not your 2010s

[02:04:44] as student growth percentiles we we now have Virginia we have your data testing we have more stretch don't get me wrong we have lots of improvement to make on the assessment side but currently we do have the scale and the stretch necessary to put some faith in these analytics um and so I think there will be scrutiny oh but SVPs are bad well they were bad with garbage in garbage out. But now that we're at a better place, I think we're going to have some opportunities there. So I just want to say thank you to SAS, and I feel good about VVAS. Now, I will also then say, many of us have heard Secretary Guderis talk about it many times, that we have used data as a

[02:05:21] flashlight, not a hammer. So this is important because there are states that misused their EVAS, and those traps have been found, people have fallen in them, and Virginia can avoid them. So we just to make sure as we assemble these pieces for our system that that we not only size them and shape them right but that we we use them right um but this thank you for this presentation thank you sir mr rotherham thank you madam president i have a couple of questions i guess it's the first one

[02:05:56] i mean this is great thank you um i guess three you talked about the predictive validity of this you said we can get scores a couple of years ago and then that can actually tell us that's more reliable then can you I think that's like a very important concept and we you kind of went over pretty quick could you unpack that a little bit for us I can actually show you something um that may helpful I do talk fast I've been told that my whole life I'm not going to show it to you because it's not a nice like that but so what we do is we take a student's full testing history so say you

[02:06:34] have a seventh grade student when we say you performed here in third grade fourth grade fifth grade sixth grade and seventh grade based on your past performance and looking at how all students in your state have performed historically on these exams and that currently are performing we predict how they're likely to perform on future tests because we have students already taking those future tests and those things are related we know that there's a statistical relationship between each of those tests moving forward so we take that student's past performance the full past performance of the student plus the full past performance of all of the students historically in Virginia. And we have five to 10 years of data that we're looking at. And then we

[02:07:12] say, okay, based on your past performance, how students like you have performed, here's where we anticipate you performing in the future, given the average schooling experience. And that's

important nuance. It's given the average schooling experience. So the hope is that if we have a student that's not projected to be proficient in the future, we wouldn't give them the average schooling experience. We would put interventions and supports in place to make sure their needs are met and that they can accelerate and really reach that proficiency benchmark in the future.

[02:07:45] Okay. You almost are anticipating my second question, which is a lot of growth is sort of growth to nowhere in a lot of places, right? Where the kids are always growing, but they never actually get anywhere. It's the reason a lot of civil rights groups were very skeptical of growth models, either in No Child Left Behind or in the waivers and so on, that Secretary Spelling's issued in that era. Talk about how do we make sure that growth doesn't become just another way we mask inequities and low performance. I think that's a really important policy

[02:08:23] consideration and philosophical consideration as you talk about your accountability system. And that's why we often see that this is a single measure. This is a measure in your accountability system. It's not the only measure in your accountability system. So you're still pairing that with achievement. Proficiency is important. We shouldn't mask when students are not proficient. We have to include that as an element. But you can pair that with growth to also see how schools and divisions are performing and accelerating students to that proficiency.

[02:08:56] So when we have conversations with our clients and our state partners, we often say this is an incredibly important measure. It's not the only measure. And while ultimately it's your decision as policymakers and as board members, the weighting of those systems, we always encourage due diligence in making sure that you're capturing both growth and achievement so that you don't have that growth to nowhere kind of concept. Okay. And then that is sort of teasing my third question.

[02:09:23] I love the graphics. Help me understand that I am concerned. We have to make this complicated so it's rigorous. Simple is a recipe for something that's clumsy or blunt or does what Alan was just talking about. On the other hand, I do worry about how parents are going to be able to understand this and so forth. And the climate is not good. And I'll just say the impolitic thing right now, like every time the governor opens his mouth and says we had learning loss and, you know, we've had these declines, we get like, you know, what 10 years ago, he would have said we're conspiracy theorists coming up under every rock. Oh, no, it's not that bad. You know, no left-handed at eighth grade kids are actually doing great.

[02:09:59] What are you talking about? And so I'm extremely concerned about like, how do we present this in a way that the average parent gets it? And when we talk about predictive validity against based on a set of the average kids and so forth, like, so help us like, just what's best practice?

[02:10:15] What are you saying to make sure we need to be technically rigorous, but like the climate, I'll just say it is crazy right now, considering the consequences and the stakes for kids, the conversations we're having, we've got to figure out a way to cut through that. And I sort of maybe hone in on that question a little bit further, and I think that goes to something that we have we've had a conversation about to begin with, is that oftentimes whatever growth measure a local school division is using may or may not be informing parents effectively or at all.

[02:10:48] And so I think the direction that I really have a strong desire to go in is to provide a means by which we are teaching teachers and administrators how to have conversations that are very direct, but also seeking a means by which parents and families are an active part of understanding the difference between growth and achievement and how we are trying to close those gaps.

[02:11:19] how the teachers in the classrooms are doing that because you know as a parent I have experienced teachers who have gone really far in their explanation and what kind of things that they are going to achieve and work with my child in particular in the classroom on.

[02:11:36] And then some teachers have just never talked about it and sent the PALS paper, the MAPS paper home. Sorry, not PALS, MAPS. And I've been left to kind of figure that out on my own. Of course, I'm in this field. I understand it myself, but I'm thinking about those who don't.

[02:11:56] And so that's really where I'd like to hear from, and I think that's what Andy's getting at. How is it that you all do that work with teachers, or do you? We do. So I want to start with a little bit of an analogy, because I think it gets to kind of our process and how we do this. Do any of you have a phone? Can you show me your phone? Do you know how to use your phone?

[02:12:22] Can I use it? You can make calls. You can get on the internet, text a little bit, right? Can any of you tell me the technology behind it and how it works? Zeros and ones. I remember that from third grade math. Yeah, you can build it. You can set the satellite systems up and all those things, right?

[02:12:39] So it's all about user experience, right? We have to develop technology and tools that an average user can use in a way that we hope that they use it, even if it's incredibly sophisticated behind the scenes.

[02:12:54] Apple's done a great job of that. Sorry, if you're not an Apple fan, but Apple's done a great job of that. They're probably the leader. We are working on that. Like, that's something that we're constantly iterating. So we have a ton of training that we do. We have an entire training team that's former teachers, former instructional coaches, former superintendents. They go out, they practice every training they do. Everything is curated for the audience that they're working with to make sure that the user experience and some of the slides I showed you are pretty complex. That is not what we would put in parent facing. That was more educator facing because we

[02:13:29] want that user experience to be great. We have been working with a company called Learning Heroes, if you're familiar with them in many of our states, to really engage with parents. Learning Heroes is probably the foremost leader in the country on parent engagement and really making very complex things like accountability systems, school report cards, easy and transparent and trustworthy for parents to use. And so that's where we're leaning in there to make sure that the technology is great, the statistics behind it is appropriate. We have a really robust and incredible user experience where we train teachers, we train trainers to make sure it's implemented well. We've already been doing a ton of that training in Virginia and we've gotten

[02:14:09] really good feedback from superintendents, but then also bringing in those external partners that have done this work for decades to make sure that our public facing information and our parent facing information is also meeting the mark but how do you build confidence like i hear that and i like i think your analogy doesn't quite work it's more like an app on your phone where if it's telling you to do something consequential you're going to want to know what's that based on like why is it telling me this to you know start doing something stop doing something whatever like how in an environment where people don't have confidence because they're being politically stoked not to have confidence how do we make sure that they're going to have

[02:14:48] confidence in what's behind this. It feels a little like a black box. And that's what I'm trying. Like, what lessons have you learned in terms of not, I get the communicating point and learning heroes.

That's great. But building confidence that people are like, okay, I trust this. Dr. Tunes? Yeah, I'm not sure that SAS is responsibility. That's actually the department's responsibility. That's part of the parent task force that we're working on. That's part of the new director of parent engagement, Melissa Rickey, who's not here this morning. But that's our responsibility. That's our responsibility to pair with our partners like SAS or Learning Heroes to help build that trust through communication, through listening sessions, through task force,

[02:15:27] through working with educators and teachers. So that's a partnership responsibility of the department, I would say. Ms. Ashton. Yeah, I think it's a great question. And I think the reality is that parents trust teachers and so if teachers have this information then it then they will that's where the trust of communication breaks down so i think the question i have is what are you doing with teachers to make sure that they are this is a lot of data and so like we have used it earlier good data in bad data in so now we're okay good data in but now it's a lot

[02:16:04] of data so now what do you do with it and i think so just hearing more about support and training and resources that teachers have with the tool and the platform i think would be helpful and then i guess one thing that's not clear to me and this is data to what goal and what end so we have grade level but if you're constantly growing and or you're growing but you're not actually getting to proficiency and this kind of gets to the college career side um i think one thing with

[02:16:38] math is it clearly says where your kids in terms of college entrance acceptance and it's just very clear i can say to a parent your kid is not on track to graduate from college that data makes sense now we can have a conversation about partnership so i think it's you know what are we doing with teachers but then to what end so that parents and teachers and school heads can partner together does that make sense it does thank you so um to answer your second question first so that type of information is in there around um act sat where are you likely to score

[02:17:13] are you likely to be um ready for college you know on track for those college benchmarks we can also project to ap um that type of data available so end of course high school exams as well um so those conversations are there it's easy to understand and use um but you're right you have to have teachers engaged in that so within our system in addition to the in-person trainings that we've been doing across the state equipping teachers principals and educational leaders around the vboss system we also have a lot of support specifically built into the site so say you go to a training and you've had you know eight trainings in the last four days

[02:17:48] and you come back and you're like what was that this type of thing and our help files will go on and you can show about this page so it gives you all the information about how this report helps you how you break it down all the way into the details of the technical modeling if it's somebody that's interested in that but it always starts at that higher level of how do you use this what do you do in your classroom in addition to that we have e-learning available and so there are videos and click-throughs that they can go on and we can develop this type of thing for vboss and customize it based on which reports you think they're the most important and helpful that goes in and kind

[02:18:26] of walks you through the report you click here you do this this is the type of questions that allows you to access the information it can provide to your classroom that type of thing um in addition we have like desk references that can sit so there's a whole suite of training materials that go along with the

in-person training and the virtual trainings that our training team offers just in follow-up to those questions uh well let me help me back up one step so vivas in virginia

[02:19:01] is a fairly new tool i think i'm right that this was part of a pilot instituted by superintendent balo a year plus ago is that about right we it rolled out a year ago so we've been working on it and we've rolled it out to all the superintendents this spring so it's uh available statewide it's not just in pilot jurisdictions yes ma'am it is available statewide and so it's rolled out to superintendents but that means it's also going to parents and to teachers already they're getting these reports so teachers do not have access to logins just yet parents do they're not a login

[02:19:40] but the parent reports are available for schools to print out and send to parents and have those parent-teacher conferences so the parent parent report is available but the teacher level reports are not yet out there and there are no teacher specific level reports it's all at the the grade and subject level so when teachers get access to this they'll be able to see school level information at like sixth grade math but not in the individual classrooms okay so that may help answer my so if to the extent that teachers are an important part of helping parents understand the information uh one of my questions would be have we is there built into this new program whether i'm not sure

[02:20:20] whether it's still considered a pilot or not but is there built into this uh some assessment of how it's working for parents and how it's working for teachers and i'm particularly interested following up on some of the questions about complexity and simplicity you know good communications tools include evaluations of is it at the right language level for the audience intended for instance is it at the right complexity level um you know how do the parents find it a useful tool and uh is that built into the program that we're doing here in virginia now

[02:20:54] any assessment of any feedback from parents and or teachers? Is that built into what we're already doing or is that something we might want to consider adding? Sure. So if you'll see here, we have a contact us button and then we have a technical support team that's available. So any questions that we get in from that, we filter through that. We get a lot of comments and feedback around the reporting. If there's like a user experience that we're getting a question a We modify the design to make sure that it's more friendly.

[02:21:24] We do evaluations of all of our trainings that we provide, and then we just like a teacher does in their formative assessments. If things aren't hitting the mark, they're going to change their instruction to make sure the students are learning what they need to learn. As far as the parent reports, likely we will eventually do focus groups on that to kind of we've done some focus groups in the past on our parent reports, not specifically in Virginia.

[02:21:46] in, but that's something that we could consider adding on to further evaluate and refine the information being provided. And have you run them through a comms, maybe part of your development of the reports? Oh, sure. Including used comms. So what grade level are they written to a specific literacy level for readers? I'll have to get back to you on that question. I don't know if we're looking at like specific literacy levels, but we have an entire user interface team and design team and a web development team and that works on all of this it's the comms tool he said that in communication yeah um and um is there are they available in different languages not currently we

[02:22:26] do um have spanish available look we're thinking about putting it available in spanish but we do not have that currently uh and then just my the next thing i want to understand or for accountability

purposes this is not yet this growth measure we're using it as a communications tool essentially to parents and divisions but we're not yet it's it's distinct from the growth measure in our current accreditation system that's correct with language thanks to mr rotherham but help me understand how it compares to that so for instance one of the weaknesses many of us i think have focused on in

[02:23:04] our current growth growth measures in our accreditation system is they don't give any credit for growth above the proficiency level so they don't help highlight school's ability or still school's success in helping students who are already proficient get better back to your your impressive slides with the kids coming down on proficiency from beginning of the year at all and they're just a clumsy they're clumsy in a number of ways and how they measure growth

[02:23:41] does this measure i mean your measure all goes back to sols right it's all well almost all at least dependent on on sol scores i think there was some maybe some early readings uh kindergarten reading or something also funneled in but mostly based on sol so does it but but can it get past that gap so will your growth measures identify when a school is helping a high achieving child well yes it will so um if you go back to and i'm going to actually it's okay while you do that i'll

[02:24:17] just say that uh we're going to talk in the achievement section more about virginia's a current achievement measure which includes that it's a combined rate so it includes both proficiency as well as growth in it um but katrina can talk more about which specific growth measure are in the current system um it is a more of a simple gains metric as opposed to the the vivos metric which is so but in other words that the the growth component of our combined measure does not address these high uh the growth at the gifted end of things so to speak and yours

[02:24:53] does that's correct okay and so a simple gains measure is really going to reflect um it's going to more closely resemble your achievement so if you think about the relationship between achievement and economically disadvantaged so on the left you have achievement high to low achievement and then And then on the bottom, you have percent economically disadvantaged in a school.

[02:25:15] And this is every school in Tennessee. This is a live site you can go to. This is real data. You see that there's like this slope there, that relationship. So as you have more kids who are economically disadvantaged, your achievement is lower. As you have a wealthier school with fewer economically disadvantaged kids, the achievement goes higher.

[02:25:32] What our growth measure does is essentially flattens that up. So here you see, regardless of the percent of children that you serve that are economically disadvantaged, you can see growth. You can also see those that are not making growth.

[02:25:48] Now, your specific question is, can you see growth with high achievers? And that goes back to the earlier slide I showed you, but this is live data from Tennessee. What you see here is that regardless of the types of students you serve, whether they're low achieving or high achieving, we can see that some of them make growth and some of them don't.

[02:26:04] So what this allows you to do is to really understand the impact of the school and the division on student learning, regardless of the students that they're serving. If you have all high achieving students in the 98th percentile, you can still see growth on those.

[02:26:20] And that gets back to Dr. Sievert's point earlier around the artificial ceiling in a test. The reason that's so important is that if all of your students are topping out of a test and there's not enough stretch in

the scale, we can't really understand if you're already over proficiency. We want to see how far you're over proficiency.

[02:26:37] And so I understand how you do that in Tennessee. Well, I understand that you can do it in Tennessee. But I don't, you know, if our SOL, are our SOL data sufficient to allow you, in other words, if all you're, if all you're getting is a pass efficiency or not, when we've tried to get growth, turn our SOL scores into growth measures before, we've run into the, just the inadequacy of our testing system.

[02:27:08] is our current SOL testing system sufficient to give you the data you need to measure this kind of growth? It is. And so every year for all of our clients, we look at every single assessment they give us. We are not limited to your statewide assessment. So if you wanted to bring in your K2 data, your MAP data, your AP data, IB data, SAT, ACT, we look at every assessment you give us and we determine whether or not that assessment is appropriate to measure growth and we have four different things we look at I won't go into them but one of them is stretching the scale if they are not appropriate for measuring growth we will go back to the client which we have done

[02:27:48] and said you cannot use this test in measuring growth it's not an appropriate test you're going to have an artificial ceiling or floor it's not reliable there's not enough sample size and so we will not use that we have already looked at Virginia's information and the SOLs the current test for the past, I think we have four years of data in our system. The current test is appropriate for measuring growth. It meets those criteria, those statistical criteria. That's very helpful to understand. What you're using now is SOL and maybe the kindergarten, some part of the PALS.

[02:28:23] We're not using in Virginia now MAP or SAT, ACT. Not currently. I think that I'm guessing that's because we don't have the mandated statewide, right? So there would be- - It was a department decision.

[02:28:38] So whatever the department has available and provides to us, we can include into- - When we looked at those before, because they're not mandated statewide, that's been a limitation. Okay, so, and my last thing I wanna understand is, my limited understanding of value-added systems is they often do factor into the growth measures, some demographics, economic disadvantage, et cetera.

[02:29:03] I can't tell whether yours does that or not. - So again, that's also a policy decision. You see here, if we go back to that growth versus economically disadvantaged slide, Tennessee does not choose to include demographic factors.

[02:29:18] We have run it both ways to see if there is a relationship between the growth model and demographic factors. And what we found is because we use a student as their own control, and those are generally consistent across time. So if a student is economically disadvantaged in grade three, generally economically disadvantaged in grade six you don't have these big sweeping excuse me changes so because we use a full student testing history it's already kind of baked into the system because the student is the student and they're the same student each year we can accommodate in providing covariates adding in additional demographic information if the state

[02:29:56] chooses that is completely a policy decision what we often encourage states to do is run the model multiple ways. And we will run it for you so you can see the outcomes and what it looks like. Is there a relationship? Is there not? Do we need to add that in? But that is completely a policy decision of the state. Oh, I'm sorry. I said last question, but I just can follow up to that.

[02:30:17] May I? Quickly, Dr. Northern has questions and we need to let others speak. Thank you. The early grade, so third grade, you don't have a lot of earlier testing. I would wonder how you know, how do we build in the markers for economic disadvantage there? And as part of that, what are most of the states that you work with do on the demographic data?

[02:30:47] Second question first, most of our states do not include it in their modeling. Right now, I think we only have one. We do include some variables in Virginia, like acceleration status, because that's so prevalent here in Virginia with your high achieving students. So most of our states do not include it. And all of the technical reports for all the states and all of their business rules are available on their websites. And we can provide those to the department as they make decisions around that. Your first question about third grade. So we actually only need three prior test scores. And that doesn't mean three prior years. That means

[02:31:24] three prior testing points. So say a student had a third grade fall math, third grade fall reading and a third grade spring math that's three test scores so we can calculate on that and it holds up to the model just as well as is this future grades thank you dr northern um i think most of my comments just clarify some of the conversation around the table um but first i want to know does the average schooling experience is it predicated on one year of growth so in other

[02:32:02] words if your kids across the entire state don't make a year of growth and you're calculating the average school experience for the expectation of growth after you figure out the kid who's gone he's based on himself but his sort of benchmark is against the average schooling experience what if your entire state's kids don't make a year of growth is it then based on happier growth so it's a little bit more nuanced than that um one is because there are not common tests except nape across all of the different states saying that your your state did not make

[02:32:39] one year of growth um i don't know that it's technically correct because what are you comparing it to if your state isn't the average if you're not using your state as the reference pool what is your reference pool with no common assessments across state lines um so it's kind of like how does red smell i'm not sure that you can like dig into that question a little bit more understanding that you have to have some kind of reference pool and that reference pool has to be the average so it is they are compared to the statewide average right yeah so it is the statewide average okay

[02:33:13] yeah i mean i think just so the the answer is in covid we're all doing terrible all the kids and so right now they're not making a year of growth so we are actually working on what we call a recovery model where we're looking at growth rates pre-covid and then comparing those to growth rates post-covid and then trajectories post-covid and that's one thing that states are are doing now to say, okay, are we growing at the same rate that students in seventh grade math grew prior to COVID now? And then if we're not, are we on a trajectory to get there? So that's some of

[02:33:50] the modeling that we're doing with a lot of our states now and what we're calling a recovery analysis. Okay. In terms of the question about prior test scores, it's a very good point that you make that race, ethnicity, all these other demographic variables that we look at a lot of times are indeed soaked up by the prior test scores. I know the research that we've done when you try to control for the school level characteristics, for instance, you think, well, it may be unfair because this is a high poverty school. Are we giving them credit because

[02:34:26] they're serving a more difficult student body than another one? But is that soft bigotry of expectations you get into these very philosophical arguments but i think it's very smart that we're looking at prior test scores versus trying to control for these other typical demographics especially since research has shown that it's soaking up all that other stuff in the prior test scores um and navigator so the other point i want to make on communicating with parents is huge we're not the first state to try to figure out how to communicate parents about growth um and i'm doing some work on ai and k-12 education right now and so i'm going to read real quickly so this is some

[02:35:04] stuff that navigator's doing uh that's paired with the apparent report card so it says i truly enjoy having michael in my class but i'm concerned about him he's struggling in both reading and math many of his skills are more similar to those of a first grader than the third grader and because he's missed 14 days of school just halfway through the school year we've not had time together to catch him up when michael's focused i've seen him love school and make real progress just last week he read beautifully in front of the entire class. Can we schedule some time to talk about how we can help Michael make a huge leap forward in the second half of the year? Here are some resources. My hope is to reduce his absences to no more than five and boost his reading performance much closer to grade

[02:35:41] level through intensive support by me and you at home. So like that type of information that a parent would get, it's like a real human. It's not like a scatterplot. It's not, you know what I mean? like it's it's crazy right like parents want a human voice right and oftentimes you know i mean i know we're all trying to wrap our hands around what ai can do but if you give it something really really complicated written in statistician's voice it can give you the teacher voice of like you know here's how to talk to a parent and we're seeing state departments across the country that

[02:36:17] usually send these very complicated state department lingo-y things they put in ai and comes out in like parent friendly voice so i do think we're at the place where we can actually attach a narrative to a parent thing um that will speak in a human's voice and give them some some resources um and my last thing is just agreement that the teachers are the ambassadors for everything and um and they have to be on board because if they don't like it and they commute that communicate the parents, like, it breaks down. So just reaffirming the idea that the teachers are the

[02:36:55] ambassadors to this whole thing. Dr. Cainz? Yeah, so I want to clarify. SAS has worked with us and worked with the reporting. Over the past six months, our team has been out training. Tony? Maury. Maury. I'm getting names all smushed in my head today. Maury Pace has trained over a thousand data coordinators across the state which then are doing train the trainer models with our educators so i don't want to make it sound like we've only trained soups or sent out reports to

[02:37:31] families we as an agency internally have done some pretty extensive training on the vbos reports so if the board chooses to move forward with this model around growth we will be building an extensive training platform for multiple layers. But I do want to clarify that we have done over a thousand trainings or a thousand people in the state to train the trainer data experts in the school divisions that then go and support our teachers and understand the VBOS reports. And kudos to Maury who has been across the state and put a lot of miles on her car to just what the two of you

[02:38:09] are talking about of making sure our teachers understand the VBOS report and the first layer of helping our families understand growth. Anyone else? Just one quick clarification.

[02:38:28] The reason that SOL works, right, it's because you're using the scale score, the raw score. You're not using like what we do now is like you get proficient and you're great. But the reason it works is because we have variants in the entire scale. Okay, I'm just going to clarify that. It's like the sol's you know and because we have worked over our our department folks have worked very hard over the last number of years to uh computer adapt the tests and to link the tests from grade to grade to grade and so that the third grade student can take fourth grade can answer fourth

[02:39:07] grade questions if they are doing well on the third grade questions they will be presented fourth grade and fifth grade questions and that work has really been the department and our current test provider have worked hard on that over the past four or five years that's fairly new dr siebert i think this is a quick question um sol scores are sufficient your answer to miss holton's question they're sufficient but other states have multiple measures and multiple measures are better correct um better is subjective so i would leave that to you all to decide um i can tell you we can incorporate multiple measures so we can incorporate norm

[02:39:44] reference tests in that like map in the beauty map and i read the i station those types of things we can incorporate ap exams we actually have one state that has about 80 cte exams in high school that our teacher created within that state about 60 of those can be used in our model we can incorporate ap ib act and sat so we are test agnostic we'll do look at whatever tests that you have and are happy to bring in more data more data is always better

[02:40:12] Katrina, while we have you, I wonder if you could address a technical question. So we're not talking about assessments too much today, but if Virginia moves to a new assessment, how would SAS adapt to that and adjust, particularly if there's other states that have gone through a similar transition process?

[02:40:28] Yes, thank you for that question. So we've had two states that we've worked with for the past couple of decades that transitioned assessments three years in a row, like new assessments three years in a row, which is always fun. But we were able to provide a consistent growth measure across those three years. So within that, that's the beauty of a more complex measure is that you're able to combine a lot of different assessments.

[02:40:48] You're able to be consistent and stable across assessment transitions. Of course, we would want to look at those tests and make sure that they meet our criteria. But in general, now most statewide assessments are meeting that criteria. We rarely see a statewide assessment that's not meeting that anymore. Can I take one second and just make sure that those board members that are joining us virtually have an opportunity to ask any questions or make any comments that they may want to make? I'll just pause here before I call on anyone else in the room.

[02:41:26] Okay. Ms. Holden. To the last exchange, if we have divisions, say, that are using MAP, and then we have divisions that are not, is there a fairness concern? That was, as I say, something we wrestled with before when we worked on our current growth measures in our accreditation system.

[02:41:54] if you, if some divisions have MAP and some don't, can you incorporate that? Number one, can you do that? Number two, if you do that, is there a fairness issue raised or is it just some of the data gets more refined? Not necessarily better or worse, but, and then the third piece connected to that is if that MAP data, it doesn't yet belong to the department, it just belongs at the division, is there a way for you to access? Sure. So we have a variety of states that approach

[02:42:28] it in different ways. So for accountability purposes, I want to kind of advocate your questions. For accountability purposes, I don't know of a state offhand, and I'll check with my technical team, that they only use measures that the entire state has in accountability. So that goes to your fairness question. And that, again, is policy question. What you want to use is what you want to use we can build the system um for the second discussion can we incorporate that data yes and so we have one state where they have like a statewide data hub that sits outside of the department um divisions opt in to provide data to that data hub then they say we want sas to have

[02:43:08] this data incorporate it into evos reporting um some they send it directly to the state and they say here give our data to sas um all their local assessments they do that so we've done it a variety of ways. Because the state is our client, we generally prefer to have all of the data from divisions come directly somewhere, either to the state, to a data hub, an SLDS, that state launch and that type of thing, and then give it all to us. And they opt in for that instead of like us collecting data from each individual division. But we can, that's just kind of like logistics

[02:43:41] that we can figure out. Thank you so much for joining us today. I appreciate you being a part of this discussion and informing us so significantly on what you guys do for this particular piece of our plan.

[02:44:03] Yeah, we are going to talk about achievement measures after this. I don't know if there are anyone else, any other questions about growth in the accountability system? We've talked a lot about the Viva system as a technical system, but does anyone have any questions on the growth metric in the accountability component in particular.

[02:44:24] Ms. Holton? This would be for you, Mr. Alderman. I really appreciate the presentation, and I'm sold that VIVAS would be a big improvement over our current growth measures. I would want to hear from our department folks about what the implications of that would be, but are there other growth measures that we should, if we're looking to improve, if we're looking to use a growth measure in an accountability system and improve upon the growth measures in our current accreditation system are there other alternatives to vivos that we should be looking at um well i mean katrina put

[02:45:03] up a slide of like the the different continuum of growth measures and vivos is one of the more sophisticated ones out there and um particularly given the trajectory of the state adopting it and the sort of comfort that's uh building in the state i think it's a strong measure um i don't know if you're looking for other components or other components of your question that you're you're asking are there any states using something different to this scale i think katrina you said how many states are using vivas for growth across the country around 15. 15 is there anyone else

[02:45:40] using different growth options at the scale of sas yeah there are other states using the different measures um so if you again think back to the continuum there are a couple states that still use a simple gains metric there are states that use the student growth percentiles which we talked about earlier and then i think the most popular most common would be the

[02:46:10] value-added model like like uh evos anything else that you would add in yeah i would probably say that the value added in student growth percentile are probably used about equally i would say but you know based on my the work that i've done on accountability over the last decade or more i think there's significant advantages to using a value-added model over student growth percentile i think a lot of times student growth percentile has been used because of the it feels slightly easier to understand but i think as katrina showed if you're able to

[02:46:47] put the reporting and the contextual data you can make really complicated information user-friendly and have a good user experience and so it's more about that when you know in student groups i think they just seem seen as easier but i think the data that you get from a value-added model is richer miss holton within the value-added category i understand sas is a really terrific player in this field and absolutely one we should consider are there other alternative value-added models that we should compare contrast with before we make a choice

[02:47:23] or is um sas evas model the the obvious selection this is my personal opinion i think it is the obvious choice i think it's the one that the most states use um you know i've never gotten a dime from sass i'll say like so i'm just saying this as a researcher needs to look at the system i've always just it's the model that i have not seen as a go-to yeah i mean again i'm an independent contrary i have no relationship with sass but they're sort of seen as the gold standard and there's the old adage like no one got fired for buying ibm like it's the same type of thing like

[02:48:01] sass uh only seems to grow with people that use it over time they there aren't a lot of states that have abandoned sass that i'm aware of they tend to adopt it and keep using it amber Dr. Northern? Sorry. So to my understanding, AIR, the American Institutes for Research, also calculates growth for a small number of states. In my opinion, they're not as transparent or consumer friendly as SAS is. My beef with SAS years ago was that you guys used to use the word

[02:48:37] proprietary model when it was like a black box that no one could really get into. And I think you guys have gotten a lot better on how you explain to states what's in the model and not telling folks it's proprietary, which made it sound kind of secretive. But there's been big, I think, growth in terms of how you guys communicate. And I think that's why the uptake of states has been better as you've gotten better with communicating what's in the model and not

[02:49:08] claiming proprietary stuff. Okay. So I, thank you all. We're going to take a break now for lunch, but before we do that, I failed to recognize our new board member who is here with us today.

[02:49:29] Michelle Ashton is here with us today. We missed her last month, but are so grateful that you have joined the team here. And we'll do a more formal introduction for you in our regular board meeting in September, but did just want to acknowledge that you are here with us and part of the team, and we're super excited to have you on board with us. So thank you so much for being here.

[02:49:51] Thank you. Ready to serve. Ready to jump in. Thank you. We will break for lunch now. Come back. What is it? 12:30?

[02:50:04] Organize here and move back in.

[03:41:40] Chad, do you want to introduce Anne? Sure, it'll be a short introduction. Anne Hyslop is a Richmond native and accountability expert. She works on the accountability regulations under the Obama administration.

[03:41:56] She's presented to the board about a year ago. In her professional life, she works for the Alliance for Education and studies accountability policy. She's here in her personal capacity as Ann Hyslop and is going to talk today about the achievement component of an accountability system.

[03:42:12] She's going to give us some background on the current system, as well as some alternative options for measuring achievement going forward. so thanks so much chad and thank you all for having

me um today i'm happy to talk about my favorite topic accountability um and i think katrina actually set up this presentation really well because i think i hope as you realize if i'm thinking about growth and these questions about like are we growing where are we growing to well the answer is that's why we have achievement you know achievement and growth they're sort of the core components of accountability um i thought just in sort of knowing that we're coming back from lunch would be a good way to

[03:42:48] kind of ground this conversation a little bit i've shared some of this information before but virginia's accreditation system doesn't really function as an accountability system as we know it in other states in virginia the system right now basically produces the same results for nine out of ten schools accredited and virtually all schools are either accredited or accredited with conditions so virtually a hundred percent of schools are getting one of two results out of the system there's a lot of information underneath that label but everybody's the same that is not how

[03:43:23] it works in other states so this is just an example of some research that i did in my other job at offer ed um looking at accountability systems in 10 states you can see here mississippi they have five possible ratings distributed pretty consistently over that distribution and no more than a quarter roughly a quarter received the same result michigan has a different system but they use an index and it goes from zero to 100 points the average is 65 the median is 70.

[03:43:54] So you can see that school quality is described over a range of possible outcomes in these states and that the systems do a much better job of differentiating school performance so that then you know state officials here at the BDOE could target resources to the schools appropriately so that parents have informed like transparent and clear information so that you know the public you all these policy makers have information um other state systems provide a lot more clarity in terms of differences between school performance than virginia's right now so

[03:44:31] i think this is a really great opportunity to think about how could what could an accountability system look like in virginia and achievement absolutely should be a part of that um measuring student academic outcomes has been the bedrock of accountability for 30 years and you know we got accountability basically coming out of developing state standards you know that is you've talked this morning about the math standards why do we have what you went through the problem you know this long process of figuring out what do we want our grade level math standards to be achievement is how you measure whether students have mastered that content at every grade level

[03:45:08] it fundamentally needs to be part of the accountability system alongside measures like growth and readiness but right now virginia's accreditation indicators don't really measure achievement and that's because the four indicators here academic achievement in math academic achievement in english and then the two gap measures in math and english use a combined rate they don't actually use an achievement or proficiency rate they use the combined rate If you should have gotten a handout, and I think along with your materials, it explains the details of the combined rate.

[03:45:44] But I think the takeaway here that you can see from these three schools is that you could have a school like school B, where 40% of students are meeting the state standards for math. But the combined rate produces a score of 82% because it's not just looking at students who have met that achievement standard.

[03:46:04] giving credit for students who have demonstrated some form of progress, not a sophisticated growth measure, but it's a measure of growth. It's also looking at English learners and the case of those

reading scores who may have demonstrated progress in English language proficiency. So it's measuring a lot of things, not just achievement. I will say though, the academic achievement indicator in science is just achievement. It's just the percentage of students who are meeting the state standards in science. So I think we've talked about this before, I know the board has really focused on this in many of your past meetings, but I just wanted to reiterate some of the drawbacks

[03:46:43] of the combined rate. One is just that it's not particularly transparent for the public. What did that 82% mean? Does that mean that a student, 82% of students in the school are meeting grade level standards in reading? Does that mean that 82% of students demonstrated some form of growth? Is that English language proficiency? How is that all allocated within that measure? It's very hard to tell. And on occasion, sometimes students are counted twice in the rate. So there are sort of technical details that let some students be counted twice.

[03:47:15] And it's also just not a measure of achievement. You know, we think about validity here in the terms of sort of statistical validity. Is this measure measuring the concept it's intended to measure? The combined rate is not measuring whether students have mastered grade level content in Virginia.

[03:47:32] It's measuring that plus a bunch of other things and student progress and growth could be recognized and rewarded in other ways in the accreditation system. That's why we had Katrina present this morning about one way that that could be done in the accountability system in Virginia.

[03:47:48] And that is how most states do it. They have a separate indicator that just focuses on growth and one indicator that really focuses on achievement. So, talking a little bit about, well, how do other states do this? Here are just some ways. I will say the first two, and that's what I'm really going to focus on in the presentation, are the most popular, but there are other ways.

[03:48:13] All states look at reading and math. Not all states look at science or social studies. Some do, but every state looks at reading and math achievement. The most popular way of doing that is either through a performance index or just a simple pass rate or proficiency rate. You also have some states, though, that might look at, they set a proficiency rate target, and then did students meet that target or not?

[03:48:36] Did Black students meet that target? Did Hispanic students meet that target? That's another way some states might do this. Some states look at average scale scores, so they would look underneath that proficiency rate and look at sort of the raw score. And then some states kind of do a combination approach where they might actually measure achievement in multiple ways.

[03:48:57] So I did want to focus, though, on like the two most common ways that states are measuring achievement, because I think they are by far and away sort of the simplest to understand, the most appealing. There's a reason why like the vast majority of states have chosen these approaches, and I wanted to hopefully give you all sort of a sense of the drawbacks, the pros, and the differences between the two.

[03:49:21] A performance index is basically just a weighted calculation. You look at the performance level that a student attained on the test. So, it's not just looking if students made that proficient level, but were they at the basic level? Were they at the approaching proficiency level?

[03:49:36] Were they at advanced? Did they exceed proficiency? So, it's looking at students sort of across the performance spectrum on the assessment. And all students are included in that, even if they are not

yet proficient. This is sort of as all students can be included now in the combined rate. Even if they're not proficient, they're included in a different way.

[03:49:56] Students who are scoring proficient are typically kind of an unweighted count so that you get full credit if a student is proficient in meeting the grade level standards. But if a student is scoring above proficiency, schools can sort of net bonus points for that. So they are weighted a little bit higher. Students who are not yet proficient, schools get partial credit for them, and they're assigned sort of a weight of 0.5 or 0.25.

[03:50:19] Here's like a mock-up of sort of how this could look in a pretend school that has 100 students in grades 3 to 5 with a pretend waiting scheme. So in this case, 1.25 for advanced, a full point for proficient, 0.75 for approaching, 0.5 for basic, made up performance levels.

[03:50:37] You can see if you had 20 students in the school at the advanced level, you would multiply that by 1.25 to get 25, 30 times 1, 30, and so on. And as a result of this, the school would get 82.5 points on the indicator.

[03:50:54] An example of a state that does something like this in real life is Ohio, which I'll talk a little bit about. And I know that you got a nice sort of longer brief about their whole accountability system in your results, your pre-read materials. I think that there are some real benefits of a performance index that are worth talking about.

[03:51:12] One is that you do recognize the full spectrum of achievement. You're not just focusing on students who are right at that proficiency cut point. You're able to look at and reward students who have exceeded that, but also give some credit to students who are at that approaching level or basic.

[03:51:32] You can include proficiency in all subject areas. So this will work for social studies, math, ELA, writing, you know, any any assessment subject could work, and it's pretty easy to show the calculation. You saw this morning the growth measures, and those are, this is not as complicated as that.

[03:51:49] It's a little bit of math, but it can easily be shown, and stakeholders can really digest this information, especially if it's presented with contextual information that helps make it clear, well, what does that 82.5 in that hypothetical example mean? So this is how Ohio does it. I said sort of preview that they are a state that is doing this now.

[03:52:10] They have actually seven different weights in their system recognizing students who are at the limited proficiency level all the way up to what they call advanced plus, but you can see that proficient is weighted at one. They also have a weight of zero for students who did not take the assessment.

[03:52:26] So they look at first individual school, the percentage of tests that were taken across all subject areas, and which performance level the student fell into, then they multiply that by the corresponding weight. they add them all together and that is compared to a maximum possible score for a school in order to create an index score which then they go further to translate that to a one to five star rating for that indicator so you can see here 81.2 percent for a school so that 88.7 points out of a

[03:53:01] possible 109.1 is 81.2 percent so that's what it was featured prominently on the report card but But Ohio also has set a standard that that would be a four-star, and then they have a little description that that exceeds the state standards for academic achievement.

[03:53:19] Looking at how this is reported, you can drill down and get more detailed information, so you can see exactly how that score of 88.7 was calculated. It shows you the math that I did on that hypothetical example of how many kids scored at each of the achievement levels, what the weight was, and what the result was.

[03:53:41] And that's what's used for accountability, but right next to it is just what's the percentage of students that were proficient, they also show that right next to it, and that's just reported. It's reported by grade level, by subject, and it's not used for accountability, but I think when someone sees all of this information, it helps kind of demystify the performance index.

[03:54:03] you know if you just saw that 88.7 points what does that mean but they provide this alongside i know that it is it is small but um hopefully you can sort of see all the different information that ohio presents alongside the index so that's one approach and it's an approach not just ohio uses but other states have as well for their assessment achievement reporting the other method i wanted to talk about um yeah just pause for questions if anybody has them right now any questions okay

[03:54:39] sorry no i'm happy to that's a good flag um i'm hoping that because you had the discussion about growth before that this seems like oh this is so simple i'm feeling great in math you know that my math skills are i'm on standard proficiency rates are just very simply the percentage of students that are meeting or exceeding grade level standards in each subject it's unweighted so only students who attain proficiency or go exceed that are included in the calculation in the numerator you don't get extra credit as a school for being advanced you don't get partial

[03:55:15] credit for approaching it's very simple and straightforward and kind of the thing you know that you use right now in the pass rates for the science indicator so here's that same school no weights that school would just be 50 percent proficient you're looking at the 20 who scored advanced and the 30 who scored proficient but the students who were at the approaching and basic level are not included in the rate at all i think some benefits of this approach are that it does really laser focus on the students who are meeting or exceeding grade level proficiency sometimes you know you can think well the way that we're we have a growth indicator and that's

[03:55:53] how we're recognizing your students across the spectrum but when it comes to proficiency we really want to focus just on the students who are proficient or above some states have made that choice. You can, like with an achievement index, you can emphasize proficiency in all subject areas. You can do this for science, for social studies, et cetera. It's very straightforward.

[03:56:13] It did not take much math to understand. So I think that that is one benefit of this approach is its simplicity. And students who are attaining advanced levels don't mask or compensate for non-proficient students. So one thing is that a lot of states who use an index, you need to think about those weights very carefully so that you would not want to have a situation where advanced students are counted so heavily that then a school looks good overall, but it's kind of hiding that actually a lot of students in the school were at that basic level or with that approaching level.

[03:56:49] So setting the weights properly can be a challenge with some index models. Obviously, states have figured it out. So many are using it, but with a simple proficiency rate, that's really not a concern. Here's an example of a state, Florida, that uses a simple proficiency rate. They use it for their English, language arts, math, science, and social studies. Each of them are worth 100 points in their system. So,

70% of students pass the test in math, you get 70 points. Very easy and straightforward to understand. That is then summed up and translated to an A to F grade. Florida does

[03:57:26] give an overall A to F grade, but plenty of states that use simple proficiency rates don't use summative rating so they don't go hand in hand. I did also want to point out here that they call their student growth measures learning gains which is measured in a separate indicator and they give them equal weight. So there are four learning gains indicators and there are four achievement indicators. Yes Dr. Siebert. Thank you and you elaborated something that I looked through the slide deck previously I didn't pick up on because I do remember probably in your last fall visit it the idea that there were multiple indicators that led to the overall and and so you talked

[03:58:05] about the learning gains piece is is there is also some states i think that we're also looking at how did individual schools do with the lowest quartile students and and that is one of the indicators as well yeah florida is an example of that so two of their learning gains indicators they have learning gains for all students in english language arts and all students in math

[03:58:26] And then the learning gains of the lowest 25%, right at the bottom left, that is looking at the lowest 25% achieving students in each school. So Florida is an example of a state that does that, and they give equal weight to growth for all students as they do to growth for that lowest performing 25% of students in their system.

[03:58:53] Here's a little just example, though, of how Florida also reports. So even though Florida is just looking at the proficiency rate for accountability, they do report the full spectrum of results. In Florida's case, level four is proficient. So students that are in that darker, the light blue and the dark blue, those are students who have met grade level standards.

[03:59:15] Any student that was in the green, orange, or red is below that proficient mark. So even though proficiency rates can seem like, again, very simple, there are ways through reporting, I think, to add additional contextual information that could be useful for parents and for the public.

[03:59:37] Proficiency rates. Any questions on, more questions on the Florida model? I'll ask, just Ms. Holtan. Are both Florida and Ohio summative, single summative rating systems?

[03:59:53] Florida is. Ohio is not anymore. I believe they move. Yeah, they're moving to stars. So they do a star. I can say, so I think New York is another state that does an achievement index. They're not summative. But Ohio does have a summative across all. And so does Florida. Yes. So they both have a summative, but one is stars and one is letters. And I think Florida, the difference, it's the nuance between Florida and Ohio is I showed on the Ohio slide that four-star rating that's just

[04:00:27] for the indicator so that's just for achievement this school is four stars for achievement they might be three stars for growth they might be one star for graduation rate so they give an overall rating just for a particular measure so they don't have and they do it overall oh they do it overall yes okay so this school is a four-star school or a three-star school yes so they have that but they also do kind of a similar for the indicator level um and you remember the indiana placemat that chad showed us at the beginning that is an example of a state that doesn't do an overall

[04:01:06] so she talked about having the separate indiana is one that just tracks those individual ones and doesn't do an overall so that placement would be another that reminds me my seatmate was pulling up south carolina am i right south carolina that i think mr alderman referred to earlier as a state that's

gotten good results does not use a single overall summative rating they do i think i don't think they have an overall rating i think they have an index so they may have a score i believe a lot of states have changed their accountability systems coming out of the pandemic but i don't

[04:01:42] believe for like their main system was just sort of coming up with a more like indiana like in indiana yeah can i so the study i mentioned this morning was a sort of five category approach the south carolina made determinations of which indicators they want to do and then they rolled it up into five categories of identification this is 20 years ago now um so there's the question of the indicators uh that i prefer to if we can talk about those today and then hold the conversation on the summative for another time i think that is important discussion but if we can talk about the

[04:02:19] indicators themselves i think that would be useful for us to come back to you with a full option suite of different ways how the indicators add up yes exactly so we're not trying to make a decision down today about whether we want a summative rating or a multiple like a dashboard now and or how we would weight them right that's not today's business to the extent that we can it'd be helpful to talk about um indicators themselves so whether you prefer an index or the percent proficient or something else and also like how you would want to balance uh the different indicators into some

[04:02:56] sort of determination ultimately we have to identify uh schools that need support and so uh we'll have to do some some sort of index some sort of weighting it doesn't we don't have to identify every school and give every school label and that's a separate conversation just so that i understand focusing on the individual indicators today and what we might want to use for a proficiency measure or growth measure to talk and we can obviously have preliminary discussions but for me to understand how i would want to balance them i would need to hear more about how they're going to i can't really say do i want to put growth twice as valuable as proficiency or half

[04:03:36] as valuable as proficiency or the same without knowing more about how they add up we're hoping to get into the conversation about how to add up as well so yeah not to a determinative or for all schools but still a com combination for some sort of index and the main reason that i wanted to show the five star sort of scale here is just because i know that a performance index might seem overly complicated or slightly more complicated but i thought this is just was ohio's solution to trying

[04:04:11] to demystify that so that if you didn't want to go in and see do the math and say well okay 25 times 1.7 plus that you could at least get that quick high level overview of okay the state says that this school got a four out of five stars for achievement real quick ohio uses stars for individual indicators and for an overall correct are the indicators weighted for the overall yes they are at some point i'd like to know that yeah it's in the packet yeah it's in the handout you

[04:04:45] could read all about ohio's um system so i think just like quick high level summary before we can get into some of these deeper conversations i know chad has some questions but you may also as well is kind of summary of everything so virginia right now is using that combined rate it really lumps together achievement and a progress measure and it doesn't really measure proficiency because it's also giving schools credit for those students who have made progress

[04:05:17] it's doing three things instead of one it's difficult to understand but it only adds certain students who are making progress correct that is correct can you clarify that yeah so the students in the combined rate if you are a proficient student or an advanced student that is how you are counted in the combined rate virginia does not look at growth at all for students who are meeting rate level standards which is

something that was raised earlier if you are non-proficient the only way that you are included in the combined rate is if you make growth or progress in some

[04:05:51] form your proficiency or lack thereof is not included um and if you're an english learner you could also be demonstrating also be included at least on the reading combined rate not because you demonstrated progress on english language arts not because you met grade level standards in reading but because you made progress on the english language proficiency assessment so it's actually also capturing progress toward attaining english language skills which is different than meeting the state standards and reading for that population of students that's

[04:06:26] that's when i say doing three things at once and you know i think if we had a really rich conversation about growth not measuring growth for the full spectrum of students just measuring growth and progress for a subset of students and also not really placing sufficient attention on students who have not met grade level standards because they can just be counted as yes because you demonstrated progress even if you are below grade level standards so it's very confusing to understand multiple possible ways that you could score points or aren't schools could earn points

[04:07:03] and can really mask the percentage of students in a school who are not proficient and haven't met grade level standards yet ohio as we know just showed uses this performance index which does consider students at all different achievement levels from basic to well above proficient by and generates this weighted score it can become easy to understand when you have that description of the weights you have the additional contextual information um alongside it to sort of make the math easy to understand um and i think the benefit of this is that it does recognize performance at

[04:07:40] all levels there is something to be said for rewarding schools who have helped their students attain the highest levels of proficiency or recognizing that you know you're close to proficiency you're just not quite there yet so we're going to give you partial credit and i think that's really appealing to some audiences and a really important reason why states have chosen performance indexes then you have a state like florida which is just using a simple proficiency rate i think here really the biggest thing that folks like about this approach is the how simple and straightforward it is that it doesn't require much math it's very um familiar

[04:08:15] it's what we think of when you think about a pass rate um i think the drawback here is that you can focus solely on that grade level proficiency and some states i think there are ways to avoid this challenge but there can be ways that this is operationalized where it can lead to an overall focus just on students who are very close to that proficiency cut point so we're just trying to get our proficiency from 70 to 75 and you're not necessarily focused on sort of the full spectrum i think there are ways to make that um mitigate that risk or problem but i think that is one

[04:08:51] drawback that some have cited to just using a simple proficiency rate and i think that's my final slide so i'm happy now to turn it over to more questions that you all have um or questions that chad would like to pose to kind of get into some of these deeper conversations now that you have both seen you know katrina's really rich presentation around growth measures as well as this presentation on how achievement is measured.

[04:09:15] Ms. Holden? Very terrific presentation. Going back to where you started with helping us understand Virginia's system compared to other states, one of the potential risks of differentiating schools into more categories than Virginia's does,

[04:09:55] I agree, essentially as a two-category system, and frankly, there was reference earlier to accreditation denied, we essentially rewrote the accreditation denied category some years ago, I think out of the same impulse that this board is considering separating accountability from accreditation, because we recognize that there are schools that, while they're not getting good results, they're doing all the right things to try, they're acting in good faith, they're complying with minimum standards we didn't want them to be denied accreditation under those circumstances where

[04:10:33] they're acting in good faith and cooperate so so essentially it's a two-tiered system right um one of the fears or concerns about a multi-tiered system is that it perhaps residential racial segregation and i think there is some research on some states that more differentiated systems drive residential segregation and also the fear is that it will drive good teachers away from the most challenged schools how are the states that are doing this well working to mitigate those

[04:11:09] concerns yeah i mean i think that this is most of the states that have had these systems have had them in place for a while um so there's a sort of a rich history and a lot of it is up to those departments of education to do a lot of communication around what does it mean to have this particular result on this on the accountability system what is that leading to you know and the point of having schools you know in the case that i showed you know if you're a school that maybe on that michigan index got a low a lower index score that's result is telling the state that you need

[04:11:44] additional resources that that's a school that the state department of ed needs to focus on needs to put more training into, needs to help and support, potentially drive more money to. There is, you know, funding for school improvement and school intervention and thinking about that.

[04:12:00] So telling, putting that into context, I think that for a lot of states, you know, they've had similar concerns and that might be one reason why they've chosen to go to more of a dashboard or Indiana, I think you called it a placemat, which was a new term, but the Indiana placement approach is that you know rather than saying this is an f school or this is a b school just presenting all the indicators side by side and saying here's how a school did on each indicator and making it really clear that you know a school didn't hit the target here um you this school really does need to focus on math um achievement and math growth that was a sore

[04:12:37] spot for this school but they're not summing it all up into that overall rating um there are probably a lot of a lot of things besides accountability that are also driving parental impressions of school quality and you know the patterns that we've seen of segregation um i certainly don't want accountability to exacerbate that but i think we also probably do need to recognize that accountability is not the only thing that's driving that um and we have that now in virginia with an accreditation system that is not doing it so i don't really don't want to exacerbate it but i think that there are ways that this board in driving

[04:13:13] this policy change could really mitigate that in ways that the department in terms of communicating this change that would be coming to superintendents and parents and divisions could help with that as well but i hear you that the placement approach has a little bit less risk of that than the summative rating i think potentially potentially i mean i think it doesn't stop folks though from taking the data and like doing it themselves you know like i think just look at grade schools right that's the state department of education doesn't do great schools and they're going to keep doing and they're going to keep doing it and that's what zillow uses you know just to remember i'm old

[04:13:47] and that has consequences so i remember virginia's legislature adopted an a through f grading system for schools 10 years ago and repealed it before it passed partly because we heard from the realtors so a summative rating it does have implications by hearing part of your answer is resources and this board unfortunately does not control resources but if we act in tandem with those who control resources i.e the legislature maybe is that the right approach

[04:14:22] to figure out how to mitigate one other thing here which is uh so the earlier conversation that uh katrina miller from sas showed is that achievement status measures are more correlated with income and demographics than growth measures and so that's one reason there's a tension between the combination of achievement and growth measures achievement are clearer achievement are where we want kids to go growth measures are more correlated to what the school controls and so it is a tension and a balance that by including both those measures we can mitigate against some of the demographic factors that yeah that's a really important story and i realize some of that's

[04:15:00] getting into the discussion yeah but i do i do have one more question that i can do now or after mr you may want to respond to him about this i just want to pause i can't help but like i mean yeah we don't control lots of things and we don't control the realtors why would we allow them to control us and what is good for kids like i'm not saying like there's a bunch of ways to design this accountability system but this is the entire problem right here in a nutshell is like is there anything more emblematic of just adult politics driving this than what the realtors think

[04:15:36] like with respect to the realtors we all like and use like we're not making real estate policy and they should not be making education policy and i think like the fact that we're sort of we have these conversations that illustrates a little bit why we're in the corner we're in and and so i just couldn't let that i just i think we like i just couldn't let that pass i think it just illustrates where we are and and the problem we have right now i was just gonna quickly say that and also even with respect to the legislature of the department um having this there to put pressure

[04:16:13] on especially for the lowest performing schools that's i think what the beauty of the system is so it doesn't necessarily have to be that the same entity is in charge of the system and the funding it's to have a system in place that will drive the public policy to meet the needs that this new system will help us identify well and and so to just to respond briefly and then i do have one more area of question which is the uh i didn't mean to say the realtors told us what to do the realtors raised the issue of the impact of our decisions on residential segregation and as we all

[04:16:52] know residential segregation has negative consequences for the achievement of our students so that was our concern um it wasn't because the realtors told us not to do it it was because of the issue that they helped us understand about the impact but i think to to chad's earlier point i think if we actually start to report this honestly people will realize demographics are not destiny which will work against the problems we have with residential segregation because people will see some of these perceptions that they may have about school quality and so forth may not actually be accurate that also brings us back to growth where we may well have we saw the the two by two we may

[04:17:31] well have some schools that are high achievement but really low growth there's you know have a lot of kids starting on third base and they're telling everybody they're hitting triples like the the transparency this can bring i would suggest can actually help us solve some of these problems and so i think i think i i hear what the realtors are saying i think they i think they have it backwards though on this

one well and that brings it to mr hansen's point which is resources maybe somebody else's decision maybe this can help drive resources i will say we also even though we don't decide resources we have a role to play in resources and we have an immediate responsibility on that with respect to our soqs so i hope that what this board chooses to do this fall with

[04:18:08] respect to the soqs helps trigger or helps further a conversation about resources for our neediest schools uh my my second line of questioning i think is a little more technical and that is as between the performance index and the proficiency rate those are really helpful to understand two completely well distinct ways of going about measuring performance with different implications which one is there any research or evidence you said some states have been using one or the other for a while is there any research or evidence or do you have any

[04:18:44] opinion or mr alderman have any opinion on which one best drives student success and and then us i'll just my second related question is can we get as we're as part of as we're thinking about these two can we get can you run this on the virginia data now to see what would it would look like across the jurisdictions and how would it you know help us think about how we're gonna as we choose whether to use performance index or proficiency rate how well does it help us differentiate our 132 divisions, our 1,800 schools? How does it help us think about how

[04:19:21] they're achieving proficiency and how we drive resources? Yeah, I think that this would be something that is definitely modelable if there was interest in seeing both. But I think it also needs to be thinking about this is where building a system, it's more than just each individual indicator. So you were asking like, why might it make sense to use performance index versus a proficiency rate. I think for states that don't have a progress measure, I would say, please use a performance index. If you're not going to actually measure growth, a performance index is much better, I think, in that case than a straight proficiency rate because they're not

[04:20:00] taking into account the progress that students who are not proficient make. So that would be sort of a clear-cut example of a case where I think one is a far superior choice than the other. There might be some states that actually just like performance indexes in some ways because they use them on other indicators.

[04:20:17] So it's a clarity of the whole system. We have a college and career readiness index, so we also want to have an achievement index, and they go together. I think Louisiana is an example of a state like that where all of their indicators are indices of some kind, even graduation rate. It's an indice of some kind.

[04:20:33] so it kind of gives coherence to the system as a whole and it's less about the performance index is a better measure of achievement than it's more about this makes sense because we want to make our system easy to understand for all the stakeholders involved um so i think you're asking i think it's a little bit contextual but this is the case i'm typically not shy about sharing my opinions and this is one where i honestly don't have a strong opinion i have a very strong opinion that virginia should measure achievement that's but i think that either of these approaches could work and

[04:21:09] as this process goes along it might become clear that one is a better approach than the other given the other design choices that are being made but i think that that's probably something that we can work through i don't know chad if you have a different i think that's right i think it's more art than science unfortunately at this point and i wonder if you could put back the ohio slide um one thing like the percent

proficient is a relatively straightforward calculation i think we you can all understand that this one no the one with the index weights this one um so one other thing that would be helpful for us thinking through options to present to the board would be

[04:21:42] like how you feel about a system like this that gives some weight to the different levels on SOLs as well as how to weight them so if uh Ohio gives 1.3 points for Advanced Plus they have more performance levels than Virginia does, and so any feedback you will have or thoughts or questions about this would be helpful for us as well. And one big question is that's a lot of performance levels, and so obviously I think we have to balance a couple of things. We want to be able to differentiate among schools, as Ms. Holden just said. We also want schools to be able

[04:22:22] to succeed. We don't want to set up a matrix, and that has happened in some places where school leaders are understanding they're like well we can't succeed under this and we don't want to do that and then third i think we want to try to do that without having like i do think virginia's performance levels i think we've lowered them in ways we shouldn't but the actual monikers on them in that approach like they're they're they're limited and i think there's something to that so talk about like this is a plethora of indicators so how should we think about it seems like you want you want fewer and you can differentiate with fewer yeah and even going like if if there was a

[04:23:01] state in the early uh asset planning process that had advanced getting 1.5 points right and a basic student getting 0.5 points so if you had two advanced students it would look like the school was doing really well and so it could overshadow people students at the lower levels and so i think that is a risk with how you design an index like this um the other thing is to anne's point is earlier point is it can be confusing so 81.2 percent is out of a possible 109 and that will

[04:23:36] vary based on the school that's less very based on clear and simple than a percent proficient which is out of 100 um that everybody is out of 100 it's easier to explain and reward points and i'm just even because there are these specific labels accomplished proficient this is awfully confusing for parents like are they like these terms like it could be a little hard to figure out what does that actually even mean you could go the florida proud approach of level one level two level three level four level five that's a different way but um the performance level descriptors that you

[04:24:12] choose do matter in terms of how easy to understand this would be for a parent and i agree that looking at ohio's the choices they've made around waiting this is more performance levels than most states use in their achievement indices yeah most states don't have seven weights and they don't have all the different advanced plus i mean with respect it sounds like an auto parts store it's hard to like um i i think it's hard for people with the difference between advanced and advanced plus you know it's one kind of the most point there i mean people have to be able to explain

[04:24:44] I'm thinking of a sports analogy, which is like, we all want to win the World Series or the championship. But if you look at it over time, like if you make the playoffs, it matters if you don't make the playoffs, it matters.

[04:25:00] So over time, being able to see the progress on the ultimate championship of proficiency, I think matters. The question, though, about all of these is what is the incentive? Meaning, is there an incentive to serve all students, particularly the students who need more support, or is there an incentive to focus on, you know, the proficient, like, you know, I know schools will say, okay, I got to get all my

proficient above to be at Advanced Plus, and so the kids are at the bottom, you know, because I get more points.

[04:25:36] So just talk to the incentives to how this structure has incentivized to serve all students, but particularly, I would say, the students who need us the most. Yes. So I'll take a crack and then you can chime in.

[04:25:51] So You Go Child Left Behind had percent proficient, and that was the goal. And that is what Florida is using in their achievement is percent proficient. that one of the drawbacks is then if someone's already proficient, the school might not care about that kid for this particular measure. Luckily, there's growth. They would still need to pay attention to their growth. They wouldn't necessarily be as focused on that. And same with someone who is far below proficient. A simple percent proficient may not give that school credit for growing that kid. Again, that's, again, why you have growth measure to supplement it.

[04:26:27] But this, an index does give more emphasis on paying attention to the particular achievement level that a student was at, and it's another way to emphasize getting students to the next level that they can reach. Okay, like in a system like Ohio is using, there is an incentive for a school to move that student who's at the limited level to the basic level versus in a great percent pass rate situation.

[04:26:55] A school might say, well, like, I'm going to just focus on getting the basic students to proficient. I'm going to leave the limited students for later. Like, that's a bigger challenge, but like, the easiest thing I can do to get a better result in the accountability system is just to look at those students who are closest.

[04:27:11] the proficiency cuts for. So that, I think, is one reason why states have preferred, states that have gotten the index red have done so for this reason. Thank you. Dr. Northern? I mean, just to that point, you can see the incentivize, I mean, you're going, if you get a kid from limited to basic, you're getting 0.3 to 0.6. If you're getting a kid who's already high achieving, you're going 1.2 to 1.3. So there is an incentive system built in to caring about every kid and how they're doing in a performance index my other comment goes a little bit earlier

[04:27:48] i think what would be helpful and we've done these calculations at ford and before is to show whoever like you can a a traditional system can penalize a school that serves a lot of high-performing kids right and you can have two different models and your one model cranks out a calculation where a high-performing school looks terrible because they've not made any any achievement, but they've made a lot of growth, but they're getting no credit for the growth.

[04:28:16] You mean low performance. Right. I mean, they're, they're low performing on achievement, right. And they, but, but you don't see that. All right. I mean, because they've, they've made a lot of progress and growth, but not achievement. And then you can take that same school with the same kids and calculate that whole thing differently and show that you're being more fair to, uh, you know, high performing, I mean, high poverty schools, right, high poverty schools, because you're actually giving them credit for growing kids.

[04:28:44] So I think that what happens, so we did this, and we were showing schools were getting A's under one accountability system, and then we took the same school, and they got a C, like when we, you know, kind of, like, so if you do 30% growth, if you do 60% growth, have huge implications but if you can show somebody you know what growth is more fair because it's actually giving this school credit for

growing kids when before it didn't get squat because the kids didn't reach proficiency so i do think that this gets in the weeds but actually

[04:29:19] showing you know we're talking about communications earlier actually showing that these um these actually these calculations matter because they do give schools that are working their butts off you know with with more challenging kids and populations that they're they're getting credit for for moving them you know so anyway that's i think that's like you've just summed up one of the biggest reasons why to potentially decouple growth and achievement into two separate measures because they're fundamentally two separate things and you you know just as katrina showed with her

[04:29:54] quadrant graphic like you want to celebrate those schools that have high growth and high achievement but you also want to celebrate those schools that may not have the highest achievement that are kicking it out of the park when it comes to growth and progress that's a great school and these might be some schools that aren't getting a lot of recognition and praise right now but really could be in a new system and then you want to drive all the supports all the resources all the interventions you can to those schools that are in that bottom left or quadrant that have low achievement and low growth because that's a really big red flag. Dr. Severt. So I agree, Dr. Northam. I think this is why

[04:30:33] the great conversation today already has been, this is not growth versus achievement, this or that. This is an end. This is an end proposition. And so I also think that's why, that's also the trap of a single summative indicator, you know, is that you've been, you conflate the two. So I think these are big things. It's very good. Your question a minute ago is about Ohio. I agree with colleagues rotherham that seven is too many um you know i i kind of come into this thinking well we're going to think about four if we're going to keep talking about nape let's just use the four of nape but now i see the benefit of like the approaching you know in the middle there the five levels i heard that maybe sashes is five levels so i think if there's even if they're

[04:31:12] different levels different things i think if we're dealing with the same quantities that that that might be beneficial um so that i think it is good i also think though um here but not like counted but we go back to the NAEP conversation we had from the NAEP director, I think he was a year ago, is we need to report below BASIC. We actually have to know how many kids are below BASIC, and that I think is important. The next thing I just want to do is I want to add a little historical context clarity about Virginia's A to F. Yes, lots of groups weighed in, including

[04:31:49] realtors. At the time, however, I had the privilege of working with a delegate who introduced A to F, and he himself the very next year repealed it because of a conversation that went like this. A single letter grade would not satisfy either of us. We had this conversation as dads. A single letter grade would not satisfy either of us for our child. My child's B. What does that mean? What about language arts? What about PE? What about chemistry? So we went and said, well, single letter grade is not sufficient. So we came to this idea, really what we need is a consumer report. And you certainly see elements of that in some of these other states, you know, multiple indicators all being rated out. And so the goal was to move to a consumer reports effort. Now through

[04:32:27] great well-intentioned processes, we got school quality profiles that became overly complex. I do believe that between the oversimplification of a single letter grade or a single indicator and the overly complex, you know, drill around websites and drill it out, there's something in between. And I'm excited that I think we're moving toward that. But the ADF repeal, again, lots of people weighed in but it was not

because of any one group it was because a single indicator what we wouldn't accept that for our child so how can we accept it for a school full of children that

[04:33:00] was the the tipping conversation there questions or Chad questions you want to ask um I hear at least some support for some sort of less confusing performance index um any brief observations on balancing growth and proficiency is your minds like 50 50 is your 75 growth 75 proficiency or you want to sort of wait and see and think about it for a while well i i before we get to that

[04:33:38] question i mean i just think like we do we can discuss it now because i think they're going to talk about the summative indicator because um i'm not sold at all on the idea that we don't need one i mean they're the part of the problem is when we talk about student achievement now it's like we talk about religion and everyone gets gets their faith and I think we have got to find some way to anchor this because if we want to send resources to communities that need them and to students that need them we've got to have very clear identifiable things and so I do I I think we have to figure out how do we balance um some legitimate concerns about summative indicators

[04:34:15] with real clear transparency for the public and part of accountability does mean that uncomfortable moment when when when you have to be accountable and i think i think so i'm happy to have the growth discussion but i don't want to i don't want to get off that because i suspect there's some different views around the dais and um i think it's a really important it's a really important point i think it's going to be a real pivotal point for for sort of how we decide to move forward so one of the things i would just say is the less complicated the better um you know

[04:34:46] the more we are able to communicate very directly, very understandably with everyone who is a stakeholder in this process, then, you know, the more that I have to explain the weight of this or the weight of that, that's just losing people, right? So I believe very strongly that what Dr.

[04:35:12] Siebert was saying is absolutely crucial that it's growth and achievement. Because, you know, at one point in my teaching career, I taught only advanced classes. And that was hard to see that, you know, of course, those kids should, should hit a certain achievement mark, right? But are they going beyond am I truly helping those students grow was my real issue and so I think

[04:35:47] that those things are confined um and but again the straightforward piece of it I think is really important as well so Ms. Holton do you have a comment thank you so uh I think the transparency piece is is incredibly important and obviously that's part of what we're all trying to get to

[04:36:07] I also, I would say the top criteria for me would be what's going to move student outcomes the most, what's going to incentivize schools and teachers and administrators to help all students have a successful pathway to the future, and especially our media students.

[04:36:28] So for me to say how to weight growth versus, well, first of all, whether to weight growth versus proficiency, i.e. whether to have a summative rating or a placemat approach, I love that new language, whether to, which of those approaches to go, and then if we go summative, how to weight the different factors, I really would love to hear from you experts from the states who have used these systems, what best incentivizes student success.

[04:36:58] and i think i'm confident that you all must have some research that tells us that yeah i know it's complicated because nobody does you know so south carolina adopted a system 20 years ago apparently but they also put financial resources in so it's complicated but help us yeah so i want to say one thing uh

we probably should table the summative rating discussion i do want to make one comment to respond to to your question and to mr rotherham's point is the there is some strong evidence that a A through F or summative ratings are helpful to schools.

[04:37:29] They spur some action and response. So the South Carolina study I mentioned had two lower performing categories that those are the ones that actually saw improvements. Similarly, North New York City had an A through F system under a previous mayor as a city level, and they got rid of the A through F system, and they kept all of the indicators in the dashboard at just as they were doing.

[04:37:54] of the A-F grades and student performance went down afterwards. The removal of the A-F system, the A-F grades saw a depression of lower performing students. So there is some value in having some transparency at the high level.

[04:38:10] Again, there's a political history here in Virginia, so I think we can have that conversation at a later time. What we're interested today is talking about the indicators and sort of the building blocks to something we can identify schools that need additional supports so we have to sign some weighting and balance between those building blocks to find those schools we don't have to necessarily give every school uh an a or a b or a c rating we just have to be able to find the schools that need more additional support so that's where the the index the combination comes in yeah so i i would i would

[04:38:45] say i mean personally i'm i'm intrigued by the performance index approach on proficiency and i And I think the folks we heard from and the wisdom here on the board suggests that we've got some real opportunity to improve on our current growth measures with using VVAS not just as we're using it now, but using it for accountability.

[04:39:06] So in terms of what our individual indicators are, I think we have some great opportunities to go forward. As between some of the different nuanced performance indicators and proficiency rate, I'd still love to see some of the data as applied to Virginia.

[04:39:21] I would love to see the DVAS accountability number used in an example with Virginia data as to accountability. I think that would help all of us. Does it differentiate in our schools meaningfully? You mentioned on the evidence.

[04:39:37] That's very helpful. I'd love to see that New York City A through F study. But South Carolina, I thought we said South Carolina is not a summative rating system. This was when the study was -- They were, but they're not now. So they had a 5-tier rating system in the early 2000s, and that's what this study was looking at, is the sort of long-term impact of those readings.

[04:39:57] Yeah. No, and I think the point that Chad made, too, that I hope didn't get lost, because I think it is important, is that even if ultimately Virginia doesn't go with A to F or 1 to 5 stars, five stars, we will say, has become more popular because I think there's a particular stigma about an A to F system and states like Maryland, Ohio have sort of moved to a one to five because they think that they prefer that as a rating system overall. But that even states that have the placement approach or just don't have an indicator, they do still need to have conversations though about how do we weight the indicators because part of what they use their accountability

[04:40:37] systems for is identifying those schools that need the extra resources. And they want to do that not based on a single indicator, but based on all the indicators. So when it comes to those decisions, even if that's not public facing, you know, a state like Indiana still needs to have conversations about, well, how

much do we wait growth? How much do we wait proficiency? How much do we wait college and career readiness for purposes of identifying those schools that are going to get extra help? Okay, so if you're trying to flush us out, I'll go. I think we have to wait proficiency substantially more i mean we just a few hours ago passed a set of mathematic standards that were about matt and were anchored in mastery and kids and so i think we have to be very careful

[04:41:15] we don't sort of say that in the standards for the kids and we do have high stakes tests for the kids in the state and then be like well no one else involved has to have any stakes so i think like parents they care about growth what they really care about is does my kid know this can can my kid do whatever the particular domain is?

[04:41:35] So I think giving credit for growth and recognizing that is important. And to your point, Anne, with your delightful mixed metaphor about kicking it out of the park. - I know, that was great. - But I'm sure my colleague, Lachey, loved-- - Bodgeball, kickball, kickball, kickball metaphor. - We have a kicker now.

[04:41:54] But I think we want to figure out a way to reward them that should be in there. But I think we disproportionately, want to know are your kids getting there that's the goal of the system the goal of the system is not just it's to actually get kids to these skills that we have determined and so i i would i mean we can get into quickly about numbers but i think we we need to um uh we need to weight proficiency heavily and then include the growth element i think i would just add you know some kind of so we have plenty of schools that can get the majority of their kids to proficient right

[04:42:27] it's how do you move them beyond proficient and are you giving them credit for doing that right and i think the one thing grace with it is madam president is that's got a big caveat of all else equal right now and also having a conversation about where we are on and so that could look different sure and that proficiency standard could look a lot more ambitious you know down the road depending on decisions that this board makes and then we'd want we'd want i wouldn't want i don't I don't want to hear if we don't rest on that because it could change.

[04:43:01] Can I ask a question, though? I know I'm going back to this morning's presentation, but about the Indiana placemat, those things that are on the slide, are those directly what is used to calculate that?

[04:43:17] So is that language that's sitting there that says percentage of high school graduates employed or enrolled within indiana one year after their expected graduation rate or graduation year are those the exact is that the exact language or in the exact way that that particular indicator is being rated uh i don't know if ann would know more i think um that's just an example of how it can be displayed um so you as a state we can decide which indicators we want to to wait and

[04:43:54] how we want to weight them to decide which schools need additional supports we can also decide how to display that information um in terms of some sort of placement approach or some other sort of ways to do it okay back to northern so this is a debate that people in ed policy have had for a long time do you wait growth or proficiency higher you know and some people are going to say oh they got to get to you know the the finish you know the place we finished so we should do

[04:44:31] proficiency and everybody says oh but you know you don't want to disincentivize schools that are working hard you know it would be unfair to the high poverty schools we need to you know growth is what incentivizes them uh and the truth is that we we do need both my personal opinion if you you know

really put me on the spot and i feel like that's where we are right now um is i would give growth a little bit more weight than i would proficiency because we're at a state place where kids are so far behind i don't want to be demoralizing to schools and administrators

[04:45:06] i want to be i want to get in that sweet spot of challenging them but not you know a nice stretch in terms of the challenge and not you know and maybe in a year two three we can revisit it and say you know what we're catching up from the learning loss and maybe we can now swap the equation and do a little bit more on it a little bit less growth so virginia's current system does in fact take growth more into account at the early grades than in high school i think you

[04:45:42] correctly point out that i i like to think of our high school measures as strictly proficiency but they're not quite because we do accommodate or we we take growth for english language learners into effect maybe that's just for reading i don't remember just reading just for reading so our high school standards are almost pure proficiency measures um and so in a way that i think helps the notion of growth more in the early grades but we want everybody ultimately to get to success so maybe there's something to be considered about weighting growth differently in the early grades versus the later grades and i don't know whether other states are doing anything similar

[04:46:21] yeah and you want to chime in on other what other states are doing on weeding either on this great band question or just overall yeah i think that you do see some of that i would say for sure with high school having a lower weight on growth for states that measure growth they typically do weight it more in the k-8 space than in the high school space in part because a lot of high school accountability systems have a lot of other rich measures like graduation rates like college and career readiness indicators but also to your point of there's no more time to get these students to reach grade level standards they're exiting our system is really

[04:46:59] imperative that by the time you graduate high school we want to get as many students as possible to meet our state academic standards um so you often see sort of that distinction between the the two systems. And I would say that as far as the mix of weighting and growth, you know, information is a little bit old because states have been making some changes now in response to the pandemic. But at least when sort of the new accountability systems came on after the Every Student Succeeds Act, I would say the most common would be a lot of states choose to weight

[04:47:34] growth and proficiency equally. They give them equal weight. I would say for states that weight them differentially. More probably take the approach Dr. Northern did of giving growth a slight bump over achievement, but there are other states that do what Mr. Rotham said and said achievement has more than growth. So I think if you were, but a large number of states give them equal weight or perhaps a slight advantage. I think in terms of like overall percentage to So typically, achievement is often with 25%, a third, up to 50%.

[04:48:13] That's sort of the range that you might see. And a lot of the states that have higher weights, the reason it is higher is because they're including science. So if you were not including science, but because they have more assessment data, then they sort of maybe have a higher total percentage going toward achievement.

[04:48:31] I often sort of feel like this is a Goldilocks problem. There's a too small. There's a too much. and you're kind of looking for the just right in the middle and so if i see a state like 85 achievement wow like how are you measuring the other things what does it say if a measure only has five percent weight it must

not matter very much um but then you see 10 15 like that feels a little low so i think most states have kind of settled in that spot of looking at a 20 25 30 35 percent as well from where they land i was just gonna to miss holton's point um if you go in our

[04:49:09] slides to um d item d attachment one you can actually see how this plays out so item d attachment one then you go to page 18 and again this is just the ohio example okay page 18 on the this is the cordom study yeah that's the report card example in page 18. page 18 and it'll it's

[04:49:39] table 11. it looks like this table 11 page 18 it says the overall rating system for school districts and selected school grade pan spans it was holton's point um you see states like this one giving different weights at different grade levels because of the measures that you do or don't have available so you know um achievement of progress they have given it 28.6 each and they've got graduation

[04:50:15] they've got a measure called gap closing they have an early literacy plan similar to what we've passed and they give that you know weight they're still working on their college and career readiness indicator so that's going to be added later but anyway this just gives you an idea of how you see the components and how they break out across grade levels depending on the data that are available thank you i uh dr northern i confess my homework did not extend to reading that study by the horderman institute which i very much look forward to doing and i'm curious if that or anything else you've got tells us you know is there any research on what best

[04:50:52] drives achievement for for all students but especially the low end and you know i'm curious even for instance the south carolina example why did they move away from a summative rating and maybe it's all the pandemic just made everything too hard i don't know i think that some of the strongest evidence that we have of the effectiveness of accountability systems driving student achievement does come from the initial implementation of nclb so you know we're going a while back but economic research takes a while to produce and i think what became really

[04:51:30] clear in some of those studies is that part of what made accountability effective is when there were clear consequences is probably the best word but if it was just accountability as a report card if all you did was report the data but then there was no sort of oh something different would happen in the school but when schools knew that if i you know fall into this category or something these things could happen in my school that really did spur changes in student academic

[04:52:02] outcomes, and that, so there is a clear, I think, linking your accountability system or whatever you would like to call it, accreditation plus, or, you know, linking that to your support system is critical, because otherwise it's just putting, like, paper out into the world, and that, yes, you know, we are hoping that it will drive parent behavior in some ways and make parents more informed about school quality and hopefully then demand, you know, change in their schools, but the best accountability systems, the most effective ones, did really have a clear component of what a state department of education would do something differently in schools that were

[04:52:41] identified as needing that support from the accountability system. But that research doesn't help, there's not research that helps us determine how much growth versus proficiency weighting we should give. No, and I think that it can be, you know, I look at all these different state systems

[04:53:01] And I see different weighting choices that are being made, but also one of the biggest differentiators, and this isn't a conversation we're having today, so I hope I'm not like taking us off track,

but the biggest thing that I think does make some state systems different is that there are states where at the end of the day, you know, regardless of how they weight their indicators, they have made choices that only put 5% of schools as eligible for those interventions.

[04:53:28] So it didn't matter how they waited. They did like they just then set the cut point for getting into intervention so low that it only identified 5% of schools or only one school or two schools serving Latinx kids in the state.

[04:53:45] You know, they made those choices entirely outside of waiting. But that really does make a big difference. And you see other states that have, you know, different waiting systems, but they have made choices in terms of, well, how do we determine that threshold for getting into support?

[04:54:00] that you see a quarter of schools identified for some form of support they're different tiers there's you know the most intensive tier and then there's a less intensive tier but that's a huge difference in terms of okay if I'm a school and I know that there's a you know five in 100 chance that something different could happen in my school as a result of this I take the system less seriously than if I think okay there's a one in four chance you know that this could mean extra resources for my school this could mean you know something something different or like more more attention from the state department of education which maybe um i'm hoping it's welcome but maybe not in all divisions

[04:54:40] um so that's i think it's just a big the biggest difference i see in states is not actually about waiting it is about these choices of how do we think about the schools that need supports and how aggressive are we going to be and i would argue coming out of the pandemic you probably need to be more aggressive than you were before dr coons i wanted to maybe we should take this session too but i was going to ask uh should we continue this conversation now or whether we should um hear the readiness portion as well and then revisit this towards the end of the day yes let's

[04:55:13] do that okay but ms ashton go ahead uh the last point i was just going to say and it's i think it's echoing mr rotherham's point which is we just set very high standards for our scholars and math and i'm thinking we need to set the same high standards for us as adults and the point that i think all this is just about transparency and so the but i've heard two different things it's like is this about helping improvement and about directing resources and i sometimes think those are not the same thing and that this is about a policy around setting high standards and

[04:55:52] And I think we should, it should be both, I like the lean a little bit towards growth, but not that much. And I think that, that, that comment, thank you, lends us to have a deeper conversation about truly discovering what supports and resources schools need, better targeting what supports schools need, whether it's recent, you know, particular resources.

[04:56:19] So, you know, it's not always the answer to just say, here's your extra pot of money, right? It's let's really get to the crux of the matter here and figure out how we need to support you better.

[04:56:34] How can we, and support isn't always financial, support is often boots on the ground, support is often increased opportunities for professional development, and really high quality professional development that gets to one particular source of a problem, and intense professional development.

[04:56:57] um and and not to not to leave out of this conversation what intense and very high quality coaching does in these kinds of situations as well to help provide resources to really needy schools in particular things so thank you so much for that comment um if we could just take a five minute break and

then i'm sorry dale did you have something that yeah i'm listening and uh i've heard a lot of different ideas and ways of doing business but there's really no one way so at

[04:57:31] some point we're gonna have to decide our way and move forward with that and sometimes we can do things to change the outcome for example absenteeism we push absenteeism and of course now schools need more resources so we have to look at what we impose on these school divisions when ultimate is about learning and as i've listened to the experts a lot of ideas a lot of concepts there's no one way so at some point i look forward to getting to our way of doing moving forward that's all i have my pleasure thank you um so with that can we take a five minute break and come back

[04:58:09] thank you come back together thank you and jad do i want to let you introduce our next speaker as well

[05:14:32] yeah so we've talked uh this morning we talked about growth we spent uh the early part of the afternoon talking about achievement and now we're going to talk about uh career readiness and readiness in general um and we have alyssa peltzman who's going to talk to us alyssa has been one of the leading experts on college readiness for i don't know 15 or 20 years and we're lucky to have her so i'll turn it over to alyssa great thanks uh it's such a privilege to be with you today um and i will be here as the independent consultant that i am and um also acknowledge as a parent including of a high school student this conversation definitely resonates

[05:15:08] with me as well um i know as a board you've previously discussed readiness um and so see this as a complement to the conversations you've been having to date and earlier today around achievement and growth um as the gentleman said earlier this is a both and um this is where this is the and part right um and so i want to set a little bit of context um very quickly just sort of make the case for why. It is clear that education is the linchpin of economic mobility in our society. Nearly all jobs require some post-secondary education and training to qualify

[05:15:47] for jobs that earn a living wage, where you can support a family, where you can thrive in our economy. Again, this relationship between education and economy is pretty inextricably linked. And as you can see on the slide, on your left, you can see the relationship between degree of amount of education and median earnings. And on the right, you can see the relationship in the inverse as relates to that same level of education and the unemployment rate. So how is important to

[05:16:22] note here, we've talked a little bit today, I think I went too quickly, excuse me, no, we've talked a bit today about the accreditation system already I don't want to dwell here this really is the context of what sort of exists currently in your index within your current accountability system or your accreditation system I should say what I want to do is talk more about things that other states have been looking to we're going to start here by looking at the non-academic indicators

[05:16:55] that are listed here for ESSA in states. Now, two-thirds of the states, this font is so small that it really does make me feel like I need glasses, but the visual is meant to make a couple of big points. One is two-thirds of the states comprehensively have included some form of college and career readiness as part of their fifth indicator in ESSA. The majority, if you look at the top orange arrow, have zoomed in on the importance of looking at chronic absenteeism.

[05:17:25] the problem of chronic absenteeism is widespread the data is readily available it's easily understood and research demonstrates a very clear correlation between attendance and achievement so

it's important to know just how high that is and then you can see and we'll talk a little bit about as well um literacy on here as well and i want to make sure i'll come back around to that in another slide but i wanted you to see both the range but also sort of the pattern um in terms of focus there so let's talk for a moment about attendance again students regularly attending

[05:18:02] school have better outcomes it is in fact that simple you have to be exposed to participate in the learning and in elementary school it becomes clear that too many absences become associated very quickly with lower levels of reading by middle school becomes an indication of early warning indicators for risk of dropout. I see a lot of nodding around the table. This is a measure that can be used at all levels of elementary, middle, and high school. And increasingly, there are ways of incorporating chronic absenteeism to think as well about the impact that the school has on the

[05:18:39] students showing up and what it means to be there. So again, you can see 27 states are measuring how many students are missing more than 10% of school, and Virginia is, in fact, one of those. There are additional ways of calculating this. I think the important point here is to reinforce the value of focusing and signaling chronic absenteeism as part of your system. I also think this complements the conversation we were just having on achievement.

[05:19:12] So, in looking at elementary and middle school here, you can see two suggested indicators for looking at literacy and math. And I think this is a point at which I would want to say there is clarity in the prioritization of these in states. There is tremendous momentum across the country with states like Virginia leading the way with focusing on early literacy. It is clear. I don't need to make the case to you why to do it. You've done it and you're leading on it. And so this is about how do you build it into your system, right, and the importance of doing so. Same thing can be

[05:19:50] said with middle school math. Again, looking at this from a lens of readiness, what does it mean to be prepared in that sense, to be prepared for the next step in high school in terms of thinking about unlocking higher levels of math, science, readiness for more comprehensive courses. Now,

[05:20:13] This is an existing framework that exists, but created by two organizations, Education Strategy Group, and Disclosure, I've consulted for them before, and Advanced CTE, Full Disclosure, I've been a part of projects that they've been a part of before, but they together created this framework.

[05:20:33] It includes seven categories. So, to our point earlier, even about a number of levels, things can be combined and made simple. I'm just sharing with you a framework that exists for how to really think about career readiness. These seven categories and the indicators within them, which are in the handout for Part E, are each supported by an evidence-based and have evidence of usage in the field.

[05:20:59] So, you know, as has been said, I think earlier today, you know, things we value and measure are the things that get focused on. This is a way of categorizing and thinking about readiness and what it means to signal what you're prepared for in terms of your next steps in post-secondary. I will note that the framework was also developed by a group of experts who've been working within schools, districts, and states across the country in the field and thinking about what that level of preparation is and what those next steps could mean. And so there are indicators within each of these as to means what you might measure and how that we can talk about

[05:21:38] in discussion. My hope is to sort of get through the slides and see the value in opening up to dialogue. I'm going to give you three examples. In fact, Anne referenced Louisiana in her previous

presentation and talking about indices and said that in Louisiana, their diploma indices, if you will, their diploma index shows differential weight to sort of incentivize. So what I'm showing here is that students can easily earn credentials within the state, and the more of those you earn, the more value that is associated with the number of points within their accountability system.

[05:22:17] you can see here where uh each level of the diploma and the credentials earned increasingly add up to more points with the highest being those who have earned both their high school diploma and an associate's degree while they're still in high school um so really an accelerated pathway designed to be aligned to career options within the state um important to note that actually as we sit here i don't remember if it was this week or uh last week the louisiana state board of ed is meeting this month in the month of august to talk about potential revisions to this index um in part

[05:22:53] frankly to think about ways that they can add more to it in particular they're looking at adding um dual enrollment focused on career technical education so dual enrollment is in there in a traditional academic sense but they're looking at uh dual enrollment focused on cte and they're also looking at work-based learning um so full you know acknowledging that those conversations about potential revisions and additions are happening, and that that is something that they're bringing to their board based on experience of using their index for several years now.

[05:23:27] Again, the font is small. I'm hoping you can see it individually on your screens or in your materials earlier, but this is Georgia's high school accountability system. This is an annual tool for measuring preparation. The College and Career Ready Performance Index, as it's called, is used for school improvement, accountability, and frankly, it's a communications vehicle for them as well. I want to acknowledge, again, I know the font is quite small, but in the middle there, pathways completion, again, signaling the percent of 12th graders who are completing a pathway, and again, you can see the different levels and types of pathways in there,

[05:24:05] and the college and career readiness signal there, the percent of 12th graders who, interestingly, the first of those lines, I'll just point to for you to see, the first of those lines signal that those students are entering post-secondary without the need for remediation. So it's not even that they are applying or that they are matriculating. They are actually successfully entering without the need for remediation. And again, there's a strong research base showing the relationship between entering post-secondary without the need for remediation and persistence and ultimately completion. So, would show that, point that out as well. I would also acknowledge that the bottom

[05:24:43] indicator here, work-based learning, this is a indicator that Georgia has already started to fold in, where students must earn a full credit as part of a career technical education pathway. So, the reason I say as part of is to just reinforce that coherence. I had mentioned earlier dual enrollment that was aligned to career technical education. Here it's the work-based learning that is part of a career technical education pathway, as opposed to sort of reinforcing the discrete actions, trying to think about readiness more comprehensively.

[05:25:17] One more example I want to give is Tennessee. The state recognizes and rewards schools and districts whose high school graduates demonstrate readiness for meaningful next steps. So this is the Ready Graduate Indicator in Tennessee, and would note there are multiple ways of demonstrating that readiness.

[05:25:39] As you can see, there's an assessment-based measure as an option, early post-secondary opportunities, that's what the EPSOs are in Tennessee, or a combination of those with an industry credential, or taking again a look at the combination of those with military readiness.

[05:25:57] I wanna add two notes to that. Industry credentials exist in many places. There are thousands of them. Tennessee is very specific and sets a bar for what it means for that to count on this list. So the state is actually evaluating those industry recognized credentials to signal quality, creating a list, and it is only the credentials that are on those lists that count in here.

[05:26:24] And I just, I note that because it's so important as we think about expanding the measures in any given sense to think about how to account for consistency and quality of those experiences. So there's a clear signal and criteria to define quality and a way of meeting it.

[05:26:42] And then also want to just acknowledge Virginia also being a state with a large military population, many military connected families, the recognition of military readiness and ASFAB on here. I believe there are 11 states that either look at enlistment data or ASVAB data as part of an indicator in their accountability system to signal military readiness.

[05:27:03] So I would want to just call that out as well. So what I'd love to do is pause here, see questions to clarify, and then really open for discussion, I think, with you about what would be most helpful to discuss in thinking about readiness indicators. I also asked Mr. Andy Armstrong to come sit up, Dr. Andy Armstrong, my bad, I apologize, to come sit up here. I don't know if I said this last time, but I think I did, and you weren't here, so I'm going to say it again.

[05:27:37] Dr. Andy Armstrong is our new assistant superintendent for innovation. He oversees our high school redesign, our innovative pathways for CTE in high schools, and all of our innovation work. So he can talk to you about some of the things he's thinking about and where we are with career readiness right now as well.

[05:27:59] Let's go back two slides. Yeah. Before Tennessee, Georgia. And then Louisiana. Now go back to Georgia. Yep. Bottom right-hand corner. Down in the college career readiness. Yeah. Thank you. That's what I need. Oh, okay. It's open. And this may be for Dr. Armstrong more than you, but these look like terrific examples. As I'm sure you know, Virginia has a fairly new college and career readiness indicator. Yes.

[05:28:44] and i'd just be interested in how ours compares to these what are we missing uh what uh might we consider adjusting based on those or and my my gut is that ours is maybe more analogous to the tennessee one or what are we doing that i think ours has a work based learning indicator and i'll wrap up with that you know how is ours working so far i think it just it was supposed to go into effect right at the beginning of the pandemic i think we postponed it but remind me where we are

[05:29:16] in terms of using ours um and how's it doing i will say we use ccri for the first year this year um we have a large number of school divisions asking for corrections and revisions on their ccri indicators right now i i think we've had some generalized feedback and i'm just giving generalized anecdotal feedback i don't have concrete feedback about the number of things in the CCRI and how complicated it is to figure out is what I have heard anecdotally from several

[05:29:51] superintendents and CTE directors in my school visits. So it may have all of the things. It doesn't include, I don't think it includes the graduation rate, the graduation distinctions because, well, no,

I guess it does include advanced diploma versus standard diploma, But it doesn't include some of those other and I don't think it includes college matriculation, but it does include the workplace learning in the military.

[05:30:19] And, you know, what what what are those recognizing implementation year one is an ongoing experience? But what are the what what factors are we using compared to what these other states are using?

[05:30:33] Well, I just, one thing, I can't, I'm not the expert in Virginia's model, but would just say the focus on outcomes versus participation is something to look at, particularly if you're trying to streamline data, when there are so many metrics, it is possible, and I'm not the expert in Virginia's model, but including participation and success outcomes for everything, while those tell you important things, particularly as you're expanding access, there are ways to streamline and really focus

[05:31:06] Focus on the outcome measures and think about ways in which you capture and use in an interim sense, sort of like as part of your implementation, capturing the participation. I'm sorry, go ahead. I could speak to other states, too, because I did.

[05:31:24] To the question of what other states are doing, I did a report, I think it's probably about two years ago, looking at how career readiness was measured for accountability systems. I think one of the unique things about Virginia is I think for most states that want to have a military readiness component, they do tend to use the ADSVAB as opposed to JROTC coursework.

[05:31:45] So I think that's a distinction of looking at sort of a coursework experience, looking more at did a student meet the qualifying standards for enlistment in the military or did they actually enlist, as Enlissa was saying. Another piece that it's not super common because states have different diploma requirements, but for states that do have advanced diplomas, that's often something they put in there.

[05:32:08] So the percentage of students that are getting like the college and career readiness diploma or getting the advanced honors diploma, that's a common measure that you will see. And I know Virginia does have an advanced diploma. The superintendent is reminding me I have a piece of paper in front of me that I hadn't looked at, but that does indicate that we do have the advanced coursework options, both dual enrollment.

[05:32:31] It's a numerator-denominator system, like you said, for Tennessee, but what gets you in the numerator is advanced coursework, dual enrollment, etc., or CTE finishers with a credential. So it is not just completion and not just participation, it's outcomes, work-based experience, learning experience, presumably is participation.

[05:32:55] Is our military one an achievement, an outcome, or is it a participation? It's harder to say. Either way, and I believe it's participation, but either way, it's not yet sending the signal.

[05:33:11] The student has successfully transitioned to the next thing. So they haven't actually enlisted in the military or earned a sufficient score on the ASVAB exam. They've completed coursework in high school. So the distinction there, so similarly on the advanced credit for the dual enrollment, if you will, you mentioned that.

[05:33:28] It's that the student has earned credit and completed that, which has a currency and will transfer with them. So on the military side, you know, looking at JROTC coursework is different than

looking at your enlistment rate or your ASVAB, because it shows the student has successfully applied and leveraged the learning from that coursework to matriculate to that next step. And then if I may ask, and I'm sorry, Dr.

[05:33:53] I don't know if you had anything to add, but a next step would be, okay, so one of the more obvious ones we don't have on here is the college matriculation. We have the advanced coursework that would set you up for transition successfully to college, but the college matriculation and and particularly college matriculation without remediation.

[05:34:13] Do we have the capacity through our VLDS, our longitudinal data system to hook up to get that data? Or is that beyond our capacity right now? - And that will definitely be within our capacity. And thank you all, sorry, Andy Armstrong. Great to be with you all today. And we will have that capacity.

[05:34:31] And I'm looking at this really from a 10,000 foot view at this point. And one area, Alyssa and I had a call yesterday that actually we scheduled before, even realized you'd be here today. And we discussed the nature of credentials in Virginia and what that means and why the credentials are what they are in the state. Are they tied to regional labor market data? That's one place where I'm really putting a lot of my efforts here in the near future, is trying to filter those down to really meaningful market demand credentials that we're awarding students that qualify under the accreditation system. So that's part of my work

[05:35:06] right now with our CTE department. Does our CTE currently, do we count you in the numerator if you are a CTE finisher, meaning you've taken at least two or more credits and earned a credential, is the credential list vetted at all for workforce value or is it basically anything? The credential could include now the successful pass of the Y certification,

[05:35:40] which is the certification that is associated with the e-com personal finance required course in 10th grade. So when we look at it that way, is that truly a credential that we want to represent our accreditation? That's an example that encompasses a lot of that for a lot of school divisions. And if I may on that, it's an area where the notion of keeping that list current to demonstrate value requires continuing to look at it. Cybersecurity is a growing area and this you know economy as well those credentials and what it means to be prepared are constantly changing well may i just suggest especially if we look at some kind of weighting system as we've been

[05:36:19] looking at on other criterias one thing you may want to look at is the list that chev used has developed for fast forward which is oriented towards in-demand careers they've already done the vetting rather than us having to reinvent the wheel yeah another dimension this is really coordinating that alignment with our higher ed community and our secondary and k-12 as well so i guess i'm really um always stuck on how kind of muddy this is um what would be your best

[05:36:56] recommendation on our to make this less confusing and much more transparent um and and quite honestly much more meaningful um what is your best recommendation here i think there's creating the u or the virginia version of a framework with the language that indicates sort of acceleration or momentum using your language right it's not adopting seven things in this way right but some way of categorizing that shows also the alignment between those components to say part of a

[05:37:32] successful pathway in signaling readiness is the coursework the advanced coursework that students are taking the sequence of a course of study or a program of study and career technical

education. So there's the coursework. There is the credentialing that needs to happen. And again, through a validated vetted list that has where post-secondary and workforce are sort of involved in this process along the way. And then also looking at work-based learning. And I think that while something like dual enrollment has volumes, literally, of research to demonstrate the impact

[05:38:07] that it has and the predictive value that it has on students graduating um and applying and matriculating enrolling persisting in post-secondary dual enrollment hall has all of that but work-based learning doesn't have as substantiated a research base it does have one and we know increasingly in preparing our students for the economy and helping them you know get ready for their next steps some of those skills they get from a work-based learning experience where you have the structure of there is a manager to that system there is learning that is translated you again

[05:38:42] i'm i want to come back to your question um but to show that and demonstrate that again helps the student and family know how with more confidence that student will be prepared for those next steps from a signaling perspective so i would think about what are the for me it comes down to the the coursework, if you will, which includes advanced coursework such as dual enrollment and a, you know, program of study, APIB dual enrollment program of study, right? Think about the credentials and think about the work-based learning and think of that in a connected sense

[05:39:15] as part of a coherent pathway. And I think there's great value in doing that. There are lots of other things that can be important at a more granular level it doesn't mean the state has to measure everything there is um some beauty in having some clear signals of focus that's um why the crispness to me of early literacy in elementary middle school math um you know thinking about transition readiness in high school and then the line throughout on sort of that chronic absenteeism that applies to all that all fits on one hand right i mean even if the sub components don't

[05:39:51] And it helps you tell a story about what it means to be prepared in your state for the next step, whether that next step is the transition elementary to middle school, middle school to high school, or high school to your post-secondary options. And I think having that sort of structure and some language that resonates with your team and, you know, with you as to what it means to signal that sort of readiness or accelerated opportunities, and then to know embedded under there, there are going to be multiple ways students can demonstrate it.

[05:40:19] you're gonna have multiple options for how that is met. Did I answer your question? - Yes. - Great. - Others with questions. Mr. Rotherham.

[05:40:35] - We still have our, excuse me. We still have our graduation composite index, correct? Crosswalk those two things. And I'm particularly interested in how we account for GEDs and how we weigh them in the calculation.

[05:40:53] - I am not an expert in that. And so I would love to defer that to- That was for anybody on the panel, particularly Anne, I thought you might know. Yeah, I mean, so Repinia currently for accreditation does include students who get a GED or not a standard diploma, including an Applied Studies diploma.

[05:41:18] So is recognizing those lesser diplomas in the index, they're not, I have the accountability manual up right now, so I don't know the exact way. It's not full credit for those students, but it's sort of like what we were talking about, the achievement index, a partial credit for those students who might be getting a GED, which is.

[05:41:38] - Yeah, I just wanna flag that as I think something, I just want to crosswalk those. And I've always thought we overweight GEDs given the research shows GED completers and so the non-high school completers actually have a fair amount in common. And so, and I don't think our index reflects that.

[05:41:53] So as we think about this, I just wanna make sure we're, early or earlier question about like, Are these industry-recognized credentials, making sure everything we're doing is actually weighted as the best research on, like, the value of it? Absolutely. And I would say that's where you could look at alignment to stackable credentials in partnership with post-secondary, particularly with your community college and technical college system, right?

[05:42:17] That's where, and not ending there, like, what are the building blocks from that, and what's the alignment and the exposure to experience aligned to high-priority labor market needs in your priority sectors by region and the state. So, and again, pushing beyond to that next step and showing using not just earning that, but using that to pivot or catapult into successfully the next step.

[05:42:39] Dr. Keynes. Alyssa, you've seen states doing different things like that. And where are you seeing that have a drive and an impact, that stackable component that you just described? Where is that working really well in getting students? I go back to Ms. Houlton's, what is actually moving the needle for kiddos?

[05:42:58] Where are you seeing things like that actually moving the needle? One state that comes to mind off the top is Colorado, which also gives credit for prior learning, which is a separate but related policy that's worth noting. But Colorado is also, to the spirit of transparency, each year the Colorado Department of Higher Education reports on post-secondary access and success.

[05:43:23] They also do a ROI study, a return on investment study related to their wage data and their credentials that have been earned in the state. And then the Colorado Workforce Development, I can't remember if the last C is Council, but they put out an annual talent pipeline report.

[05:43:41] And then K-12, higher education, the governor's office, the state board, folks come together cross-sector to look at this data in a meaningful way and to make sort of in progress, you know, tweaks as needed, either to what's being focused on, where do we need to either divert resources, what is in demand, in wage, what does that look like, and to the point of the sort of stackable, if you will, cybersecurity was what I mentioned earlier, an area that continues to evolve. MSU Denver within Colorado has built a range. They've now built two-year and four-year programs around

[05:44:19] students accessing it. Like, that's an iterative process and something that isn't static for, you know, we'll come back to this in five years and see if it's working. It's sort of looking at the data each year to see what employers need and value, how education is delivering on it, and sort of tracking student experience. So, again, it's a cross-agency effort to do stackable credentials well, and it definitely brings in your workforce partners as well.

[05:44:48] Ms. Holden? You mentioned, we're talking about wage data. I'm interested if any of the K-12 ECRI indicators are using, just like they're using college matriculation, are they using wage data that suggests, wage data at least a family sustaining wage level or some magic level?

[05:45:12] And then the question to Dr. Armstrong, like I did with college matriculation, is do we have the capacity through VLDS to link up to wage data if we wanted to? Obviously, wage data, matriculation data would be delayed by a year or more. But there is a way in which wage data gets embedded in some states, which is a little it's a step back, which is to say the state creates a definition of a high-quality pathway,

which includes student completing that pathway that is aligned to, and their language might be in-demand, high-wage job, high-growth, in-demand job. They'll have their specific language, and that often has a

[05:45:52] wage calculation with it, and there's a reporting as to whether or not students are either in post-secondary or able to look to wage data to see if that's the type of industry job that has been earned. And so it's not that they're actually calculating the total wages earned for students, but they know that that student has secured employment in a industry or sector that is pays a living wage. I don't have just gotten the credential for the industry, but gotten the job.

[05:46:19] There are places that are able to do that as well. That's, I mean, I would, that is an advanced approach. And putting those pieces together here in the Commonwealth is a work in progress, but we do have the capacity. I think we're, that is part of the work right now is leveraging all those information sources and developing those metrics that we can use to really chart our course with our credentials and with our workplace readiness. But I do think there's area for growth there.

[05:46:46] Absolutely. I'm a huge valuer of higher education and think we are right to be encouraging as many students as we can to go on to post-secondary educational opportunities. And yet, I think we all understand here in Virginia the value of folks going on to great career pathways that don't necessarily involve going directly to post-secondary education and i would hope that the vlds data connects to the employment commission just like it connects to chef so you know if people are getting good jobs without going to college and getting all that debt we don't want to discourage

[05:47:22] that in fact we want to encourage it um secretary gadara and i secretary slater are working to figure out how all the data systems talk well to each other we've had multiple meetings with business community with labor workforce and with cct employee to think about how we make sure those data systems are talking i think for myself if a superintendent's trying to make great decisions and know what that workplace industry um says and dr armstrom and i've talked a lot about this then they have to have a placemat of data that they actually can talk to so we're in alignment and we're working to make sure that happens so that it can feed something like this as well i know

[05:48:00] that's always been the hope that the virginia longitudinal order system would let us do that is reality takes time to catch up with that that data will be a bright flight flashlight soon i'm sure in this state right you'll be able to use it to guide decisions further questions or comments dr northern so um i've done some research uh in this area and one thing that i found in maybe three or four studies, was when kids got an IRC, the majority, I mean like 60%, did not end up

[05:48:35] majoring in the IRC in which they attained in high school, nor did they go into the same field of the IRC. And we're scratching our heads going, why did they spend all this time getting an IRC in high school if they had no desire to go into it into college or to get a job in this field?

[05:48:53] And so then we did a bunch of qualitative interviews with kids. And they said, they're more, they're just, they're hands-on. I like taking these courses better. I'm so bored in my regular classes. Or they say, you know, I just want to learn how to fix my car. I don't want to pay a mechanic $1,000 to fix my car.

[05:49:10] So I just took auto mechanics to learn to fix my car. Or, you know what, I just want to learn how to cook better. So that's why I took this, you know, cooking class. So like kids don't think like adults think,

right? Like we think that they're going to, they've got their whole map, you know, their life planned out and they don't.

[05:49:26] So it's not to say that these classes aren't important or useful, but I think what I take really seriously is the formation of pathways. And I think that Kentucky has done some phenomenal work in developing pathways. They've been at this a long time. And I think the other thing that we should think about is not only just, is it gonna lead to a high earning wage, high demand, which is all good, but we also wanna incentivize kids to think about the type of CTE courses they take.

[05:49:55] So like Microsoft Office, I think I've mentioned this before, and OSHA Safety are the two most highly taken CTE courses basically in most states. So it's nothing wrong, right, with Microsoft Office. There's nothing wrong with OSHA Safety, but why can't we just think about them in different buckets?

[05:50:13] So like these are CTE classes where you're exploring. Like you just want to find out whether you're interested in this, you know, and here's a bunch of classes that are explored, here's a bunch of classes that are actually um going to be stackable like if you start figuring out what you want to do with your life then these do stack like you know up to a nurse and then up to a nurse practitioner whatever and then maybe some that are actually going to lead to a two and four year degree like you're going to get credit for this like it's going to mean something so i think not only just tying to regional demand which is huge that's happened doesn't happen across the country either um but it's just thinking more carefully about how kids think about

[05:50:51] these courses and these pathways and building in some flexibility to think about it like they think about it if i may just a couple of quick responses the first one that comes to mind was a many people have had this type of anecdotal experience i was in marion county ohio talking with a student who was in a nursing program and she had completed coursework and credential and did her first sort of day practicum seeing a blood draw she wasn't passed out her head couldn't handle it was like you know and so she didn't work out a bit like good that she had that um experience as a senior fall of her senior year of high school and not after she's paid for because she's been accepted

[05:51:30] for completing her coursework so there there is something to be said for that exposure i think it also speaks to the importance of the advising system which is not what we're talking about today but we'd be remiss not to acknowledge that really quality advising addresses these issues as well, and it starts in middle school. So even if the pathway is starting later, that exposure and awareness starts earlier. In fact, yes, I'll leave it at that. And then to say that the pathways done well are sector-specific more so than job-specific, right? So that you are being exposed to the sector, and healthcare is a great example of that. You think of a hospital system,

[05:52:07] Think of all the types of roles within it, whether it's, you know, medical for sure, lots of those, but you can think about IT, you can think about marketing, you can think about patient relations, there are all sorts of roles within. So, it's sort of sector awareness becomes really important to that as well.

[05:52:23] And so, I just, I want to say yes to, I hear you, and I've seen that as well, and I still think the intentionality of sort of threading these things together and providing those early learning, you can think about as a continuum of exposure to, from awareness to experience, all the way to immersion and you're not going to jump all the way into immersion until you've explored it to find out if it's the right fit for you who knows uh president do you mind i have a selfish interest here steering is slightly back to accountability um so uh i want to feedback what

[05:52:59] i've heard on the ccri college degree ready index from the high school level is looking at rigor looking at high quality pathways, looking at outcomes versus proxies, making sure it's simple and clear, and we're rewarding things that we actually value. And so what I would think we might want to do is, Ann and I, as support with VOE and Dr. Armstrong, we can work and try to come back to you all with a list of what that looks like at the high school level. If we have time, I would be interested in other metrics of readiness. We put up briefly a discussion of elementary and middle

[05:53:38] school potential indicators, and I wondered if there's any feedback from the board. Alyssa, can you put that slide back up? What we wanted to have get feedback on was, it doesn't mention it here, but chronic asmonteism. They're not on the same slide anymore, so there's that slide.

[05:53:58] and then and then this of measuring literacy in elementary school aligned with uh virginia's investments in literacy and then in math virginia's done a lot of investments in getting advanced coursework more students taking and passing math courses um so want to put those on the table hear any reactions or conversations about those questions too dr siebert um i'd like to almost take those in two parts because really the segue here is i wanted to come back to those slides about the chronic absenteeism piece because we've had tons of conversations in here about that topic also as you pointed out is highly correlated with achievement and outcome other measures

[05:54:37] um and so if we're putting our our primary emphasis on achievement um then we're also going to be picking up so so but to the college career readiness piece absolutely uh again grew up working dad's female whatnot so so we the the being at work and being on time all those things is hugely important when you on that chart where crack of seals was at the top are you saying that states are reporting that that they're measuring it and then if they're measuring it how does it weight out that those graphs were the weights that are assigned to them no that was the number of

[05:55:13] states that chose the indicator so they are building it in as their sort of fifth indicator under essa and i will say with all of these measures they range quite a bit um from anywhere from as low and i think ann brought this up as low as five percent to as high as above thirty percent right so with most of them sort of in the you know depending on the measure like and it and it also varies from elementary school weights to high school depending on which indicator that you're looking at at that time as well um so there's no one right exact number or um it doesn't make sense to really uh give you a sense of that but that's the number of states that are saying chronic

[05:55:51] absenteeism is something we are going to calculate we're going to report and we are going to use in our identification of schools to determine um necessary supports awesome and so my follow-up to that is is that within college career readiness or is it standalone depends on the state it's often standalone because the it or it could be a meta indicator with other things um as part of school climate um as an example it could relate to engagement climate do either of you want to jump in on that well i was going to say uh and might want to add on the waiting what i want to

[05:56:30] say is just put this on the table is nationally attendance rates are are really down uh they've roughly doubled uh chronic absenteeism rates have roughly doubled during the course of the pandemic uh virginia is similar although virginia is not as high as some other country of other states nationally about 28 percent of kids were chronically absent last year i think in virginia it was about 20 percent um according to a national study that just came out a couple weeks ago so this is a challenge that schools all

across the country are facing um and uh it's a question of how we want to embed it into and that is also where i'm trying to go with this because we go

[05:57:08] back to last time ann was here talking you know it was about accountability indicators should also be largely things that schools have control over i'm not minimizing the profound importance of attendance because it we've got to get them into school if we're going to be able to retrieve them but again i also know that you know juvenile court justices in our in our region if you don't feel like they have enough tools i mean it there's it's a very big complex thing that is hugely important i think is a factor and it absolutely needs to be reported i just i'm wrestling with what kind of weight does it get when compared to other things um the schools don't have as much control

[05:57:46] over yeah i mean i think that's why if you think about the three buckets that we sort of have talked through today with achievement growth and now this readiness or other whatever you want to call it for the most part states weight those first two growth and achievement more so those are kind of the primary measures i think in part recognizing that they're really directly related to student outcomes they seem to be pretty much like in the school's wheelhouse um it's a slight nuance so i would say between that's definitely true in the elementary and middle school space i think when it comes to high schools some states it's this is not about chronic absenteeism but the readiness

[05:58:26] measures that alissa was talking about when it comes to dual enrollment work-based learning like that is actually weighted very significantly in some states but chronic absenteeism is often not weighted significantly in high schools. It might be a 10% or a 5%. There's also a way, another way that's sort of emerging. We'll call out the working paper from Harvard and the Fordham Institute has had a paper as well, looking at value-added chronic absenteeism and taking a look at that, which is another example of both and, so this is another bold and, where you would report both and look at both. And it's sort of analogous to our conversation earlier about growth and status. So

[05:59:05] So you have your sort of raw number of what it is, and I hear your point. But by looking at a value-added calculation, and I won't get into all the details, but at a very high level in a non-technical sense, you're looking at the total number of class periods.

[05:59:21] For instance, a ninth grader would be in across the year because of issues in particular with partial absences in high school. So and it controls for demographics in a different way, and it's a very stable measure. And so there are ways of which, and we're not talking today about like the how to calculate, but there are ways of controlling for some of the concern you're raising and still valuing the importance of that signal and the value added.

[05:59:47] you know indicator has it it speaks to the fact that the school can impact student attendance because that's been the research on that again shows that there's a high correlation from students sense of safety within a high school and their presence in that high school you keep belonging yeah safety and belonging so i wonder too how that um can come in how we can kind of pull those things together with what we do sort of already have in place which is the requirement for school climate surveys how did those did those in other states play any role

[06:00:26] or factor in in any way to these discussions that we're having so that's something that i'd like to explore because ultimately that does impact whether a student is successful or not if they don't feel safe they're absolutely not going to be successful or as successful as they could be so um if you guys could elaborate on what you know about that that would be awesome don't you click back to the slide the really

one the hard that's the one that's hard to read the arrows um so there are full climate surveys are on this uh slide i'm trying to figure out exactly

[06:01:05] where they are i'm like scanning my eyes like blue yeah it's a light blue one there eight yeah so it's a handful of states and more than eight states have school climate surveys but i think there's a question and the conversation is often of do we want to sort of put these surveys which were you know sort of developed not necessarily with accountability in mind but with other purposes in mind do we want to put them into accountability um or do we want to keep them outside of accountability but certainly use them in like school needs assessment you know if a school is identified for support like that's probably one of the first sources of data you want

[06:01:42] to look at is if you have a school climate survey like let's look at that in addition to our achievement and our growth data and our readiness data um so while eight are using it for accountability there are definitely more states that are using them in the broader pool improvement um system or reporting results so maybe not catching stakes to them okay just if i wreck to the extent i miss

[06:02:04] I recollect this conversation in Virginia. I think Virginia, like many in that 36 chronic absenteeism, I'm a big believer in recording and using chronic absenteeism with the appropriate weight, and I don't know what that is, but when Virginia adopted chronic absenteeism as our non-academic indicator in ESSA, it was because it was the only thing we had that met the data requirements of the Department of Education, where we had enough data differentiatable,

[06:02:32] And we had the, you know, and I think that the rareness of school climate surveys had to do with many of us had either a nascent survey or no survey at all. And we wanted to adopt one, but to adopt one and get it in use broadly enough to meet the ESSA required that you have enough data and differentiatable in various ways, it just wouldn't work.

[06:02:58] so basically everybody defaulted to chronic absenteeism because everybody had absenteeism data and we could differentiate it up the wazoo anything else ashton yeah sorry yep um just a couple things um i have a high school now and kids don't come to school because they're working or it's boring that's really it um and so the the thing about these indicators that i'm wondering about is some of them are lagging and some of them are leaving and so specifically with attendance i

[06:03:37] pulled up my school attendance three times since we've been here today i'm thinking wait what are we doing tonight and tomorrow morning to get kids into school and so it's not just you know do kids show up you can actually do something with that data pretty immediately whereas some of these things you have to wait a whole year and then you've got to you know adjust so i just think as we're thinking about this there's the tools that an accountability system says okay as a state here's this lagging indicator now we can put some resources across the state to address but there's

[06:04:15] some things that school people need to be able to do immediately and making sure that they have the resources to be able to do it and yeah so that's mostly so i'm looking through this like which ones are going to help a school person today and which ones are going to help us set policy like for today for tomorrow so trying to figure out those two there's the today there's the longer term but there's also the interim for some of those course-based experiences in high school you may still be if if you know in october you can still inform what happens for second semester right by

[06:04:50] the time registration happens or what have you so some of it is like within here um as well so attendance is probably your best example of the next day or to your point by monday or if you're a system looking at the first 30 days and the research behind the attendance patterns students have within your building the first 30 days of the school year um so uh i hear you on that um but But I do think a lot of these high school, you won't be able to analyze and use the outcome data until afterwards, but you can look even at outcome data as an indication of what you need to do around enrollment and that sort of thing.

[06:05:28] It's still sending signals to a school, and I think so much of this is about signaling. You're showing what it is you value. You're showing you value multiple options for students in high school, and hopefully by doing that, you're helping with the engagement level as well. Justin Ewert: The feedback on the other potential elementary and middle school things either the sort of extra emphasis on literacy in elementary school and the extra emphasis on math and middle school and if I said that right extra emphasis on literacy in elementary extremists on literate on that middle.

[06:06:06] Justin Ewert: And i'll just say a little bit about why so literacy, we know that it's important for kids to be able to read fluently by third grade there's lots of research suggesting that. that is sort of a benchmark that if they're not reading fluently by third grade, it leads to some long-term, potentially bad outcomes. And math, there's two reasons for that that we threw it out there. One is that Virginia has historically emphasized getting more kids to take and hopefully pass advanced math in middle school.

[06:06:36] And the second thing is that middle school math is one of the areas that kids are farthest behind. And so to give extra credit, give extra emphasis for middle schools to refocus on those things. And it's a gateway to a lot of post-secondary options in STEM.

[06:06:51] You know, think about sort of growing career jobs, too. But content itself, like multiplicative reasoning and modeling and the things students are doing apply across all sorts of job sectors. It's math that's relevant to your daily decision making. So I understand and and concur with the analysis of their importance.

[06:07:11] That's why we've passed the Virginia Literacy Act, and while we're doing everything we're doing on literacy. I what I don't understand is I mean I understand these are relevant to career readiness. But is it useful to measure them as part of a career readiness indicator for accountability, as opposed to what weight we give to them?

[06:07:31] I mean, to me, that's those are our academic achievement indicators, and it may the particular importance of third grade literacy and high school credit in middle school might be something we want to think about as part of our academic. But you're you're mixing me up. Why are they here in this conversation?

[06:07:49] Yeah, I mean, this is and hinted this earlier is sometimes the the career readiness label might be confusing for elementary and middle school. So if we think of them broadly as readiness indicators, that's sort of a better definition.

[06:08:04] If we call them readiness in elementary, we care about literacy readiness and middle. We're going to emphasize math and readiness in high school is all about the readiness transition is sort of how I think about it. it's not entirely well that helps that helps i will just say i i wouldn't want to take away from i mean i do think these workforce readiness indicators are are really an important addition that we have made to our accountability system even though we're just starting to make it work and i would hate to

dilute that but i hear you wouldn't necessarily dilute it because that's really only high school and you don't want to also you want to capture the high school but you don't

[06:08:42] want to lose those states that are further ahead in where they are with that are also saying but we need to signal what that looks like in middle school or elementary not make the signaling seem which is why the readiness label if you label carries through nicely but you don't want it to seem like you're starting career readiness um your 11th grade year right so why would it just in why wouldn't we just use the terminology readiness indicators because you're going to ask you're asking kids to show to demonstrate readiness from elementary to middle

[06:09:17] to high school and even into post-secondary education absolutely so um it just it's it's different indicators at those different marks and so um you know then that gives us that gives us a a bucket, if you will, that maybe is specific to one particular level. However, they are maybe they are just differentiated for what exactly that level is. And so I'm not, I think that's

[06:09:53] probably why I've had such a hard time with having the CCRI anyway, because then you have nothing to do with that in elementary and middle school. So I think for a transitional approach, that's something that needs to be carried forth K-12. The readiness language also lends itself well to collaboration with early childhood and with post-secondary. And the, you know, the indicators that they are looking at as early childhoods preparing for kindergarten, as your post-secondary system, two-year and four-year, even, you know, articulation and transfer within, that readiness

[06:10:28] language carries across the entire education continuum and and we have had a a rather large importance that we've placed here in the state of virginia on generalized school readiness for a number of years and so that continuum of readiness is is extremely important um and so i do think that that's a great pk-12 um discussion dr siebert yeah you've asked us a question several times today that i'm i'm going to go ahead and throw out there i just want my colleagues to know this this is

[06:11:03] like not a recommendation this is thought but first i do like this idea of readiness being a crosscut indicator i like chronic absenteeism being part of the readiness indicator uh but people think allen's against crack have seen no right now in our accountability system chronic absenteeism can do as much to a school as failure of low achievement that's right you know and so right now it's weighted like the same which that's what just does my so so i i like this but you've been asking us several times nicely through the day what would be so i've come up with this idea it's like we're building a mosaic um and we have certain tile pieces every state uses certain tile

[06:11:42] pieces we cut them we shave them and we we place them in how we want and so i've started thinking about it not just as the placemat we saw in india in the morning but with the size of this right Right now, like the placemat, even in South Carolina, all their squares are the same size.

[06:11:57] But we're talking about weighting things. So to me, the size of the square on the placemat could indicate its weight. And so, again, hypothetically, our achievement, and that's the thing I want to say and clarify, we have to treat elementary, middle, and high school differently. Okay?

[06:12:13] And I think those, based on the Ohio thing that you shared, help us come back to a district measure, which I think has largely been lacking. So I think these pieces are starting to come together. That was always going to be the details. But at the elementary level, if achievement and growth are the two

biggest squares, and let's just say that they're equally rated, maybe the reason we're doing equal is because achievement perhaps is just the raw pass rates proficiency or not.

[06:12:36] And I think we need to run some data there and look at that. I think early literacy with what we're doing with Virginia Literacy Act is its own little rectangle, and it's probably third grade. I don't think it's as big as the other two, but I think it's on the dashboard placement, whatever we want to call it. I'm uncertain what maybe goes in maybe a fourth one.

[06:12:53] Because, again, I want to avoid the trap where we have just so many squares and rectangles. That is just we lose it. I think we've got to have some focus. I think focus, one, helps people focus. I think it also lets innovation happen in other places. If we try to micromanage everything, I think we preclude some innovation.

[06:13:10] In that fourth quarter, I'm interested in what my colleagues think. I like the gap closing piece kind of appeals to me. But I also like the improving the lowest quartile piece. The reason that appeals to me is because every school has the lowest quartile of students, and so every school could be working on their lowest quartile of students, and so at the elementary level, I see the achievement growth, early literacy, perhaps lowest quartile gap closing, and this little thing across the bottom called readiness that picks up some things.

[06:13:39] And I will skip middle school for a minute because I've served in middle school and it's its own animal. High school, I think the largest square is graduation and graduation, including I like the even the NEP piece about still enrolled for the fifth year.

[06:13:54] Because if we're truly going to individualize for children, we need to recognize that as we raise the standards, it takes we got to be more flexible with time. And for some young people, it takes more time. So I think the five-year graduate in high school, I think that's something to be celebrated because they're still enrolled, they're still plugging along, you got them.

[06:14:12] I think achievement and growth are there, but they're probably a little bit less. I will push back a little bit, even though I'm a science teacher. You know, as Isla pointed out, that the science in Virginia, we do just pass rates. But those science tests, especially in grades five and eight, are multi-year tests.

[06:14:28] So they're really not terribly helpful in that regard. So I think when you think about what are the achievement and progress measures in high school, but I think they could be there. I think their college career readiness, or maybe it's called readiness, is a bigger square than it is the line drawn through the other ones. And then maybe there is still a gap closing there.

[06:14:44] I think at the middle school level, achievement and growth can still be the two big ones, probably about equal. But I think their readiness, what I heard lately today, which appeals to me based on my prior experiences, is that there's a high school credit attainment celebration that happens in middle school.

[06:15:00] Because, again, Virginia already has a really clever thing to code. you're a middle schooler and you take a high school credit course and you're bold enough to try but you don't do well you can take it off your transcript you know no no harm no foul and so what that gives us the opportunity is we think about mathematics achievement and also the harsh reality if we want kids getting career credentials we gotta have room in their schedule their junior senior year and and that's hard to get unless you're getting some high school credit attainment in in the middle school level and i think you know that the algebra one piece

uh is is a great one i think this might be one where you give a multiplier factor for the kids get in geometry while they're in middle school you know there's some thoughtful things that could be be done there i also think middle school though while it has the high school readiness piece of

[06:15:39] crash entertainment has to honor its elementary roots where it probably does have either a gap closing or again improving that lowest quartile of students because in really middle school you you have eighth graders who are basically high schoolers you also have seventh graders that are still you know working on basic skills so that appeals to me and then i like you know looking a little bit at the higher piece again about how that flows into a district level um that's kind of what i'm thinking and i'm really looking forward to what is crystallizing for all these other smart people he's got a beautiful notebook of piles like a divided plate like yeah for like

[06:16:17] infants you know like a beautiful mind over there exactly i have one idea that maybe a really lousy one and i'm totally open to the idea that it is but like so we're measuring math and literacy achievement elsewhere and so we're here like and and if this is kind of where we're going already i feel like this could be a place to really embed practical measures so like lexile score kinds of things apparently you can say like what it means to actually be ready here is to be able to read

[06:16:50] like a newspaper op ed page uh pamphlet from the dmv whatever it is and to embed these in really real ways and then probably some analogous stuff on math and to move away from because if we're going to capture the traditional measures of meat breeding math which i obviously think are quite important but if we're capturing them elsewhere um this may be a way to put in some authentic measures that again i'm looking at my colleagues i'm looking at that may well be a really lousy idea may i this president i'm sorry i'm being asked two questions yes

[06:17:25] just so it's allowed so i so it is at some point before we get too far along uh uh we should hear from the hb 585 am i doing the right sb 585 passports on assessment and where are you know where are we going with our underlying assessments and you know i would love to have us be looking at lexile scores but i don't know that we certainly don't have that available to us at the state level at this point could we get it but then again why should we be getting it shouldn't our assessments be capturing that and if they're not capturing that what's the matter with our assessments yes

[06:18:03] i think i would also just want to one point on that too is that maybe it does feel like you're doubling up on third grade or you're doubling up on middle school math but the achievement measure will not in most states be like here's the third grade math achievement indicator and the fourth grade math achievement indicator it's just school-wide right so it is putting a hyper focus on an appointment like an exclamation point on extra attention for the third grade and it's sort of the same thing with middle school math students taking the algebra one assessment in middle school math are part of the math achievement but they're not called out and sort of an extra really push so

[06:18:39] more just putting like a bold on those particular grade levels and that particular advanced course taking that you don't quite capture with just a straight achievement measure. Ms. Houlton, I'm going back to your question about Lexiles. So there are states who do Lexiles. It's part of the procurement process for your vendor. Right now, our procurement, our contract with our current assessment vendor does not have that included. It's definitely something we could put into an RFP. I will flag, and I would be remiss, and Shelley would be very upset with me if I didn't say how long that procurement would take.

[06:19:14] So I don't know if you can go in sync with that part of the conversation. Just wanted to kind of give additional context to your question. And Dr. Koons, would it require a separate assessment or could it be built into the SOL assessment that we would get an SOL score and a Lexile number for each student?

[06:19:36] Several states incorporate Lexile based on the assessment items. It would just have to be part of the assessment design to make sure the items are able to capture that Lexile level. So it would have to be part of that RFP because it would be a change in the assessment items to capture that data. So back to Mr. Rotherham's question, whether it was a lousy idea or not, I would say, I would hope that these are things that the HB 585 Task Force and what comes out of that, and I do, I know that the procurement process is long and complicated, but I'm hoping what our, that the 585 Task Force

[06:20:10] are going to help us make our assessments better and that their work is going to feed into our procurement process. And whether or not adding Lexiles into it is the best improvement we can make or whether there are other improvements, I'm really hoping our wise gut friends on that task force are going to help illuminate for us at some point. So I think the task force is scheduled to meet on September 8th. Katie, correct me if I'm wrong, in the middle of the day to review the final report, the report has been drafted. It is going to be sent out to the 585 task force tomorrow afternoon for them to review and give feedback next week. So that is rapidly coming.

[06:20:51] So another option for things like this is in the curriculum frameworks document, you know, where we give teachers examples of what kids should be able to do at certain grade levels. I know that different companies give that to parents. Like if your kid, determine if your kids on reading grade level and chat to some of this stuff that your child should be able to read this you know so there are other ways to I think you know uh integrate some of these um like you know ideas in the real world um my other thought is I like the Tennessee model on page slide 10

[06:21:27] um for one reason I like I can see us as the conversations evolving around the table that You know, we have an elementary, we have a middle, we have a high school readiness, whatever that is. And then it's one bucket. So to be considered ready and elementary level, you must have one of these four things.

[06:21:45] And then boom, boom, boom, boom, boom. Right. So in that way, it doesn't look so clustered and everywhere. And in the case of like, you know, readiness at the high school level, one thing might be you don't need remediation when you get to college or you actually get a 21 on the ACT.

[06:22:04] You know, there's ways of like measuring readiness differently, which is what we're seeing here. All the EPSOs, I love this, instead of calling it dual enrollment AP, they just put them all together. These are all like, you know, early post-secondary opportunities.

[06:22:20] So I don't know. And I like this that, you know, we can have an ASVAB score um or we could have uh you know some kind of apprenticeship maybe can go in that bucket but anyway all i'm saying is that i like the way that they've organized this very simply and i can see it being replicated at at the three um major grade bands anyone else here i also like what we've discussed today in terms of possibly future proofing some things and this kind of came up to

[06:22:53] me based on what uh um was saying about um when we get better assessments you know if we if we again my my follow along is you know which it was the car before the horse assessment versus accountability system etc but if we go this kind of modular approach then that gives us and future boards

the opportunity to look at a piece um at a time and then you know maybe reweight things if they so choose but it also means that if we build this right now again we talked this morning there is there is a confidence issue in the field with our current assessments and so but if we build out

[06:23:29] a good model and then we bring better assessments to bear then we increase confidence in the entire accountability system and so i think this kind of modular approach could could help future-proof some of our future work what else anything else from you chad no this has been very helpful i appreciate dr siebert's mosaic approach and uh it's a good metaphor i think for our discussions

[06:24:00] thank you i guess we will go with item f then um oh excuse me god do you want to do with item f um yeah i will reflect on the day i'm happy to capture some of the conversation in terms of how i'm hearing it and um if others want to jump in and either amend what i have said or uh continue

[06:24:38] this conversation um so uh morning i felt like people were fairly confident or comfortable with the sas type of growth model approach given some of the discussions that have happened in virginia um the ongoing build out of it and uh to the conversation we just finished of its adaptability to a new assessment can be adapted for new things so um that was sort of my takeaway from this morning on the achievement conversation i felt like there was more support

[06:25:12] for some sort of index um type model uh we currently virginia currently uses uh percent sorry proficiency bands and so we could build those into an index it's not as many bands as i think i think we want it to be a little more straightforward than that if if i'm is everybody in agreement with that i'm not sure that i mean we've dealt with these weighted issues and and that still sits in our current system so i'd like to kind of hammer

[06:25:47] that out a little bit more i mean is that the direction we want to go in do we want to continue with do we want to make this far more easily understandable and transparent or do we want to continue to to i guess for lack of a better term kind of have some muddy waters and i'd love sort of your just just your direct not direction but input there i guess no i mean i think if effort and i hear you a hundred percent of the simplicity question so i

[06:26:23] think if we were to bring a model that had an index in it i think something simpler than what the ohio system yes and it's also there are cases of indices i didn't mention this but states that actually just do an index that gives partial credit for below proficient but they don't give extra credit for advanced like some people do that so like there are ways of a model where it's you know far fewer levels um than what ohio has done that help make that easier to understand i

[06:26:57] think one of the other things that it can be confusing about the way that it's presented is then it becomes out of like how do why is there 109 maximum possible points what does that mean um so i think ways that we could think about could we make it so that the maximum is 100 points i think like it's unsettling things that it was like it then becomes a simpler scale um so i think that would be something if i think the main question that would be helpful for the board to wrestle with is like in an ideal world measuring achievement do you like the idea of looking and

[06:27:35] including those students who are above proficient as well as below proficient and then it's chad and my job to find the easiest simplest way to do that but if you think that really you know we want to have this it's most important to laser focus on that proficiency level and you know we don't want to give partial credit for below basic or basic and what you're saying is weights are not weights i think is what i've heard

them define it as i think you're using so do they want weights for the levels of rating for a student or do you want yes you were proficient and no you're not

[06:28:09] on the achievement measure i think those are the two places we're at i'm just clarifying what you were saying and that like we heard the criticism the ohio's model is not the one that this board would like to pursue because of how complicated it is but i think that we could come up with an index that is far simpler okay so so if i may just yeah i would i like the idea of a performance index if you can figure out how to simplify it and and so i think there may not yet be consensus around

[06:28:40] the board on it i also my my like is um a tentative one because i i really would like to see some data on what how does it help us differentiate schools in virginia and and run some data models so if you all can come up with a simpler version and then run some data on it that would be hugely helpful for me to help think about that the one other thing i wanted to just say on that is that there is some degree to which it well all the pieces fit into the whole so for instance there's been

[06:29:15] some suggestion that we might align our cut scores with nape proficiency if we do that and use a proficiency rate analogous to what we're using now without giving any credit for those who are almost proficient or those who are more than proficient then we're going to have you know most 60 percent of our schools are going to be 70 possibly not proficient our students are going to be and therefore our schools are going to be and just the demoralizing effect of that

[06:29:50] and yet on the other hand if we're going to go to uh proficiency as our cut score and then we use a performance index to uh give some weight to students who are almost proficient or who are more than proficient then it it would moderate the demoralizing effect of it perhaps there would still be plenty of call for action i think but it would not be uh would not have the same uh message of your all failures can i drill down on that uh so one i'd like to hear the rest of the

[06:30:29] board respond on the index versus non-index question i also like miss olden if you could ask if i could ask you why you support the index is it at all the levels or is it um the below basic or the basic levels do you want to give credit for those or you like that as well as above like the above and below okay yeah because one of the things i mean i guess i'm just one of the frustrations with our current system is it doesn't help schools aspire to help our strongest students i think i'd agree with that i agree with that last round i do think we want to we want to stretch we want to work that in i just would caution us if we are going to level with virginians

[06:31:08] about kind of where we are like we talked earlier about eighth grade eighth grade is not as bad as fourth grade still at eighth grade within a third of eighth graders are not proficient or are both excuse me are below basic and the director of ies stood before us last year and talked about like just how dire that is forget proficient in advance but if you're below basic you're basically functionally unprepared that's a third of eighth graders in this commonwealth and so any kind of meaningful accountability system is going to i think be something of a shock to the system because

[06:31:43] we have not been really forthright about kind of where we are and so i think i think we need to we need to make sure it meaningfully differentiates we need to make sure there's an opportunity for success and so forth but i worry if we come at this from just like starting at the at the finish line of what do we want this to look like like that's the wrong way to go about it we have to start with some first principles i think the ones we've generally come to around sort of higher level of rigor greater transparency but like there there there is there is some hard news coming um with respect to the fourth estate they're never

here when we're talking about this i think people are going to be sort of jarred because they've been sort of told a happy tale and i

[06:32:23] think we have to we have to engage with that um we have to engage that realistically these numbers these numbers are daunting and and if we're if we're gonna seize the opportunity we have to take it on that we're gonna it's gonna require leadership and some hard uh some hard conversations other comments i think you wanted everybody to answer the question yes please nobody wants to chat haven't you learned you've been here all day nobody answers your questions sorry calling on

[06:32:54] people yeah i agree i mean i'm for for the weights i want to see both but i think until we see something it's it's actually not gonna really hit home in terms of is it helpful what are the what are the consequences but that's my premise dr northern um for a performance index and i'm very on board with incentivizing both raising the floor and raising the ceiling and that's what a

[06:33:27] performance index does and so i think it is an easy sell for parents at all along the distribution if you will um relative to how it is and um focusing on their child no matter where their child is and the distribution it's focusing on them so big fan of performance index anybody on in virtual world have comments uh as usual i agree with a lot of different people we have to

[06:34:01] have parents on board and as i don't understand we have to be transparent and upfront about all the work that has to be done to make improvements on where we have faltered in these past few years so whatever it takes to get parents to see that we're all on the same team we're all here to prepare as we we've used the word readiness a lot and that's been on my teaching career talking about readiness and how that was my job as an educator to help prepare them to be ready so whether it's elementary middle school high school readiness is the word i didn't comment on that earlier so i'm kind of

[06:34:39] listening together but um i agree with alan we're going to have to face the music and it may be tough but we are here to have our students ready as virginians as u.s citizens and as worldwide that's a little philosophical i know but right mr stardofen i'm gonna have to jump with alan as well i heard this term absenteeism chronic absenteeism i still don't think our schools

[06:35:13] should be penalized for it um court systems are pushing it back to the schools it's not the school's role um the school's role is to educate and i think there's an alternative way that the school can measure dealing with chronic absenteeism you're right um the kids don't show up then the scores may be less it's like if you go to work if you don't go to work you don't get paid and get paid less so yeah it's understandable but um it's not the school's administrators teachers job to maintain that and then if they don't do it they get punished i i just disagree

[06:35:50] with that totally but i want to move forward with the accountability system um we can talk a lot about that you can talk a lot but i want some motion i want some movement i think this board we have with the leadership we have for our president and vice president they're going to keep us on track moving forward with this creation system so that's what i look forward to thank you madam president may i just respond to that i i um i have school right now 600 kids i will tell you i feel 100 responsible and accountable and capable of getting them there every single day

[06:36:28] and so i just want to respectfully disagree with that i think schools can do it it's about relationships it's about quality teaching about quality programming i don't think it should be the majority weight shouldn't outweigh everything else but i absolutely think schools have the capacity and resources

and should have the accountability to do everything they can to get scholars to school so that's just my experience thank you madam president yes sir mr star defense all schools

[06:37:02] aren't the same some schools may have the ability and the bandwidth to make it work not all um and some of the schools that are utilizing their limited resources towards absenteeism they're going to do the best they can because they're going to play by the rules they don't be penalized however one school i'm not quite sure which school my fellow board member was recovered to but it really depends on what part of virginia virginia is very different from the living virginia southwest virginia to south side virginia central virginia so that we can't

[06:37:40] all lump them together and really have the same expectation as to how they can run the day-to-day operations that's it madam president and along with what he's saying that's why i was saying parents have to be on board because I agree with her that you know schools have the ability to do it we have the enthusiasm we have the desire but the agenteeism still is connected to is there someone at home saying to your child you must be at school so it's as much as we you know work to try to get them there and encourage them all that that's why I'm saying parents have to be on board

[06:38:19] and I think a lot of parents are on board I'm not saying that I had a lot of good relationships with parents and I was a parent of students but it's teamwork it's not you know it's not one or the other I don't think that I think that's what Dale was probably pointing out too that school systems vary but all school systems that I know of have problems with antigenism and I think that a lot of it does play a role when is there someone encouraging that child whatever age that child is to show up every day like you do a job but we are training them to be ready as we just said

[06:38:54] for the world of employment it is what our one of our main goals is right that's how i saw it and i really appreciate the whole conversation here and dale i know we've had this offline and online and i but i also really appreciated the conversation earlier and possibly having this pegged in the readiness piece and to um and i think the weighting and the distributions are going to be critical for us and i've obviously been one of the big proponents of this and i really appreciate everything you said miss ashton i um total

[06:39:32] agreement with you but i i think just between you know the um the three legs of the stool of the pieces allen's mosaic i just i feel like we've got the components here too um and i really appreciated amber's um you know conversation too about the weighting of whether it's 50 50 or thereabouts

[06:39:53] And I'm just going around the table here, but Andy, I feel like I've also been preaching here for the last year about just the trough that we're in with the learning loss and as well as the population differential scores that we've really got to address.

[06:40:13] And it's getting worse, not better. And so I think we've got to have a sense of urgency about this and a sense of priority. And I really think we owe it to our teachers, our parents, our students to have a system in place.

[06:40:30] it's understandable. And again, I think the current system, which I was maybe part of back in the 90s, are getting the standards of quality and accountability together. It just is very opaque right now. And I just think we've got to come up with a very transparent system that works.

[06:40:51] So when people are being held accountable, they know what they've got to be driving towards, what they've got to be measuring themselves up against. And I think the thing that always gets lost is whenever we have these numbers coming out of these scores there is never um i don't think an

understanding of the human lives that are underneath all of those numbers and i feel like this system can bring reality to putting a face to each of those kids that are impacted by this and having and i just think a lot of the examples that we've heard today um where the system can really make what we're trying to get done at our schools of whether it's calling home whether it's

[06:41:30] trying to help students figure out their pathways so just have everybody focused on the individual needs of the student whether it's academic or readiness and but also growing ourselves out of this massive challenge that we're facing is just critical and that's again maybe be open to put in a little bit of a weight maybe even on certain grade levels for the growth area to have folks really uh held accountable for that and can maybe be a sliding

[06:42:07] scale as we move ahead but i just sense of urgency i think is real maybe like you is more of a speech than it was uh dr sievert so to your question chat about where i am on waited or not waited for the achievement piece i was undecided until i've just heard these really good points and i think the exclamation here was mr hanson that we want the achievement measure to include all children and if we're going to do that then i think we do want it to think about the advanced as well as the people who are moving and and a reason i was on the fence i was how to wait by here that you're saying by moving from seven tiers maybe five you might be able to come up with a

[06:42:46] thoughtful way so that it is it is weighted so it's it counts but it doesn't skew uh and so i i thank you all for making that those points so with that in mind i now would lean toward the the weighted achievement measure. I think Dr. Siebert's explanation there that it counts but doesn't skew actually gets me to my full circle thought here, you know, because I think that's probably where I was. The fact that if we weighted it, it could skew our outcomes or exactly,

[06:43:22] just like we said earlier, what we are putting heavier value in. And I don't think we want to show that we value one piece over the other so you know broadly so so obviously but i think that's exactly where my mind must be it must have been going and that is that things count but they don't skew so if that helps i think that's a good takeaway i would maybe even just add to that i i think also to the along the lines of the bottom quartile or quintile as well the philosophy that

[06:43:58] this i think it's going to be incumbent upon us as a narrative or communication tool as well to a be lifting us out of the trough that we're in but to also focus the resources going forward where and that's going to actually be i think immediately across the board of where we've got to identify the resources and target them but obviously going forward it's also i think some of the states that have really identified this is really what's also going to be the focus of this process so any other comments

[06:44:38] that do we need to help you with anything else uh i think i have a fairly good sense of the discussion today um i want to say that i think we may be able to run some numbers on this achievement index and come back to you on that i think that'll be not too complicated to run i don't want to promise a full sketch we can't run all the indicators yet particularly in the readiness side we don't have all the data but i think we can come back with some sort of straw man for what the entire accountability system could look like in terms of the weights and what that could look

[06:45:14] like in terms of the systems and probably some options within that as well so uh showing what that could look like at the elementary level middle school high school level i'm sorry i failed to go to mr roth no that's fine i i'm for that i want to see the models i i do want to put a mark and i still think we have to have a conversation about even with performance index that can roll up to summative and and i think

once we see the data that may become apparent or not depending and so i think like this is a really we need to get moving on this process and there's gonna be a lot of learning i i too want to see like what does that actually look like would it be meaningful

[06:45:50] or not and all of that yeah i think i would uh i think i've heard you say this but it would be wonderful also to see the vivas data uh run on current uh which is obviously available because we're sharing it already uh in some fashion but to run that uh on a school basis if if we could that data may be available somewhere but we haven't seen it so uh i will check on that that's uh yeah anything else one other thought um i don't know how far y'all are going to build a straw man for us

[06:46:28] um but i absolutely love this idea of incentivizing um advancement so in other words you know schools and districts get credit if a elementary school child chooses to take a middle school course or a middle school child chooses to take a high school course um we've been working with um a national working group across the country on how to expand the pipeline of advanced learners so we have more diverse kids you know and how can we you know especially given light of the supreme court uh recent decision so i think we need to put some thought into how we do make a wider more diverse

[06:47:07] pipeline of advanced learners and i actually think i'll send you all the link but i do think that some of these ideas this national group came up with may be able to be part of the way that we incentivize it in some of these buckets we're talking about the other things that i've asked you all to put a pin on i appreciate is uh we have to and to mr rotherham's point we have not had a full conversation on a summative rating we can uh bring that back for a board discussion as well um and also you mentioned to me that we haven't talked about um student groups how to include them in a good way in terms of identification of schools that need help for particular student

[06:47:47] groups um and we can uh tease out some potential ways to include them as well i think one additional thing that we ask for as we are walking away is some kind of sense of percentages. We don't need to know your absolute percentages, but we need some kind of sense of that. So as we're working through things towards next month, two weeks, we have a sense of where you guys are landing in general. We don't need numbers, but readiness, growth, and achievement, we need to have a sense of that so we can put some modeling up in front of you for next month. Well, if I may, just the

[06:48:24] weight on that may depend on whether it's a summative rating or some other system, but like there may not even, you know, our current system is essentially unweighted, so we may want to do something. I think we just need some options. I'd like to see some options, Dr. Kuhn, because first of all, I find myself in the awkward, I don't like to be on the opposite side of an education issue from amber uh northern i mean seriously and so it makes me feel uncomfortable so i want to actually see the numbers because that was what she said was compelling and i think it could be as as everybody remembers in their child era sometimes when you run these it turns out like growth low

[06:49:00] status schools low growth schools they actually are all roughly the same schools and it's not as pronounced as some of the scatter plots we saw and sometimes it's not and so i think seeing some of that those runs over the next few weeks might help inform like at least for this board member how to think about specifically some of that uh some of that waiting i think it would also help this board member to see you you all referenced it some today but more of what other states are doing if we don't know which states are are if we can't say if the research doesn't tell us that some states are doing better than others with this

which i'm hearing we don't really have research that says what's the best waiting but at least to know what's the range of options for

[06:49:40] how much states are waiting achievement versus growth versus other metrics and you showed us that for one or two states but i don't know if there's a chart or something that that helps us you know is nobody waiting growth more than 50 is nobody waiting growth uh achievement less than 25 you know something some sort of range of what what's the what have others gone before us done i agree and i thought even the last presentation with the different states that were not referenced in the prior states like florida and others it would be helpful to know if florida has a readiness component

[06:50:16] to it and um and how that's weighted earth tennessee which we focused on the readiness piece but not on the other pieces so it would be helpful to know yeah i know um so miss olden i know there's lots of research on the initial state essa plans so it might be outdated but we could probably get you that of where they were and i haven't seen as good tracking over the last year or two on this question but but whatever the most recent you can get us and and also and frankly you know pick a state or two or three that you can show us is doing really well on say they're below basic

[06:50:51] scores uh and what are they doing who's doing the best at helping all students especially those at the bottom succeed and what are they doing one thread i wanted to connect because i just think it probably would show up in strawman the proposals that we bring to this it's just your point um about the below basic sort of thinking to what mr rotherham said about just looking at the huge percentage of students in virginia they're below basic using the growth measure for the lowest performing 25 of students in a school as mr cyber was talking about kind of

[06:51:30] gets at that problem i know it's a growth measure but that sort of measure does focus it is focusing on that population of students for every school that would be in that below basic so just wanted to link those thoughts and i think that is something that we could try and think about and as strong as options that would include that and the options that wouldn't anything further okay not for this before we adjourn can i just give a thank you we're not adjourning yeah yeah

[06:52:05] to get you back to get back to my agenda but okay good thank you but any pressure but i i and i'm the one that also mentioned their bottom quartile on the and i think even if we have differentiated numbers i think it's also got to still be as simple as possible and not so differentiated or so tiered that it um so well i think that's where we want to see the runs because you we may build a bunch of stuff in that actually doesn't differentiate and so it's a lot of and and so you can go more simple and that's where i think that will be very helpful because you often you've seen

[06:52:40] some other states they put in a lot of stuff most of it actually doesn't differentiate so it's both confusing it means you only have a few indicators that actually really matter i don't want to over promise on what we can deliver on the data runs we will do our best i understand yeah especially with the vivos data which you know we have confidence in you next board meeting is when two weeks all right we're good no more questions comments well you're gonna hear about next steps yeah so you know i think that we have certainly seen several presentations we've talked about this

[06:53:20] for quite some time um and we've gotten a lot of different pieces to this puzzle that we we really are are now looking to move on and i know that you know during our july board meeting we discussed bringing a nora regarding the soa um so with that in mind i'd like to entertain a motion to direct the virginia department of education to file a notice of intended regulatory action according to the

provisions of the administrative process act so that we can start revising this system like do the real work um i think that nora should be broad enough to allow us some flexibility

[06:53:59] in revi the revisions process um so i guess the actual formal piece of it is that we have to withdraw the current action which is 5633 revising the standards of accreditation in order to streamline the work that the board is doing um but i so because we don't want to have two administrative actions in concurrence so um i guess this is two parts opening anora and withdrawing the current soa revision if that's your emotion so moved to do both those things

[06:54:40] discussion so am i correct in understanding that the department would come back to we have to approve the language of the draft nora right so the department would come back to us with a draft for approval but we're directing the department to present us a draft the the nora is something we approve the document i don't i don't think we can vote on a nora without a document we have one would you like for us to take a break so that you can you can distribute them right now distribute it well i mean i'm happy to look at it right now but i i would hope that i

[06:55:18] i would think the better course would be to give us a little while and even to have the public have an opportunity to have input something that we're seeing right now for the first time and speed reading i understand the public will have lots of opportunity absolutely but the shape of the nora the expanse of the nora well i mean the nora is a guiding document for the process and the language in the nora is not is not irrelevant to the outcomes which is why and we're going to be back together in two weeks so i just would hope that what we're asking the department to do is bring us language that we can vote on or consider at least if a september meeting for the nora

[06:55:55] i'm happy to move forward with a nora but i don't want to vote on a nora without knowing what's in it so i think if if you recall the conversation we did ask for that to be prepared um in the july meeting we asked the superintendent to get that ready um so that the board's work could move forward in this particular capacity but we haven't seen it yet and and as i said it's a it would be extremely broad so that the work that we need to accomplish in this capacity that we have spent hours talking about um we've just got to come to a place where we're actually getting the work done

[06:56:33] instead of circling the way i totally agree with that and i totally think it therefore appropriate for us to vote on it expeditiously once we've seen it to but we we need to make sure that it's broad enough i mean the wording of the nora can determine the whole multi-year process of revising regs so uh taking two weeks to get the nora right i think would be wise i mean i don't i don't even know how we ask for one we've never seen us do we have one how many pages i've never seen us vote on a nora without having it published to the pub and maybe mr chapman can inform us but have we ever

[06:57:09] voted on a nora without it being presented to the public first i believe so the the forms are the technicalities and you know the the board has oftentimes you know voted on regulatory actions fast tracks on the basis of the boiler fast tracks is different fast track is different this isn't fast track well when when you have text um you know so exempt actions the forms are kind of this is neither fast track nor exempt i understand that but like the the nora in this case if it's if it's that broad well i don't know whether it's that broad because i haven't seen it i want to make sure it's broad enough i mean that's part of what we need to do can we see it we have it we were asked to prepare it we haven't i i'd be happy to look at it today but to me it makes a whole lot

[06:57:48] more sense to look at it today have an opportunity to have our education stakeholders our superintendents our parents our our school board associations they all care desperately about what we're doing here and the nora is the starting point and we to get the starting point not right would be a terrible

[06:58:07] at State. Madam President. Yes, Mr. Skardafin. I assume that we have a motion on the floor on a second, and we have an order that we ask the staff to present to us. I have the utmost confidence in our staff to do what we ask them to do.

[06:58:31] Has this document, I'm sorry, Mr. Servin, I didn't mean I'm used to you being so brief. I thought you were done. I apologize. no no no um the um and i get your point um as far as the process of delaying and review but we also did request our staff to get this for us at this event um and we are we do have discussion and if the president had mentioned maybe we'll give you a break so all boardrooms can review it that's me but we already have a motion and a second on the floor so can we have

[06:59:11] a delay for review and keep our motion going would you like would you like a 10-minute recess and by way before we recess if i may just one comment has it been posted on the doe website and have uh mr sturdivant and miss kilgore do they have it we can get that to them contemporaneous and we can that's what i was asking for in the 10 minutes for you so we can at least get it to their board members and post it on the website but i mean not that we will have any opportunity for public input that way but what i'm looking at is a four and a half page document with a lot of

[06:59:49] content it is a form and it's very broad okay let's take a 10-minute recess please the board

[07:10:26] had requested staff to start drafting the last meeting is part of the very long three-stage process and so even this nora on its own is going to be subject to a 30-day public comment period so if the board decides to move forward with the nora staff will post to the virginia regulatory town hall and the public will have an opportunity to comment for you know a 30-day public comment period before the board then has to come back at some point at the proposed stage with regulatory text and then that will be subject to its own in addition to coming before the board will be subject

[07:11:04] to a 60-day public comment period and then after that it will go come back to the board for a final stage and have an additional 30-day public comment period so this long process in addition to the nora having its own 30-day public comment there is an additional 90 days of public comment built in after that um and again this is uh you know the noras are typically viewed by this board on first and final review these are these are things i think the board in the past has said we're we're ready to kick something off let's get this started um and we usually take on on one

[07:11:41] review mr rotherham madam president i think i do think process matters i mean recently at a meeting i expressed concerns on something related to process this as mr chatted just said there there's gonna be ample opportunity this is the first step in a very long journey um we've talked about this we have circled around this for a while we have had extensive presentations calling attention to the need for change i think this is written the bullet points look to me to be written broadly enough to cover pretty much anything we would have to um uh touch and so like i just think

[07:12:19] like we can we can talk this to death and we can wait and we can you know spin everyone up but we can start this process and again as mr chapman said there will be ample opportunity for the public and stakeholder input that we should appropriately receive absolutely i may so mr chapman there's at the top of page two there is an incomplete sentence can you help me understand how the document works my

apologies the sentence uh in the version i have uh is just the board is considering a full revision of the standards of accreditation as an integral step in fixing the

[07:12:56] state of public schools fixing what the state of public schools and then on the final page yeah there is an option which are we opting for there is um a or b still doing research on that because i i seem to recall that there is a state law requiring that the board have a public hearing when it revises the standards of accreditation so i just want to be be sure that the option selected won't put us in conflict with with state law how what what nora are we being asked to approve today that the first version or the second version i'm sorry if there's a version where the

[07:13:33] public hearing will be held and there's a version where a public hearing will not be held which are we asked this is a form that's been printed and there's a you're supposed to select one or the other which are we being asked to approve well if if we do if we don't have an option and we the state law says we must hold a public hearing then my anticipation is that the board would want to follow state law um otherwise i mean realistically we will do the public hearing right so what i'm hearing you say we should delete the language that says or and a public hearing will not be met no i i wouldn't say that i think i think i think i think we probably for the purposes of um this

[07:14:12] particular situation probably need to go with number one first you're not you're not meeting the terms of what town hall requires if you don't select one or the other of those so i understand i'm with miss chrissy yes miss chrissy are you directing us to select public hearing in the form okay thank you and if i'm is now the right time to speak to the content or should we wait a way to motion no we have a motion on the floor the motions on the floor so if i may comment i i do think that there are some language there's language in here that i think is unnecessary and frankly

[07:14:49] offensive to the hard work that the department and the public did on the last round of soa accreditation to which i can assure you the last round was much improved over on many factors you all have highlighted in our discussion today from the version before that where growth was not considered at all where there was no consideration of a profile of a graduate where there was no consideration of a workforce readiness career readiness so the language that says that the standards of accreditation are since that action it has become apparent standards are not serving their intended purpose i i would amend that language since that action has become apparent

[07:15:25] that the standards of accreditation merit further review to better align with the board of education goals there's just no need to unnecessarily critique all the hard work that people put into that last round i would make that change in the final paragraph on page two i would add language board will revise the current accreditation system in order to increase transparency number one number two improve student success for all students i would add that language and then go on to the current language and aid so that can you say where at the bottom of page two there's a

[07:16:00] sentence on the third line the word transparency i would add a comma after transparency and add improve student success for all students comma we've already addressed the fix on the final page and then obviously the fix to add in the language that mr chatman gave us at the top of page two so i would i would if it if it's appropriate i would um uh i don't know if i can make an amendment uh a proposed amendment to the motion to incorporate those changes i personally still

[07:16:38] think we'd be better off coming back in two weeks when the public can tell us if there's something we've forgotten but um i have nothing further to add on that one more time on the language on

page two on language on page two so the language mr chapman gave us to the incomplete sentence at the top of the page, mixing the state of public schools, whatever the heck that means.

[07:17:02] Then at the paragraph that starts in the middle of the page, there's a paragraph that starts since that action. I would delete, after standards of accreditation, I would delete the language that says are not serving their intended purpose nor meeting their stated goals, and I would substitute merit further review to better align with Board of Education goals. And then in the final paragraph, after the word transparency i would add improve student success for all students comma oh and

[07:17:39] i'm sorry i would i'm sorry that's it i would be happy to offer an amendment on the second one improve student success that seems like a good add on the first one though i do think we have to be very plain and forthright in our language i do think that language uh accurately captures where we are in the view of this board member sorry i'm doing them backwards that's extra confusing sorry the language on increase um uh uh success for all students i get i i would happily offer an amendment

[07:18:17] uh or second amendment on that um the first one i'm on uh which is the second paragraph so since that action has become apparent the standards accreditation is holding that some language which which i don't think is needed but i don't know how mr matter president how you want to do when you're ready to get us to a vote one way or the other i'm happy to make a motion to amend the motion if that's the proper process i'm not sure what it is we can make two motions one on each if you if you want to make a motion that's fine i move i still move on my amendments and

[07:18:55] maybe maybe there ought to be two things like we split your amendments yeah or really are we all in agreement with the amendments that mr chapman uh are we all in agreement with the state of public schools fixing the incomplete sentence and we're all in agreement with miss creasy's call on the final page let's go with amendment number one does on page two at the very top the board is considering a full revision of the standards of accreditation as an integral step in add fixing the state of public schools period that's amendment number one amendment number two

[07:19:34] is on page five and that is that we will strike or and the very last sentence on that page and we would also strike insert either right okay so we're going to take a vote on amendment one and amendment two in a block if that is amenable to everyone on the board yes i don't mean to

[07:20:09] complicate matters but i'm not a real fan of fixing the state of public schools myself i feel like it and it connotes that and i get what we mean by fixed but it's a it's a simplistic term so if i may do can i offer amendment on top of amendment or you guys tell me how this works we're not there yet but i if you want to add a word like improving instead of fixing or something like that that would be my preference okay improving instead of fixing okay so to review

[07:20:44] amendment number one improving the state of public schools amendment number two strike insert either and strike or and strike the last sentence on page two okay so that is amendment amendments number one and two is everybody just on discussion i mean i'm fine if statute requires us to have a hearing at this point we should obviously do that but it's going to be a very abstract hearing and so like i'm happy to go with the will of the board but it just seems like if it's following

[07:21:22] the proposed stage yeah we have to it's and we have to at this point we believe sure should following the proposed stage okay oh yeah yeah probably the proposed stage but we don't have that's what it says okay sorry i thought it was a hearing just on the okay that's fine never mind i withdraw that's fine

okay okay so amendments number one and two does everybody understand them yes any questions before we move forward are you okay with that okay all right okay so then let

[07:21:59] me get my roll call um miss miss holton i um dr siebert hi mr hanson um dr northern hi miss ashton

[07:22:18] Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Mr. Sturdefin? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Okay so and Chair votes aye. Okay then um the next amendment Mr. Rotherham what was that? Well Ms. Holden had two amendments and I was always speaking to myself one of them I have no issue with the other one I do. So the second one is the one in the pair the added language in the final paragraph on page two improve student success for all students adding that language

[07:22:55] okay um you had one in the sunset action paragraph i do but i'm i'm doing the one that mr rotherham doesn't oppose for the truth i'm just one more if other people do i would say i was with it as well tell me where that is in the third after the third sentence transparent or third line transparency and i think dan's recommending improved students success for all students improve success for all

[07:23:23] students capturing your edit to my edit i'm fine with it as well okay so we would um we would insert comma improve student success for all students and aid in the allocation correct is that correct okay so um this amendment would be amendment number three amendment number three would read in the third paragraph on page two the board will revise the current accreditation system

[07:24:01] in order to increase transparency comma improve success for all students and aid in the allocation of commonwealth resources into virginia schools is that correct everybody good okay so let us then vote on amendment number three miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hansen dr northern hi miss ashton

[07:24:34] Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay um would we like to entertain the other motion from Ms. Holton and where is that again?

[07:24:52] It's in the second paragraph above that and the sentence that I think now reads we would after the word accreditation we would delete are not serving their intended purpose nor meeting their stated goals and substitute merit further review to better align with board of education goals merit further review to align to better align with board of education goals okay

[07:25:29] so miss holton's um fourth amendment suggestion would be since that action has become it has become apparent that the standards of accreditation delete are not serving their intended purpose nor meeting their stated goals and insert merit further review to better align with board of education goals so that is amendment number four we'll take that up um for a vote two amendment

[07:25:57] number four miss holton aye um dr siebert hi um mr hansen all right um dr northern hi uh Ms. Ashton? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? No. Mr. Sturdefan? Aye. Ms. Kilgore?

[07:26:24] Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay, so we will now take a vote on the final amended document.

[07:26:39] That's not a typo. Does that matter? That's fair. I saw the same one. okay yeah okay so this is on this vote is now on the amended document before we do that and i just clarify has this been published on the public website i'm not seeing it there yet it will be posted very soon but it's not so we're voting on something we haven't shared with the pub just to

[07:27:11] be clear okay um is there any discussion um yeah i would have appreciated having this earlier but that that would prevented this not walking work but i'm thankful we did this wonky work to get the the

wording good um this is the accountability assessment accreditation work is what i am here for so i love that final paragraph um that that that the true stated system you know we've made We've made some more sense of that we're going to allocate the resources without a clear picture.

[07:27:49] I like that. So yes, let's get this done. Any other comments? I'm going to vote yes, because you all been so generous in letting me help rewrite it at this late hour.

[07:28:04] I will. I just feel like we're in a very bad precedent to not. And we've done a lot of these first and final reviews, and we shouldn't be doing it that way. know things that they help us see that we don't see and it's a mistake to not wait for their input with that said i'm prepared to vote for it any other comments mr rotherham i think they do probably know things that we don't know i think that's probably very true but there's gonna be an enormous time during this process for that i think this is written broadly enough that it

[07:28:37] we feel it is we can responsibly move forward any other comments okay let's take our roll call vote Ms. Houlton. Aye. Dr. Siebert. Aye. Mr. Hanson. Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay. Thank you all. Let's move on to G, please.

[07:29:15] Madam President, I'm so sorry, but I do have to exit now. I promise I will listen to the rest of the board meeting as I grab up my way. I would like to make a quick motion before Ms. Holton leaves to actually remove H from

[07:29:48] our agenda and we will for the for the in the sake of time can we move that to September let's move it to September which is again just two weeks away so let's kind of have a motion to do that please okay all right um so we will move this item to september um miss holton how do you vote the learning line okay uh dr sievert mr hansen dr northern hi miss ashton hi mr rotherham

[07:30:27] mr scurtofin miss kilgore okay we'll move this and chair votes aye mr chapman president creasy Vice President Hanson, members of the board, Superintendent Koons. I've handed out and circulated two documents that Ms. Fulton had requested be provided for the board, both of which are available publicly on the website. One is a summary of graduation requirements,

[07:31:02] and the other is a copy of the Board of Education bylaws, just so you have a hard copy in front of you. Of course, they're also available for, as mentioned, in a number of other places.

[07:31:23] this process of beginning the board of education's uh origin to the comprehensive plan um is is a big one and so at least an overview of what we'll you know looking at today um we'll start off with an overview of the the statutory requirements for the board of education's comprehensive plan before moving into what what ends up being um the meat between the the objective education the priorities and goals um in the current plan and a discussion of the boards uh and then allow some time for a discussion of what how you would like for the priorities to look in the next iteration of the

[07:31:56] comprehensive plan um if the bylaws uh give uh the the how-to's of the board's work you know really the comprehensive plan is the the what and the why of what you'll end up doing or uh for those on the board who might prefer prefer metaphors from the construction on i-81 um the bylaws are the guard rails and the comprehensive plan is the road and the cars a good comprehensive plan i think is your choice of how the road is going to cut through those mountains and in this moment however i don't

[07:32:30] think you want a good comprehensive plan um i think you need a great one and you need this plan to keep the passengers safe to get them to their destination with efficiency and so as you begin this work you know that this plan is going to set your agenda and it has to reflect your priorities it has to be capable of helping you discern a good path through the mountains from a great one so why does the board have a comprehensive plan it's a good idea most of you have probably been in organizations where the comprehensive plan has taken a big part of the a lot of bandwidth for

[07:33:07] the the organization it's a great idea but at the very least this board is required to have one by by the code of virginia and so this it's important to know that since you are accountable to the law that's where we need to look for the first orientation points of what the comprehensive plan is supposed to look like.

[07:33:29] So moving on, you know, this is really the elements that are required to be in a comprehensive plan. The plan has to include the objectives of public education in Virginia, including strategies for first improving student achievement, particularly the achievement of educationally at-risk students, and then maintaining high levels of student achievement.

[07:33:52] It must include an assessment of the extent to which these objectives are being achieved. It must include a forecast of enrollment changes, which the department will be providing data as the board moves along in the process. It needs to include an assessment of the needs of public education in the Commonwealth, an analysis of the extent to which the standards of quality have been achieved and the objectives of the statewide comprehensive plan have been met, and then a long-range plan to integrate educational technology into the standards of learning and curricula including career and technical education programs and i can tell you already that

[07:34:28] the the career and technical education group and the the stem and innovation group in the department already have a very very good revisions to the educational technology plan that was involved in the last conference of plans so as far as the objectives of education in the current plan these are my best attempts to summarize the way the objectives are framed. The current plan frames the objectives of the education system in Virginia as really to allow for the development of the

[07:35:07] individual. Objective two, it has stated as the education system is essential for the perpetuation of free government. And then the third objective that it recognizes that the educational system in Virginia is part of, you know, providing skills that allow each student to participate in the economic health of the Commonwealth. And I think, you know, both the, you know, individual enrichments, you know, the investment the education system has in informing citizenry, and then certainly what this leads to and how this translates into career readiness have been major focuses of the

[07:35:45] board and we hear those touchdowns even in the conversations on accreditation and all sorts of places the board's current priorities and goals that it uses the first priority and you'll notice on on all of the items most of the items that you receive for the board in the the overview and summary usually includes some reference to how this item fits into the these priorities and goals in the current comprehensive plan the first is to provide high quality effective learning environments for all students the second is to advance policies that increase the number of

[07:36:22] candidates entering the teaching profession encourage and support the recruitment development and retention of well-prepared and skilled teachers and school leaders and the third is to ensure the successful implementation of the profile of a virginia graduate and the accountability system

for school quality as embodied in the revisions to the standards of accreditation and so you know this is what the current plan says are the this is the cut through those beautiful blue ridge mountains um these are the boards boards priorities as they currently stand and so that brings us to the point where it's like yeah this is it's time to think through well well how

[07:36:57] is this board moving um and at least one touchstone that i believe is important for this is is you know how this has been framed in the the current department's vision under the guidance of of dr Kuhn's general yeah I think one thing Ms. Holton asked in her call and I'll represent her while she's not here she asked if that was the directionality we were asking the board to give we are just giving you information as you are thinking about this don't want this to be she asked me to comment that this is not the direction we're asking you to go this is these are our four overarching priorities just wanted you to have this information from us.

[07:37:35] And so here we are for discussion questions, comments, concerns from this one.

[07:37:51] Ready? You guys have no, no comments. We've we've hit you with so much today. So much information and overload. Well, I mean, I'm a little, I am a little disappointed.

[07:38:09] Ms. Holden's not here only because like I would love to learn here. Like the comprehensive plan in my experience has gone through various iterations, some of which have been more or less successful and sort of have a little bit of a discussion. a discussion on sort of what are best practices what can we learn from that and like to make sure that the time we're about to put into this is you know as effective as been as possible so i will say having read the comprehensive plan um myself a few times um i i think that i would like to take

[07:38:41] our new plan in a very objective very clearly directional um direction sorry i'm losing my words at this point of the day um so i'm i'm i think that we need to be very clear on what we want this document to include i i don't want um i don't think we need to spend a whole lot of time making it um you know sunshine and flowers as much as we need to be very direct at what the

[07:39:18] points are that we want to make sure that we're working towards so that's just my input mr hansen i agree and um chapman just maybe just what's the process and the timing and the time frame for this yeah the current plan expires at the end of this year so i think the goal would be to have the final version approved at the november board meeting um and typically the board is required by statute to review the comprehensive plan biannually um so i would take it that at the minimum the comprehensive plan should be for a two-year period i think traditionally it's been for a five-year

[07:39:57] period is how how they've been interpreted long can we find the current plan um it's on it's in the board docs but it's also on the website under the i believe it's sitting on our board page too i think on the board page there's a link to the other comments dr siebert as we go down this path again always trying to think about the end you know backwards design piece often these plans end up being really thoughtful multi-page documents with charts and implementation and timelines and

[07:40:36] all that management by objective very very good stuff we have to have but i also think it'd be helpful for us as we move forward um if from it we can derive not so much an executive summary but a plan on a page i think ultimately we should have a piece of card stock front and back that we can all have with us at every meeting that encapsulates the end product so rather than trying to make you make that after we're done i just think uh a plan on a page and we can be front and back but uh i think something uh

that we can refer to if we have a question about plan page we can go into the bigger plan but i just don't want to compromise a plan that it's on a

[07:41:14] shelf or on a web page i think if it's going to be actionable it needs to be accessible okay dr northern so how have these really been used in the past i mean do they do they drive the work at all or you know it seems like a kind of a big deal to put together a plan that gives a direction while we're still building everything that we are trying to build so so the intent is that that's um so

[07:41:53] the current comprehensive plan is the roadmap goals to reach right and so that that that was the plan that that that's how it would be used i think that for us in particular that is how it should be used what are what are sort of the overarching goals that this board plans to achieve the goals that we are working towards and so i do think that that is really where it should be

[07:42:27] sort of a pseudo work plan for us. And what are the things that are important that we have to work to seeing an end to or getting to that final stage for? So that's my thought process as we enter this. Can it be pulled from the documents? I assume like we looked at some front matter from the math standards a day that laid out absolutely responsibilities so okay trying to make sure it

[07:43:04] just kind of aligns with what we're already doing use your resources and don't reinvent the wheel other comments thank you mr chapman sure and we will now move into our final topic which is discussion of current issues and um just to jump in on this before anybody else jumps in on other topics. As president, I am given the opportunity to set up different committees or

[07:43:41] work groups. And so that being said, we have a lot of work to do in a very short period of time. And so what I have decided that we would do is that we will come up, we will work in work groups. And I've defined three of those work groups, one being comprehensive plan work, one being the standards of quality, and then the third being the annual report. And for the ease of work, I have determined the people who will staff those at least our board members who will staff those

[07:44:20] at least for now. And I will just say, please keep in mind, we have a lot of work moving forward. These are simply three buckets that we need to accomplish pretty quickly. So if you are not one of the people on one of these work groups, consider yourself either lucky or not because you will be assigned in the next round of work groups. But the annual report, I am going to ask Andy and Dale to work on. The SOQ work group, I'm going to ask Alan and Amber to work on.

[07:44:53] And then the comprehensive plan, Bill and I will work on. So that's where we're going with that. Any other issues that are of importance here?

[07:45:11] Is our homework there? Oh, I will communicate your homework soon. Go get a dog, so you need it. I just want to mention the department is running three major priorities right now. We are encouraging everyone to get out in schools, thank a teacher, really elevate the great work that our educators are doing across the state.

[07:45:34] My entire agency has been asked to visit a school during the month of August, and we are really getting into schools, thanking our teachers, thanking our bus drivers, thanking our school nutritionists, and making sure everybody understands how much our educators are appreciated and how much we understand what they're doing.

[07:45:50] So if anyone on the board wants to go visit a school with us, happy to do that. Was in Mr. Sturdifant's hometown a couple weeks ago and had the opportunity to actually kick off our campaign in Mecklenburg County schools. But we have continued to spread out and make sure that we're talking about the great work our educators are doing and then the great work our leaders are doing at finding alternative pathways to fully staff and make sure there's a highly qualified licensed teacher in front of every child.

[07:46:18] Second, we have kicked off a major campaign around Attendance Matters VA. We know that our students are dropping about 25% in mathematics when they are absent more than 18 days a year. That's just two to four days a month. So 25% in math on our own Virginia scores and 18% on our ELA scores.

[07:46:38] On average, we're seeing over time if a student is chronically absent. That's a significant drop for students just to be in school. So we have launched a communications campaign with our school divisions, provided them a great deal of resources, working collaboratively with No Kid Hungry to expand Breakfast After the Bell programs, really working to think about transportation barriers, working with the secretary's office, and thinking about the barriers that might be in the way of children coming to school, but really focusing on how important it is for a student to come to school every single day.

[07:47:15] And we talked a little bit about that today, but that's a major emphasis of the Department of Education. Last but not least, Everybody Reads VA. We also talked about how important literacy is. We are working diligently in partnership with UVA on the Virginia Literacy Act implementation, but also elevating literacy among our families, elevating literacy in our communities.

[07:47:37] we are challenging and have challenged the Virginia School Board Association Executive Board to listen to Sold a Story by Emily Hanford. So I'm going to give the same challenge to this state board and challenge you to listen to, we'll put it in the minutes you have it, but Sold a Story by Emily Hanford is a podcast. It's on Spotify, Apple Music, but it really sets the stage for why we need to do the literacy work and how important it is to implement the Virginia Literacy Act.

[07:48:07] The Virginia Literacy Act really embodies the work that will help us get better, but Emily Hanford does a great job painting the picture of why we have to do this, and it gives us a great understanding of what has happened in education to the system that is now requiring things like the Virginia Literacy Act to help us change for our children. So just wanted to mention those three things. Those are major priorities for the department and things we are focusing on in August and September and just wanted to share those updates with you. Can we get a list of like where the schools that are going to be visited are in a little bit? Because that sounds like a

[07:48:44] fantastic opportunity. I will do my best with everything else to get you, paint you a picture. Tell us who we should talk to. Yes, we will get you a point of contact so that you can come visit with us. Happy to do that. Dr. Siebert. On behalf of my superintendent, I would say that Roxy schools is an open invitation to anybody in Euronic Valley.

[07:49:03] Let me know, and we'll show you great things. Anything for the good of the cause. Yes, I thank you. Dr. Coons, you do a wonderful job of commending your staff for the work they do and lifting them up, and we appreciate that.

[07:49:23] But I want to thank you. Just a month ago, we asked you to pivot and bring us some meat and potatoes about assessment accountability, and that was designed for us today and it was a long difficult day

it was profoundly important day it was structured very very well it had great thought leaders and it helped move us forward um we we we finally take a step from talking about it or as my superintendent dr white says uh from admiring a problem to solving a problem and and so i i feel like we're moving in down the solution road and so i thank you for your leadership i just go ahead and i thought i

[07:50:00] knew a lot but now i learned a lot so it was just a very helpful primer and i think it's given us the foundation to get a good result here so i do want it was very informative i appreciate it i do want to mention secretary gadara in the audience she has been a tremendous partner in this work so i do want to thank her and not um eliminate that she has been a tremendous push to even get us to this door so i do want to acknowledge her as well anything from anyone else before we adjourn

[07:50:36] Thank you, ma'am. Okay, and we're adjourned.